

**Viksit Bharat – Viksit Haryana**

Flagging-off of India's first Hydrogen Train between Jind and Sonipat

Fully indigenous and based on hydrogen fuel cell technology, in which the train runs on electricity generated from hydrogen and oxygen (drawn from air), emitting only water vapour

World's most powerful hydrogen train, with 3,200 horsepower

World's longest hydrogen train, with 10 coaches

World's highest passenger-capacity hydrogen train, with a capacity of 2,600 passengers

along with

Dedication to the Nation and Foundation Stone Laying for Development Projects worth **about ₹15,000 crore**

Delhi - Amritsar - Katra Expressway (Cost: approx. ₹9,700 crore)

- Delhi to Katra journey made easier - now takes just 6 hours instead of 14 hours
- Haryana's Jhajjar, Sonipat, Jind and Kaithal districts connected to the expressway

Ambala - Kala Amb National Highway (Cost: approx. ₹1,200 crore)

- Stronger connectivity between Haryana and Himachal Pradesh
- Reduced transport time and logistics costs for industries
- Safer travel for the public, new momentum for trade

Pandit Neki Ram Sharma Government Medical College

(Cost: approx. ₹600 crore)

- Bhiwani district hospital upgraded into a medical college
- 630-bedded hospital
- Classes begun following admission to 100 MBBS seats

Jind - Gohana National Highway (Cost: approx. ₹1,600 crore)

- Jind-to-Gohana travel time reduced from 2 hours to just 40 minutes
- To help farmers reach agricultural produce markets more easily
- Better connectivity to Rohtak-Panipat-Delhi NCR

Kurukshetra Elevated Railway Track (Cost: approx. ₹400 crore)

- Smoother traffic flow
- Five railway level crossings in highly populated areas removed
- Relief to public from traffic congestion

Maharishi Chyawan Medical College (Cost: approx. ₹900 crore)

- Treatment capacity increased with a 650-bedded hospital
- Admissions to 100 MBBS seats
- OPD facility started

Sikh Museum, Kurukshetra (Cost: approx. ₹160 crore)

- Inspiring younger generation with the heritage, life, and cultural significance of the Sikh Gurus

Hansi - Barwala National Highway (Cost: approx. ₹140 crore)

- Better road connectivity between Hisar and Panchkula
- More economical agricultural production and local freight transport
- Boost to local employment and economic activity

by

Sh. Narendra Modi

Prime Minister

August Presence

Prof. Ashim Kumar Ghosh

Governor, Haryana

Sh. Nayab Singh Saini

Chief Minister, Haryana

Sh. Nitin Jairam Gadkari

Union Minister for Road Transport & Highways

Sh. Ashwini Vaishnaw

Union Minister for Railways

Date: 17 July, 2026 | Time: 9:00 AM
Venue:- HSVP Ground, Sector - 9, Jind, Haryana

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EXPRESS special

Vessels to and from India among top applicants for Hormuz passage

Three-week data from June 17 shows 40% of vessels seeking to cross Hormuz were to or from India and China

Sukalp Sharma
New Delhi, July 16

MERCHANT VESSELS to and from India were among the top applicants for passage through the Iran-recommended routes to cross the Strait of Hormuz in the three weeks following the June 17 US-Iran peace MoU, as per Iranian data.

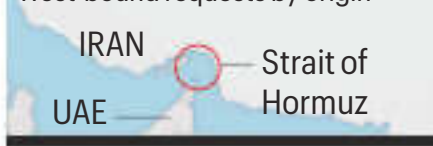
According to Persian Gulf Strait Authority (PGSA), set up by Iran to regulate the flow of maritime traffic through the Strait of Hormuz, over 200 non-Iranian vessels coordinated with it to receive passage permits and insurance coverage during the three week period.

Among the transit requests to exit the Persian Gulf received by the Islamic Republic's PGSA

• Transit requests

Origin/destination	West-bound	East-bound
India	21%	20%
China	19%	21%
Other Asia	20%	29%
Intra-region	24%	22%
Other World	16%	8%

East-bound requests by destination
West-bound requests by origin



SOURCE: PERSIAN GULF STRAIT AUTHORITY

set up recently by Tehran, those bound for India had a 20% share, second only to China's 21%.

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NCP REUNION: TATKARE SIGNALS BALL IN SHARAD PAWAR'S COURT

CBSE 3-LANGUAGE POLICY FOR CLASS 9: SC JUDGE VOICES CONCERN

Happening today

• **PM NARENDRA** Modi will flag off India's first Hydrogen-powered train between Jind and Sonipat.

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Business as Usual

By EP UNNY



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ELECTRIC TRUCKS FOR LAST-MILE DELIVERY: DELHI WINTER PLAN

• SPAIN HAVE CLINICAL FORWARDS, STRONG DEFENCE; ARGENTINA CAN'T BE DEFEATED UNTIL WHISTLE BLOWN

For many in Spain team, meeting Messi in final is a dream — and a nightmare



Sandip G
Atlanta, July 16

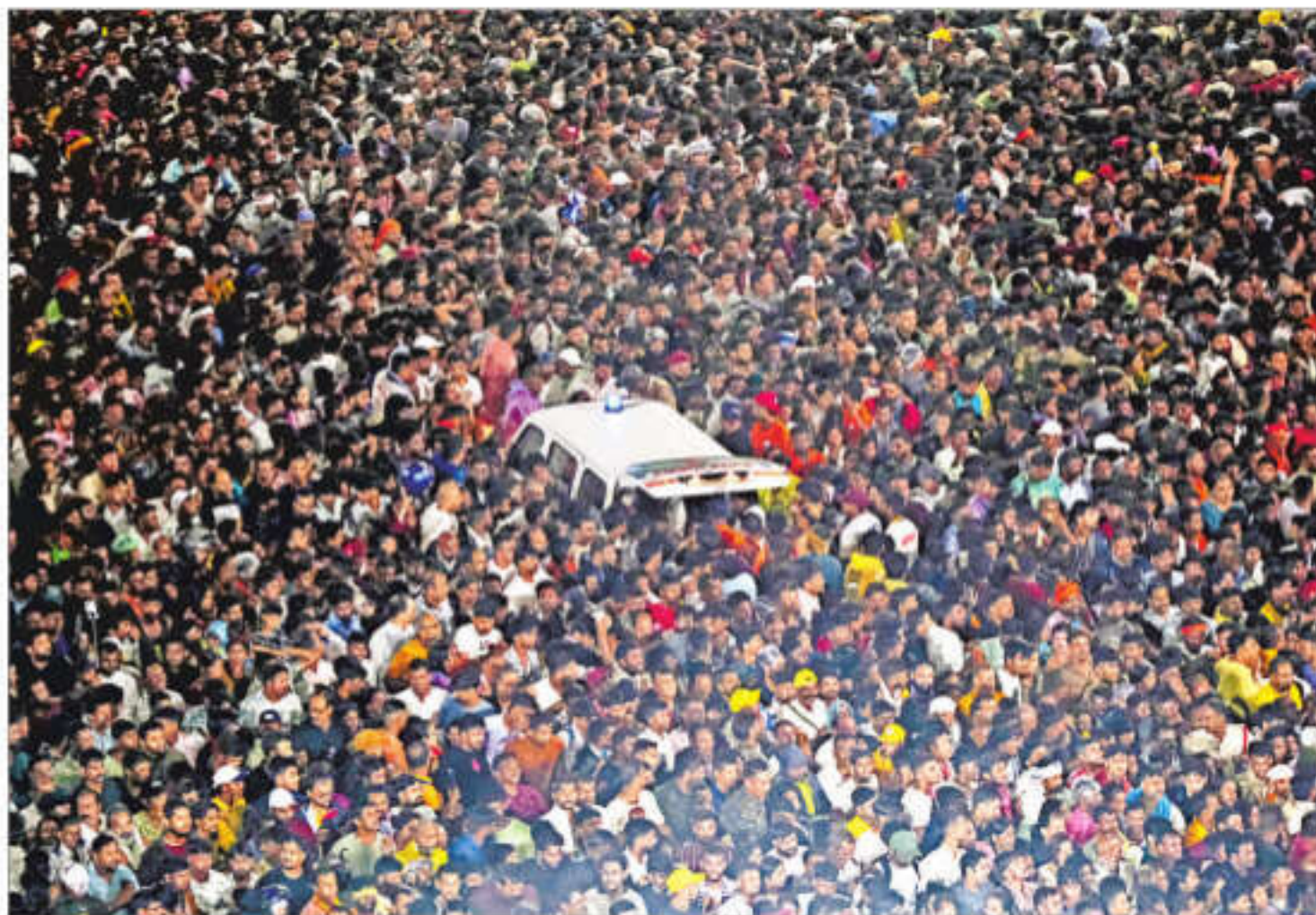
LIONEL MESSI smiled when asked about meeting Spain in the final of the World Cup on Sunday. "I have faced many of them, and I still follow them. Several of them play for Barcelona, a club I love and continue to follow."

For nearly 15 years, Messi was the heartbeat of Barcelona, its philosophy distilled into a



Lionel Messi celebrates after teammate Enzo Fernandez scored the first goal during the semifinal against England, Wednesday. AP

human figure, the most celebrated footballer in Spain, and the only one Spain wished



Two dead in Puri Rath Yatra

Devotees surround an ambulance during the annual Rath Yatra in Odisha's Puri, Thursday. At least two persons died and several others sustained injuries following a crowd surge. AP

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US latest on immigration: Shrink visa duration for students, media

Shubhajit Roy
New Delhi, July 16

IN A move that is expected to impact a large number of US-bound Indians, the Donald Trump administration on Thursday moved to tighten the visa duration for foreign students, journalists and cultural exchange visitors.

According to a US government notice, the new final rule from the Department of Homeland Security (DHS) creates a fixed time period for F visas for

international students, J visas that allow visitors on cultural exchange programmes to work in the US, and I visas for members of the media. Currently, these visas are available for the duration of the programme or employment in the US.

Under the new regulations, the student and exchange visa periods would be no longer than four years. The visa for journalists — which currently can last years — would be for up

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

E. EXPLAINED

New roadblock
US President Donald Trump has kicked off a wide-ranging immigration crackdown since taking office — revoking student visas over ideological views and stripping legal status from migrants. The latest move will create new hurdles for students, exchange workers and journalists.

ACTIVIST ON HUNGER STRIKE SINCE JUNE 28

Govt doctors must monitor Wangchuk health, directs HC

Life of any citizen is precious, notes court; SG says no objection to order

Sohini Ghosh
New Delhi, July 16

THE DELHI High Court has directed the Centre to ensure daily monitoring of the health of activist Sonam Wangchuk by government doctors, and to "intervene immediately" if required. "The life of any citizen is precious," the court said on Thursday.

Wangchuk has been on a hunger strike at Jantar Mantar since June 28 as part of the protest organised by the activist platform Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) to demand the resignation of Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan over NEET-UG question paper leak.

Advocate R K Saini had petitioned the High Court alleging that the government was treating Wangchuk like a "terrorist", and seemed "apathetic" to the situation. The petitioner sought the court's direction to the government to provide "full, proper and necessary aid" to

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2



AAP national convenor Arvind Kejriwal with activist Sonam Wangchuk at the protest site in Jantar Mantar, Thursday. TASHI TOBGYAL

From AAP to Congress, SP to NC, Opp parties rally behind activist

Express News Service
New Delhi, July 16

AS ACTIVIST Sonam Wangchuk's hunger strike demanding the resignation of Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan entered its 19th day on Thursday, the Opposition rallied behind him, with Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) national convenor and former Delhi Chief Minister Arvind Kejriwal joining Wang-

chuk at Delhi's Jantar Mantar. After maintaining a measured silence on the protest organised by the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP), the Congress too weighed in, appealing to Wangchuk to end his hunger strike and saying that it shares his "anguish and outrage" on the lack of accountability in the BJP-led Union government. Other Opposition leaders such

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BCCI panel takes call, Lord's ODI may be Rohit Sharma's last for India

Devendra Pandey
Mumbai, July 16

THE THIRD and final ODI against England at Lord's on July 19 could be Rohit Sharma's last match for India. The BCCI's senior selection committee is learnt to have informed him that they have decided to "move on" from him after the England series.

The panel is learnt to have spoken to Sharma, along with



Rohit Sharma was removed as the ODI captain last year. ANI

coach Gautam Gambhir, last week.

According to sources, the selection committee wants to give youngsters like Yashasvi Jaiswal, who has been waiting in the wings, a chance, and has made it clear that it doesn't see a role for Sharma in the 2027 50-over World Cup.

"The selectors have informed Rohit that he does not figure in their scheme of things

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Nepal protests have a new Gen Z face, this time in anti-Balen Shah govt camp

Yubaraj Ghimire
Kathmandu, July 16

A 25-YEAR-old who died of self-immolation on July 10 is emerging as the face of the discontent against the Balendra Shah government, which swept to power less than four months ago on the strength of Gen Z support. Anticipating that ongoing protests over Ganesh Nepali's death and other issues may mount, the ongoing Parliament Session was adjourned.



25-year-old Ganesh Nepali died of self-immolation on July 10.

Ganesh set himself on fire in an altercation with police after the Kathmandu Metropolitan Council clamped the wheels of

his motorcycle for allegedly blocking passage at a complex of the Department of Passports, suffering 60% burns.

Ganesh was a rider with a ride-sharing app, and the motorcycle his means of making a living. This fanned protests already underway by disparate groups over the Shah government's alleged highhandedness, including the dissolution of trade unions and student organisations, pushing through

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॥ श्री ॥

Om Shanti

Jai Maharaja Agrasen
Jai Gau Mata

In Loving Memory of

SHRI NAND KISHORE JI GOENKA

Life Partner - Late Smt. Tara Devi Ji

Shanti Baithak (Daily)

10 am to 1 pm
4 pm to 7 pm

Venue: Goenka Seva Sadan,
Devi Bhawan Mandir Parisar,
Hisar

Rasam Pagri
(26th July 2026)

3 pm to 4 pm

Venue: Maharaja Agrasen Bhawan,
Old Government College Ground,
Hisar

Sons

Subhash Chandra - Sushila
Laxmi Narayan - Sulochana
Jawahar Lal - Sushila
Ashok - Kaveeta

Daughters

Kusum - Late Ramesh Rawalwasia
Urmil - Ashok Gupta
Mohini - Deepak Gupta

Entire Goenka Family



Infra Excellence

Defence Minister Rajnath Singh and Director General of Border Roads, Lieutenant General Harpal Singh (left), confer awards to BRO projects for their excellence in infrastructure development, at the Strategic Infrastructure Conclave in New Delhi on Thursday. ANI

Beard, niqab, Arabic expressions: MP flags ‘profiling’ in Gujarat’s ‘anti-radicalisation’ SOPs

Express News Service Ahmedabad, July 15

RAJYA SABHA MP John Brittas has asked Gujarat Chief Minister Bhupendra Patel to put on hold “Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs) of Anti-Radicalisation Cells (ARCs)” in the state until it is determined that they do not “permit profiling or surveillance” based on a person’s religion, attire, or language. The MP’s letter, written to Patel on July 14, refers to a purported communication from the State Intelligence Bureau of the Gujarat Police to all superintendents and commissioners of police regarding the SOPs for these ARCs. The communication, issued on June 19, had come after the government approved 139 new posts in ARCs across districts, and operationalised them. It is learnt to have defined “a radicalised person”, and detailed the procedures on prevention, detection, intervention, rehabilitation and monitoring of such individuals. The SOPs are learnt to have identified such persons as “someone who uses their radical ideas to carry out anti-national activities and work against the unity and sovereignty of the country, create an environment of fear in the people, and tries to propagate these ideas”, the paper has learnt. It reportedly said that such individuals believed their religion to be supreme and “aim to harm those professing other faiths. They disseminate such hardline ideas through social media, newspapers, radio, TV, magazines, public gatherings and try to radicalise vulnerable people.”

Brittas, who represents the CPI(M) in the Upper House, wrote to the CM that while the state has a duty to prevent terrorism and violent extremism, “the contents attributed to the SOPs” were “disquieting” enough to merit his “immediate attention”. “They appear to define a radical individual in broad terms and... reportedly list behavioural indicators that include suddenly keeping a beard, wearing a niqab, using Arabic expressions in ordinary conversation, reacting strongly to incidents affecting Muslims anywhere in the world, withdrawing from education or

employment for religious reasons, frequently meeting religious leaders, visiting mosques and madrasas identified as ‘sensitive’, etc.” Such “contents of the purported SOP”, if accurate, “risk treating ordinary manifestations of religious identity and constitutionally protected conduct as grounds for police suspicion”. Another MP, chief of All India Majlis-e-Ittehadul Muslimeen (AIMIM), Asaduddin Owaisi who represents Hyderabad in Lok Sabha, too criticised the alleged broad definition of “radicalisation”. “What is radicalisation? Those who offer namaz, visit mosques, or dress a certain way are being branded ‘radicalised’. Such stereotypical policies won’t matter; isn’t destroying mosques radicalisation?” PTI, which posted a video of Owaisi’s speech on X, reported on Wednesday. Neither Deputy Chief Minister Harsh Sanghavi nor Gujarat Police DGPGS Malik were available for a comment on the letter. The SOPs, seen by *The Indian Express*, refer to “Actions” including the purchase of fertilisers that contain dual-use chemicals such as potassium nitrate, sulphur, and ammonia; the hoarding of LPG cylinders; frequently visiting jungle areas; contacting people in PoK, the Gulf countries and Afghanistan; using encrypted apps; and withdrawing large amounts of cash, as those to be watched out for. Among “Digital” actions, the SOPs mention the VPN use; downloading of Signal, Element, and similar encrypted messaging apps; membership of radical Telegram groups; following of accounts of Islamic State (ISIS) and Al-Qaeda, and sharing of ISIS magazines like Dabiq and Rumiyyah; and dealing with cryptocurrency, especially Monero, without any known sources of income. “Any institutional framework that creates an impression of profiling a particular community would be inconsistent with the constitutional promise of equal protection of laws,” Brittas wrote.

A senior Gujarat Police officer told *The Indian Express* that the intention was to proactively address tendencies towards radicalisation. “This is not targeting a specific group, but those who are against society...”

Slab falls, kills 21-year-old in Uttarakhand tunnel 3 yrs after rescue of 41 workers

Aiswarya Raj Dehradun, July 16

The National Highways and Infrastructure Development Corporation Ltd (NHIDCL), the implementing agency of the project, has ordered a detailed investigation and is preparing a factual report. The official cause of the accident and other details will be confirmed only after the inquiry report is received. In 2023, 41 workers were trapped inside the Silkyara-Barkot tunnel for 17 days during construction after a portion of it collapsed and blocked their way out. In a massive effort that took 17 days, all 41 were rescued. The tunnel, which is touted to be a fillip for the Char Dham yatra, is being constructed at an estimated cost of around Rs 853 crore and is 4.5-km-long with two lanes for bidirectional traffic. The government said that the construction of the tunnel is expected to reduce the distance between Gangotri Dham and Yamunotri Dham by 26 kms, resulting in a reduction of travel time to 5 minutes, from the current 50 minutes. The works at the site commenced on July 9, 2018.

[FROM PAGE 1 | FULL REPORTS ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM]

Govt doctors to monitor Wangchuk health: HC

Wangchuk to address his “deteriorating health and life-threatening condition”, and to “force-feed him”. The HC Bench of Chief Justice D K Upadhyaya and Justice Tejas Karia orally inquired of Solicitor General Tushar Mehta, who appeared for the Central and state governments, whether the health of the activist was being monitored, and whether any medical reports were available with the government that the court could peruse. When Mehta said, “Sometimes some private doctors also come in and check.”

US immigration

to 240 days or, in the case of Chinese nationals, 90 days. The visa holders could apply for extensions, it said. The regulations also prohibit graduate students from changing their “educational objectives” at any point, or from transferring to another school without authorisation. They halve the amount of time students have to leave the US after completing their degree or training, from 60 to 30 days. The new regulations will come into effect 60 days from publication in the federal register, subject to Congressional review. Among Indian students, the US is a favoured destination for higher education. As of January 2025, there were about 300,000 Indian students in the US, mostly in graduate (Masters) programmes in STEM (Science, Technology, Engineering and Mathematics) fields. According to the US State Department report, in 2024, 90,129 Indians got F (student) visas, 15,208 got J (exchange visitor) visas, and 426 got I (journalist) visas. After the Trump administration’s immigration crack-

Hormuz passage

The share of the rest of Asia was 29%, while that for intra-region (in the Persian Gulf) movements was 22%. The share of the rest of the world was 8%. To enter the Persian Gulf, of all transit requests, India topped the list of origins with a 21% share, followed by China at 19%. Other Asian countries had a combined share of 20%, intra-region movement requests accounted for 24%, while the rest of the world had a share of 16%. The PGSA didn’t provide the absolute number of transit requests received. This data also doesn’t include vessels that crossed or attempted to cross the strait without seeking Tehran’s permission. Post these three weeks after the MoU, tensions resurfaced in the region, leading to a significant drop in maritime traffic. While vessel movements have not completely stopped, they are sharply down following the resurgence of conflict around the critical trade artery. On its part, Iran and the PGSA maintain that the strait is closed. The data is in line with trade patterns considering India and China have traditionally been

Nepal protests

of ordinances bypassing Parliament and eviction drives. Home Minister Sudhan Gurung’s accusations against the Opposition of politicising Ganesh’s death further fuelled the mass anger. Realising the building tensions over the incident, the government got Ganesh admitted to a top hospital and Gurung announced he was personally monitoring his case, with arrangements made for his air-transfer to AIIMS in Delhi if needed. However, Gopal died after nearly a day of battling for his life. On Monday, he was cremated in Kathmandu, at a funeral site overlooking the famous Pashupatinath Temple, with his old parents travelling around 700 km from Mugu, a backward region of Nepal, for the last rites. The family agreed to cremate the body after the

Meeting Messi in final

I wanted to play for Spain, but I always said that I wanted to play for Argentina and I only felt these colours,” he once said. For most of the Spanish players, especially those of Barcelona, it’s like their dream and nightmare coming true at the same time. Most of them idolised him when growing up; one of them, Lamine Yamal, the wunderkind, was photographed with Messi for an advertisement shoot when he was barely two months old. Dani Olmo still has a picture of him hanging in his bedroom. Mikel Oyarzabal watched, and still

“He (the SG) further assures the court that depending on the opinion of doctors, whatever medical intervention is needed to check the deteriorating health condition of Wangchuk, shall also be taken. While noting the assurances given by SG we only observe that the life of any citizen is precious and all efforts ought to be made by the government (to save the same)...,” the order said. In his PIL, the petitioner had alleged that the “government is treating (Wangchuk) like he is a hardcore criminal, terrorist, or traitor to the nation”, and that

Real Creator IAS Edition https://t.me/+2RvD_RG0mIjMzg1 down last year, the number of F-1 visas issued to Indian students fell sharply by 69 per cent in June-July 2025 as compared to the previous year, from 41,336 in June-July 2024 to 12,776 visas last year. According to the DHS, there were over 1.8 million student visa admissions in total in 2024, a more than 11% increase over the previous year. The US granted visas to more than 500,000 exchange visitors and 37,300 members of the media in fiscal year 2024, which began on October 1, 2023, it said. The significant increase in the volume of such visitors “poses a challenge to DHS’s ability to monitor and oversee these non-immigrants while they are

vagueness in its terms have now emerged as the flashpoints between Tehran and Washington. Maritime data shows that ever since last week’s fare-up, which followed Iran’s targeting of a few vessels taking the Omani route through the strait, even the vessels crossing the strait are mostly doing so using paths designated by Iran. During the war, Iran actively regulated the flow of vessels through the strait, allowing only a handful to pass, that too using routings dictated by it. Following the June MoU with the US, Iran continued to insist that vessels cross the strait only through the routings designated by it, and that too after seeking permission from the PGSA. Tehran also plans to impose a service fee for transits, but at a later date. Earlier this week, US president Donald Trump even proposed a 20% charge by the US Navy to facilitate safe passage of commercial ships through the strait, only to backtrack the very next day. According to the data released by the PGSA, of the 200-plus transit applications it received in the three weeks following the MoU, 53% were for exiting the Persian Gulf, while 47% were to enter the Gulf. The PGSA said that it ap-

death, a job for his wife Ekmaya Pariyar, 20, and funding for their two-year-old daughter’s education. Pariyar, who has done a diploma course in IT, is pregnant with the couple’s second child, and soon after Ganesh’s death, the government cleared a ‘citizenship certificate’ for her, with Gurung personally handing it over. Pariyar did not have the formal certificate, and with the document, she is now entitled to a job and other relief announced by the government. According to sources, the government may also declare Ganesh a “martyr”, a status enjoyed by hundreds of people, mostly Maoist cadres, who died during agitations over the past 20 years of the country’s troubled history. The family says the police action in clamping his motorcycle’s wheels distressed Ganesh as he had bought the vehicle on loan and the next instalment was coming up soon. He also had a scuffle with

gentina’s boss Lionel Scaloni spent almost a decade in Spain with various clubs, especially Deportivo La Coruna in their heyday. He met his wife in Spain, and took baby steps into coaching under Spain’s manager Luis de la Fuente. “Luis has been a huge help to those of us who did the coaching course in Las Rozas. I’ve had chats with him, and he helped us lads who did the (coaching) course in Las Rozas a great deal. I like the way he manages things and how the players give their all for him,” he said before Argentina’s quarter-final game against Egypt. Both have similar personalities, withdrawn and evasive of the limelight. Both were uncel-

Opp backs activist

as Jammu and Kashmir CM Omar Abdullah, SP MP Dimple Yadav, and the Leader of the Opposition in Kerala, Pinarayi Vijayan, also backed Wangchuk and targeted the Centre. Kejriwal — whose political rise is intrinsically linked to a similar civil society-led movement held a decade-and-a-half ago against corruption (the Anna Hazare-led India Against Corruption demonstration) — stood beside Wangchuk and urged PM Narendra Modi to replace Pradhan with the activist. Wangchuk, he said, was better suited to reform and lead the education system that had been hit by a series of paper leaks over the past few years. Calling Wangchuk “a great educationist”, Kejriwal said he had “worked tirelessly for the country and for Ladakh many times” and praised him for “risking his life for the country”. “When a child goes to write a competitive exam, it is not merely an exam; it is a dream. The child enters the exam hall believing that through hard work and intelligence he will build his future.”

Drawing from his own experience, Kejriwal said he had qualified for IIT at a time when exam leaks were unheard of. “I also appeared for IIT examination and studied at IIT. In those days, papers did not leak. I was thinking that had papers been leaking then, perhaps I would never have had the confidence to attempt the examination.” “My two children also graduated from IIT. Even during their time, the papers did not leak. But over the past few years, the way papers have begun leaking, the confidence of a child ... has begun to collapse. This is dangerous for the country.” Referring to the NEET controversy, Kejriwal alleged that successive investigations had failed to dismantle the networks responsible for paper leaks. “Every year, papers are leaked. The mastermind behind the 2024 NEET paper leak got bail. This has become a system: papers leak, a committee is formed, an investigation begins, an FIR is registered, arrests are made, bail is granted, and preparations begin for the next year’s exam. How long will the youth tolerate this? After the NEET paper leak, more than 20 children have died by suicide... But nothing changed.”

Kejriwal also criticised the handling of CBSE’s evaluation controversy, alleging that “they did not even file an FIR against the company responsible”. Warning that public anger over alleged irregularities in exams could have political consequences, Kejriwal drew a parallel with the Anna Hazare-led movement held at the same site in 2011. “Today, while coming here, I remembered April 4, 2011, when Anna Hazare was sitting here. The government of that time was also arrogant. an official, leading to the mobile phone the latter was carrying getting damaged. Soon after, Ganesh took some petrol out of his locked motorcycle, poured it on himself and set himself on fire. Ganesh’s brother Madan Nepali, who is four years older, says he is a civil engineer diploma holder but works as a labourer in Kathmandu, while their parents survive on the government’s social security dole. Their eldest brother died around 18 years ago. “We are Dalits and our parents are marginal farmers who sent us to the city to work honestly, pursue our studies and live with dignity... Ganesh was supporting his family with his earnings,” says Madan. The two brothers planned to visit their home in October for the festival of Dashain. Madan says they hoped to eventually go abroad, to the Gulf and finally Japan or South Korea after acquiring additional skills.

Rohit Sharma

after the England tour and they are moving on from him after this series. He wanted to continue, especially after working on his fitness. The selectors have left the ball in Sharma’s court,” said a source in the Indian board. It is learnt that Sharma spoke to a few BCCI officials on the sidelines of the England series, and the opener wasn’t happy with the decision. Sharma has already retired from T20Is, stepping away on June 29, 2024, hours after leading India to the World Cup title, and from Test cricket on May 7, 2025, a decision announced on Instagram ahead of India’s tour of England that summer. The selection committee removed Sharma as ODI captain

and Kylian Mbappe could unravel them. They made them utterly irrelevant, starving them of space and passing outlets. Only once in the seven games has their backbone been breached. This would be Argentina’s staunchest challenge -- to break Spain’s irresistible symphony. On the other hand, Argentina were stretched in every knockout game, surviving by the skin of their teeth. Every game, they flirted with the peril of crashing out. But somehow, they have discovered the courage and forged the spark to not surrender. Structurally, they could be flawed; in terms of personnel, they don’t match Spain;

Three years later, that government didn’t survive because of its arrogance,” he said. Later, in a post on X, Kejriwal reiterated his demand: “Sonam Wangchuk should be appointed as the country’s Education Minister by removing Dharmendra Pradhan.” In the first comment by a senior Congress leader in an official capacity, general secretary (organisation), K C Venugopal said the party had been demanding Pradhan’s resignation for over a month and a half. “We share the anguish and outrage that Shri Wangchuk ji feels, especially due to the lack of accountability within the Modi government — for the collapse of the examination system in particular,” he said. Appealing to Wangchuk to end his fast because of concerns about his health, he said, “His concerns are our concerns and those of other Opposition parties as well. Rest assured, we will continue to confront the Modi government and demand Education Minister’s resignation.”

In Srinagar, Omar Abdullah said politics must have room for compassion, as he hit out at the Centre for not approaching Wangchuk since he began his fast. Comparing the Congress-led government’s approach towards the Anna Hazare-led protest, he said then PM Manmohan Singh had sent his ministers to persuade protesters to end their strike. SP’s Dimple Yadav, who also visited Wangchuk at Jantar Mantar during the day, appealed to the Centre to show “alike sensitivity” and initiate a dialogue, saying compassion is central to Sanatan Dharma. In a Facebook post, Vijayan said the Centre was being indifferent not only to the anguish of the students but also to Wangchuk’s life. He urged the Centre not to allow the activist’s health to deteriorate further.

Apart from political leaders, several artistes have also spoken up in Wangchuk’s support. On Thursday, actor Sonakshi Sinha, whose father Shatrughan Sinha is an MP from West Bengal, uploaded a video message on her Instagram page backing the activist. “I have never made a public statement like this before, but I cannot stay silent any longer. We all know Sonam Wangchuk. We know what he has done for the country, his achievements, and the many honours he has received. For the past 18 days, he has been on a hunger strike without food. And why? Because he is fighting for the future of children, a future he believes is being pushed towards ruin... He may not know us personally, but despite that, he has chosen to sacrifice his own well-being for this country’s children. Yet so many people have remained silent. I couldn’t. Whatever happens now, so be it, but I can no longer stay quiet,” she said.

last year, replacing him with Shubman Gill. The panel, in consultation with the team management, is learnt to be keen on giving younger players a chance, keeping the future of Indian cricket in mind. Sharma’s ODI captaincy record includes leading India to the 2023 World Cup final, where the team’s all-out attacking approach from the top of the order redefined how India batted in the format. The following year, that same bold, aggressive template was carried over to India’s triumphant 2024 T20 World Cup campaign, also under his leadership. But Sharma has not been able to score runs in the past few games — he scored 26 runs off 47 balls in Cardiff on Thursday.

but they put their lives on the line to not lose. Argentina cannot be defeated until the whistle is blown. As England and Egypt would confess, they keep bouncing back. Scaloni summed up the philosophy that drives them: “This team plays best when facing adversity. The opponent hesitates a bit, we smell blood, and we go for it. That’s the feeling I’m left with.” At the heart of their comebacks has been the man who knows Spain better than most in Spain’s squad, the man Spain once coveted, the man who most Spaniards worship. But for one evening, they would want Messi to fail — and for one evening, Messi wouldn’t mind the tears of Spain.



Ushering in a New Era of Development in Chandigarh region



Inauguration of and Foundation Stone Laying for
Various Development Projects
worth ₹4700+ crore

by

Shri Narendra Modi
Hon'ble Prime Minister

Inauguration of

- Advanced Mother & Child Centre PGIMER, Chandigarh**
Quality Care for Mothers & Children
- Advanced Neurosciences Centre PGIMER, Chandigarh**
State-of-the-art Neurological Care
- Kurukshetra Boys Hostel & Mess Punjab Engineering College**
Enhanced Campus Living
- 6-Lane IT City Chowk to Kurali-Chandigarh Road**
Seamless Regional Connectivity
- Hostel Block Government College Sector-46**
Better Student Accommodation
- 240 Police Houses, Dhanas**
Secure Housing for Police Personnel

Foundation Stone Laying for

- PR-7 Spur from Ambala – Chandigarh (NH-205A)**
Enhancing Regional Mobility
- Critical Care Block PGIMER, Chandigarh**
Advanced Emergency & Critical Care
- Research Scholars' Hostel Punjab Engineering College**
Empowering Research and Innovation

July 17, 2026 | 11:30 AM

Punjab Engineering College, Chandigarh

LIVE TELECAST ON DD NEWS

Delhi's winter pollution plan: For last-mile delivery in city, cargo from diesel trucks to be transferred to EVs

Five logistics hubs around NCR to serve as freight interchange points

Sophiya Mathew
New Delhi, July 16

THOUSANDS OF diesel trucks are stopped at Delhi's borders every winter when pollution curbs under the Graded Response Action Plan (GRAP) kick in, prohibiting their entry. Now, a proposed network of five multimodal logistics hubs around the National Capital Region (NCR) could allow their cargo to continue its journey.

These hubs would serve as freight interchange points outside Delhi, where long-haul diesel trucks from neighbouring states would transfer their trailers or cargo to electric trucks for the final leg into the capital, *The Indian Express* has learnt. The plan aims to reduce freight emissions while improving logistics efficiency.

Proposed under the Centre's National Highways for EV (NHEV), a PPP initiative, they are planned at Sonapat, Faridabad, Ghaziabad, Greater Noida

and Gurgaon. In the initial phase, it aims to shift nearly half of the long-haul freight entering Delhi to the hub-and-spoke model. Abhijeet Sinha, Project Director at NHEV told *The Indian Express*, "The long-term objective is for diesel trucks to stop at the city's edge, with only zero-emission freight vehicles entering Delhi."

Officials said the phased approach addresses a recurring problem logistics operators face during severe air pollution episodes. Under Stage IV of GRAP, entry of diesel medium and heavy goods vehicles is restricted, except for those carrying essential commodities or meeting specified exemptions. This often leaves loaded trucks stranded outside the city and disrupts supply chains. The proposal comes amid growing concern over emissions from interstate freight traffic. A June study by IIT Delhi, TERI and the Air Pollution Action Group (APAG) found that nearly 17,000

heavy-duty trucks enter Delhi every day, making them one of the Capital's biggest yet least-addressed sources of transport pollution. While accounting for only a fraction of vehicles on the road, these trucks contribute about 23% of transport-sector Particulate Matter (PM) 2.5 emissions, with their impact rising sharply at night when most are allowed to enter the city.

Freight interchange

Each hub is proposed to be spread over around six to eight acres, including a core operational area of about five acres and additional space for truck parking. The first phase would involve land acquisition, construction of logistics infrastructure, and installation of charging stations for electric commercial vehicles, with operations expected to begin within the next 16-18 months. According to project officials, land parcels are currently being identified and earmarked for the facilities.

Officials associated with the project said the challenge is to secure the periphery and ensure no polluting truck enters Delhi through arterial roads. To



fix this, electronic enforcement systems are also being planned along these routes to ensure

Site assessment for hub being carried out at Hapur on Delhi-Lucknow highway. CREDIT: NHEV

that trucks required to use the freight hubs do not bypass them and enter Delhi directly.

Unlike conventional transshipment facilities, the proposed model is centred on a trailer-exchange system. This means a diesel tractor unit arriving at a logistics hub would detach its trailer, which would then be coupled to an electric tractor for onward movement into Delhi. Since trailers follow standard dimensions and

coupling systems, they can be hauled by tractor units from different manufacturers, such as Ashok Leyland or Tata Motors, without opening the container, officials said.

In cases where the consignee requires cargo to be segregated or delivered in smaller loads, the container can be opened at the logistics hub. These would be segregated and sorted according to destination and loaded onto smaller electric commercial vehicles, such as five-or six-tonne trucks, for last-mile deliveries, officials said. The project is currently in the planning stage, with officials expecting to submit the proposal to the government in October. This will be followed by a pilot in November to test both the operational and commercial aspects of the model, including trailer interchange, electronic enforcement and the pay-per-use pricing mechanism before wider implementation.

Project documents describe the facilities as integrated freight and energy hubs rather than standalone EV charging stations. Besides supporting trailer interchange and freight

consolidation, the hubs are expected to provide charging infrastructure for electric commercial vehicles, warehousing and logistics support, digital fleet management and other ancillary services.

Site selection is underway along major freight corridors leading to the capital. Earlier this month, officials from the NHEV Greenways project and the National Highways for EV Working Group, along with representatives of logistics company CJ Darcl Logistics Ltd, carried out a site assessment at Hapur on the Delhi-Lucknow highway to evaluate its suitability for a future multimodal logistics hub serving freight movement into the NCR.

Impact on pollution

As per the June study, 16,900 heavy-duty trucks enter Delhi each day, releasing an estimated 52 kg of PM 2.5, three tonnes of nitrogen oxides (NOx) and 2.5 tonnes of carbon monoxide (CO) daily. Older pre-BIS VI trucks, despite accounting for just 38 per cent of truck entries, contribute 62 per cent of PM 2.5 emissions from inter-

state freight, besides 87% of NOx and 95% of CO emissions.

Their impact is far greater during the night, when nearly three-fourths of interstate trucks enter the city because of entry restrictions. Between 10 pm and 7 am, heavy-duty trucks account for nearly 61 per cent of transport-related PM 2.5 emissions, with pollution concentrations further aggravated by lower atmospheric mixing heights during these hours.

The report had recommended establishing Urban Consolidation Centres at the city's periphery where freight from long-haul trucks can be transferred to cleaner vehicles such as electric or CNG trucks for last-mile distribution. It had also recommended deploying automated Weigh-in-Motion payload sensors along with AI-enabled ANPR cameras at toll plazas to improve enforcement, identify overloaded vehicles and ensure compliance with freight regulations. According to project officials, the proposed multimodal hubs are intended to complement such measures by creating an alternative freight ecosystem.

DRIVE FOR 14-YEAR-OLD GIRLS

New target for Health Dept: 1.49 lakh HPV vaccinations in 100 days

Vidheesha Kuntamalla
New Delhi, July 16

MORE THAN four months after India launched its nationwide Human Papillomavirus (HPV) vaccination programme for 14-year-old girls, Delhi has administered roughly 13,500 vaccine doses, prompting the state government to launch a renewed push in schools with an ambitious target of vaccinating 1.49 lakh girls over the next 100 days, *The Indian Express* has learnt.

Officials said the fresh target comes after the Health department reviewed the campaign's progress following its initial 90 days and concluded that deeper engagement with schools would be critical to accelerating coverage. "We decided to re-approach the Education department for its full cooperation at the school level. We are giving this initiative a renewed push since schools have now opened up after summer vacation. We aim to achieve 1.49 lakh vaccinations in 100 days," a Health department official said.

India rolled out its national HPV vaccination programme on February 28 to protect 14-year-old girls against cervical cancer, aiming to vaccinate nearly 1.15 crore girls annually.

Cervical cancer is the second most common cancer among women in India and remains one of the country's leading causes of cancer-related deaths among women.

While Delhi's coverage has steadily risen from around 11,000 doses reported in May to approximately 13,500 now, officials acknowledged that prog-

● HPV VACCINATION NUMBERS

13,500 GIRLS vaccinated in Delhi since the drive began on February 28. **Target:** 1.49 lakh vaccinations across Delhi in next 100 days.

- Campaign intensified in schools after reopening following summer vacation.
- Doctors, principals and DDEs mobilised to boost awareness and parental consent.



● HPV vaccine prevents cervical cancer, which leads to **1.2 lakh** new cases and nearly **80,000** deaths annually in India.

Real Creator IAS Edition https://t.me/+2RvD_RGf9mljMzg1
The department has also intensified its communication campaign to counter vaccine hesitancy, which officials continue to identify as one of the programme's biggest challenges. "We are circulating videos explaining the benefits of the vaccine and myth-busting misinformation. Many people have fears, so we are sharing videos of senior doctors explaining why people should not believe rumours," the official said.

The campaign will focus heavily on government schools, with health officials expecting classroom-based awareness sessions, counselling of parents and coordinated efforts between teachers and healthcare workers to improve vaccine uptake over the next three months.

Officials are also using testimonials from women who received HPV vaccines years ago to reassure parents. "We are showing videos of women and their success stories. Many who received the vaccine in 2009 have now given birth and are healthy," the official said.

With schools reopening, the Health department has once again reached out to Education authorities, holding both virtual and in-person meetings with deputy directors of education (DDEs) across districts as well as school principals. "We are personally and virtually interacting with each DDE in every zone and with principals to push the programme. Doctors from our department are visiting schools on the ground to spread awareness about HPV and the vaccine," the official said.

Real Creator IAS Edition <https://whatsapp.com/channel/0029Van2VRb6RGfOKH6oBd0F>

Ghaziabad man shoots father dead over property dispute

The deceased owned around 75 bighas of ancestral land, says family friend

Drishti Jain
Ghaziabad, July 16

A 52-YEAR-OLD farmer was allegedly shot dead by his 32-year-old son following a dispute over ancestral property in Ghaziabad's Modinagar late Wednesday, police said.

Assistant Commissioner of Police (Modinagar) Bhaskar Verma said Hari Om was shot dead at his residence and died at

the scene. Police have registered a case of murder under Section 103(1) of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS) against Nikhil, his son, who is absconding.

Hari Om owned around 75 bighas of ancestral land, a family friend told *The Indian Express*.

"The family also owned three shops along the Delhi-Meerut Expressway that had been rented out. One of the



Nikhil, the accused on the run

shops was rented for car repair work and the money used to go to Nikhil," the friend added.

In her complaint to the police, Hari Om's wife Meenakshi

(48) alleged that there had been a long-standing dispute between her husband and son over land.

According to police, preliminary investigation suggests that Nikhil had returned home allegedly under the influence of alcohol.

"Around 11 pm on Wednesday, an argument broke out between the two. My son, enraged, opened fire on my husband," Meenakshi said in her complaint, adding that after hearing the gunshots, she reached the spot and saw Nikhil holding a pistol.

"He fired three bullets in front of me, after which my husband fell to the ground. Nikhil then fled."

Police said Hari Om sustained four bullet injuries—two to the face, one to the chest, and one near the genital area. He was declared dead at the hospital.

According to the family friend, Nikhil had also opened fire on his younger brother in 2018. "But the matter was settled. Nikhil had developed a habit of drinking," he added.

Three police teams have been formed to trace him, ACP Verma said.

ACB busts extortion racket operating out of Delhi prisons, 6 jail wardens, asst superintendent among 11 arrested

Express News Service
New Delhi, July 16

THE ANTI-CORRUPTION Branch (ACB) of the Delhi government said on Thursday that it has busted an alleged extortion and bribery racket operating inside the prisons of the Capital, leading to the arrest of 11 people, including an Assistant Superintendent, six jail wardens, and two advocates.

Joint Commissioner of Police (ACB) Vikramjit Singh said the investigation had revealed "a well-organised criminal syndicate" allegedly involving jail officials, inmates, and advocates who worked together to extort money from the families of undertrial prisoners in return for illegal favours.

The ACB said the accused allegedly took bribes for ensuring the safety of the undertrial prisoners, and giving them preferential treatment.

The case originated from a complaint received on February

ACB said accused allegedly took bribes for ensuring the safety of the undertrial prisoners, and giving them preferential treatment

9 in which the complainant alleged that he was being forced to pay money to ensure the safety and comfort of his father and brother, both lodged as undertrial prisoners in a Rohini jail.

The FIR was registered and ACB laid a trap, said officers. Six accused were arrested.

They were Dinesh Dabas, Pankaj Kumar and Ravi Kumar, wardens posted at Rohini Jail; Jogender, head warden at Tihar Jail; advocate Manish and Ashish Rana, a Delhi resident. The agency said it recovered an alleged bribe amount of Rs 1 lakh.

The investigation subse-

quently expanded, with the ACB analysing bank accounts, financial transactions, mobile phone records and digital evidence, according to officers.

Investigators alleged that money collected through extortion was routed through bank accounts before being withdrawn in cash and distributed among syndicate members.

Based on the evidence collected during the investigation, the ACB arrested five more accused—Sunil Kumar, an Assistant Superintendent posted at Rohini Jail; Yogesh and Jagbir, both wardens at Rohini Jail; advocate Harender Bansal from Baghpat, Uttar Pradesh; and Viplove Khari, a Delhi resident.

Officers said the investigation is continuing to identify other members of the alleged syndicate, trace the complete money trail and establish the full extent of the conspiracy.

No response from the accused or their legal representatives was available.

● Rs 700-CRORE MEDICAL SUPPLIES FRAUD

Key accused flees India, had got anticipatory bail in extortion case days earlier

Nirbhay Thakur & Pragynesh
New Delhi, July 16

RAJIV RANGILA, a key accused in the Rs 700 crore medical supplies procurement fraud case being probed by the Delhi Anti Corruption Branch (ACB), secured anticipatory bail in an extortion case days before allegedly fleeing India, *The Indian Express* has learnt.

A pharmaceutical trader, as per the ACB, Rangila is a key conspirator in the case pertaining to medical procurement fraud within the Delhi Health department.

On June 30, he was granted anticipatory bail in a case of

personal enmity lodged in East Delhi's Laxmi Nagar police station for offences of voluntarily causing hurt, wrongful restraint, theft and criminal intimidation. Days later, according to ACB sources, he allegedly fled the country.

The extortion case pertained to allegations that Rangila and his family called the complainant to their house and wrongfully confined and assaulted him. It was also alleged that the mobile phone, car keys and wallet of the complainant were taken by the accused.

The Investigating Officer (IO) had submitted during court proceedings before a Vacation Judge that offences pun-

ishable under sections 127 and 308 (4) (wrongful confinement and extortion) of the BNS were added in the case.

While the IO opposed Rangila's pre-arrest bail plea citing that "extortion" charge had been added to the case, the officer opted not to file a reply to Rangila's application seeking protection from arrest.

"...considering that the maximum punishment for which the accused are facing the investigation in the present FIR is punishable up to three years imprisonment only and only allegation of offence punishable under Section 303 (2) of BNS, 2023 (theft) is punishable up to three years is non bail-

able and other allegations are bailable in nature, the court is of the considered view that... (this) entitles the accused/applicant the protection of anticipatory bail," Vacation Judge (Additional Sessions Judge) Ravindra Kumar Pandey of Karkardooma Court said in his order June 30.

The Judge added, "...the same is also maximum punishable up to seven years and further no record has been produced to show that the allegation of offence punishable under Section 127/308 (4) of BNS, 2023 were added or attracted in the facts and circumstances of the case."

As per the ACB's sub-

missions before a Delhi court, Rangila had multiple cases against him. His role in the medical supplies fraud case pertained to allegedly creating fake companies and firms using fictitious owners. He also allegedly colluded with manufacturers of medical equipment to fix supply rates and the kickbacks that were to be paid back in cash.

Police said Rangila had two cases registered against him in Laxmi Nagar police station. Officers, however, said that the extortion case didn't involve any medical equipment sale as such. It was related to personal enmity and non-payment of some dues, which the other party had "labelled" as extor-

tion. "These are rumours that he had a similar sale and purchase of medical equipment going on in Laxmi Nagar," a senior officer said.

The primary accused in the alleged Rs 700 crore medical procurement fraud include former Directorate General of Health Services (DGHS) chief Dr Vatsala Aggarwal, former Central Procurement Agency (CPA) Deputy Controller of Accounts Neeraj Chopra and Dr Vinod Kumar Ranga, the former Head of Office CPA. They had all been arrested by the ACB last month and are currently in judicial custody.

The case began with a Vigilance Department complaint

that was converted into an FIR on June 2, and revolves around widespread irregularities, manipulated tenders, and the siphoning of public funds meant for medicines, surgical items, and hospital equipment. The first arrest in the case came on June 18, almost two weeks before Rangila allegedly fled.

After the ACB served multiple notices to him and he failed to appear before it, raids and searches were launched across Delhi-NCR and Uttarakhand to locate him. Over eight places, including a small Laxmi Nagar shop, were searched during raids on July 2. When the ACB reached his house, they found that it was locked. Rangila

has multiple properties, including a farmhouse in Karnal and one property in Rishikesh, the ACB claimed.

The alleged irregularities in the 700 crore procurement fraud first came to light in May this year when the Vigilance Department conducted raids after receiving complaints at the offices of the CPA, which is the nodal agency responsible for procuring and supplying medicines, vaccines and medical equipment to Delhi government hospitals and healthcare facilities. Tender specifications and terms were allegedly drafted to favour chosen firms and fake companies were put on records to create confusion.

FUNDING TO BE RELEASED IN PHASES

Seed funding of up to Rs 10L for students in new start-up policy

Gayathri Mani
New Delhi, July 16

IN WHAT has been pitched as a first-of-its kind move on a large scale, students studying in government schools and government-funded colleges and institutions in the Capital will be eligible for seed funding of up to Rs 10 lakh to launch their entrepreneurial ventures under the Start-Up and Incubation policy approved by the Delhi government, officials said on Thursday. “Our government will invest Rs 400 crore in the policy over the next five years. The policy is not just to help people launch start-ups, but to transform Delhi’s youth from job seekers into job creators,” Chief Minister Rekha Gupta said.

The CM said the policy will be implemented across 11 state universities, 13 government-funded colleges, polytechnic institutes, and Industrial Training Institutes (ITIs) and Delhi government schools.

She added that the policy aims to build a strong innovation ecosystem across the educational institutions of the Capital. The alumni of Delhi government schools will also be eligible to secure seed funding under this policy.

Education Minister Ashish Sood said, “This policy is not for general public...the aim is to help students develop and incubate their ideas at an early level, so that by the time they pass out from schools and college, they become job providers...by handholding students at every stage from guiding them from idea stage to developing prototype till they take patent for their innovation.”

Industries Minister Manjinder Singh Sirsa underlined that the student-focussed policy promises “Rs 10 lakh fund in different stages of their projects growth.”

Incubation centres, annual fairs

As per officials, this will be a first-of-its kind policy focused

● Key highlights

- To be implemented in 11 state universities, 13 government-aided colleges, ITIs and polytechnic institutions
- Only for students, not general public, says government

₹ 400 cr

Total budget allocation

₹ 40 cr

Budget allocation for incubation centres



on students with the Delhi government investing on a large-scale.

Under the policy, officials added, the government also plans to strengthen incubation centers in schools and colleges. Besides, new incubation centers will be set up at the colleges and school campuses to nurture ideas among students and help them execute it.

The CM said the government will provide one-time financial assistance to eligible institutions for setting up and strengthening incubation centres.

In addition, these centres will receive annual operational support for mentoring, networking, innovation activities and the overall development of the start-up ecosystem.

“Start-ups associated with these incubation centres will receive financial assistance at different stages of their growth. The support will cover various phases, including prototype development, proof of concept, product development, market validation and commercialisation, enabling promising ideas to grow into successful enterprises,” she said.

Incubation centres will provide young entrepreneurs with modern infrastructure, expert mentoring, business advisory services, intellectual property support, access to laboratories and testing facilities, as well as opportunities to connect with investors and industry, the Chief

Minister said.

Under the policy, the government will also organise an Annual ‘Delhi Start-up Youth Festival’ to bring together young innovators, educational institutions, start-ups, investors, industry representatives and policymakers on a common platform to showcase new ideas, build partnerships and inspire entrepreneurship among the youth.

Further, a State Incubation Policy Monitoring Committee (SIPMC) will be set up comprising members from government, educational institutions and industry, to oversee the implementation of the policy.

Govt attacks AAP

The previous AAP government had also floated a start-up policy but it never took off. However, it implemented Business Blasters scheme in schools for students in 2021 under which students studying in Class XI and XII were to be given Rs 2,000 to start their businesses under Entrepreneurship Mind-set Curriculum.

Later, the AAP government announced in the 2024-25 Budget that this scheme will be expanded to universities and ITIs and allocated Rs 15 crore.

Attacking the previous government, however, Education Minister Sood said, “As per the records and files that we have seen, the previous AAP government did nothing but publicity. Its scheme started in 2021 and ended in 2022. The entire budget allocated for the project was Rs 22 crore, whereas our budget for this policy is Rs 400 crore. It is a full-fledged policy that aims to develop and nurture young minds and their ideas, and help them become future business leaders and entrepreneurs.”

He added that students can draw inspiration for innovative ideas related to new age technologies such as Artificial Intelligence and drones will be welcome and the government will support them.

Govt plans to rope in hotel chains to operate and maintain Kejriwal’s former Civil Lines bungalow

Gayathri Mani
New Delhi, July 16

MOVING FORWARD with its plan to develop former Chief Minister Arvind Kejriwal’s official residence at 6, Flagstaff Road, as a state guest house-cum-cultural centre, the Delhi Government has asked the Public Works Department (PWD) to explore plans to rope in top hotel chains to operate and maintain the property, which the BJP had dubbed as ‘Sheesh Mahal’.

Officials said the PWD has also been asked to complete the unfinished camp office located next to the bungalow located in Civil Lines.

“The previous AAP government was building a two-storey building as a camp office. The broad structure has been constructed but after a Vigilance inquiry was initiated into the alleged irregularities in relation to the renovation of the former CM’s residence, the work remained incomplete,” a senior official said.

“Interior works like painting and electrical works, among others, are pending... The PWD



The 6, Flagstaff Road bungalow in New Delhi. FILE

now has been asked to complete the work so that it can be used to host people and hold conferences or meetings as part of the state guest house plan,” the official added.

PWD Minister Parvesh Sahib Singh said that instead of handing over the bungalow to any corporation, the government is exploring options to partner with top hotel and hospitality chains that can professionally manage and run the property.

Maintaining that project will help the government generate

revenue, he said, “The PWD has been directed to come up with a plan. Discussions are going on to rope in professional players, so that it can be developed and managed professionally.”

“The main residence (bungalow) does not require that much work but the other one (camp office) requires interior work... Also, there are plans to build a conference room, a boarding facility, a restaurant or a cafeteria where visitors from here and abroad can stay and have food... they can also participate in events...”



Day 19 of Sonam Wangchuk hunger strike

Samajwadi Party MP Dimple Yadav interacts with climate activist Sonam Wangchuk during his hunger strike at Jantar Mantar in New Delhi on Thursday. Cockroach Janata Party founder Abhijeet Dipke, SP MLA Ragini Sonkar and others can also be seen. PTI

Day after 3-yr-old found dead in drain, man arrested for murder

Express News Service
New Delhi, July 16

A DAY after the body of a three-year-old girl was found in a drain in South West Delhi, a 37-year-old man accused of killing her was arrested on Thursday following an exchange of gunfire, said police. The man lived in the same area as the child, officers added.

The child went missing on July 10 and her body was found in a drain in the early hours of

July 15, according to officers.

Chandan Kumar, the accused, allegedly told police that he killed the child and threw away the body in a drain. The motive behind the crime is still being investigated, said officers.

According to police, information regarding the disappearance of the three-year-old girl was received on the evening of July 10. A case under Section 137(2) of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS), was

lodged and an investigation was initiated. During the intervening night of July 14 and 15, police received information about the recovery of a child’s body.

A Crime Branch team and forensic experts inspected the spot, while the post-mortem examination confirmed that the child had been murdered before her body was dumped in the drain. “During the investigation, police analysed CCTV footage from the area and

identified Chandan as a suspect after finding his movements suspicious. Acting on the leads, a police team raided his hideout on Thursday,” said DCP Amit Goel.

Police said the accused opened fire when officers attempted to apprehend him in the early hours of Thursday. In retaliation, the police fired one round, injuring him in the left leg. He was overpowered and

taken into custody, said officers. A country-made pistol and one live cartridge were recovered from his possession.

He was shifted to a hospital for treatment following his arrest. The accused is a tailor. His wife and son reside in his native village in Ballia. Police said further investigation is underway, while appropriate legal action is being taken in accordance with law.

Muslim man assault case: After SC rap, Noida Police invokes hate crime charges

Vineet Bhalla
New Delhi, July 16

ACTIONING ON Supreme Court’s directions, the Noida Police has filed a supplementary charge-sheet invoking hate crime charges against five men accused of assaulting and robbing a 62-year-old Muslim man in 2021.

During a hearing on July 14, Additional Solicitor General K M Nataraj informed a bench of Justices Vikram Nath and Sandeep Mehta that the investigating officer’s report has been forwarded to the state government for prosecution sanction. The court granted the Uttar Pradesh government four weeks to secure this approval.

The supplementary charge-sheet invokes sections 153B, which punishes imputations prejudicial to national integration, and 295A that criminalises deliberate acts intended to outrage religious feelings, of the Indian Penal Code.

It details the statement of Kazeem Ahmad Sherwani, who testified during investigation that he was offered a shared car ride to Aligarh from Noida on July 4, 2021. Once inside the car, the accused allegedly locked the doors and beat him.

According to Sherwani, the attackers called him a “mulla”, repeatedly pulled his beard, removed his skull cap and stripped him naked. The driver allegedly told an accomplice to “gouge out this Mulla’s eyes” with a screwdriver, which struck Sherwani’s nose, before they robbed him of Rs 1,200.

The inclusion of these charges marks a reversal for the police. Although the alleged attack took place in July 2021, the police initially did not register a first information report (FIR). This prompted Sherwani to approach the Supreme Court.

HC lawyers call off strike over jurisdiction concerns

Sohini Ghosh
New Delhi, July 16

THE DELHI High Court Bar Association (DHCBA) on Thursday suspended its call for abstention from work even as several lawyers, predominantly practicing intellectual property (IP) law, continued to flag concerns over the proposed enhancement of the pecuniary jurisdiction of Delhi’s district courts from the present Rs 2 crore to Rs 10 crore.

Pecuniary jurisdiction refers to the limit on the authority of a court to hear a case based on the monetary value of the matter in dispute. It ensures that a court that is lower in a hierarchy of courts cannot take up a case involving a property of value exceeding a specified ceiling or cap.

Lawyers from the High Court had abstained from ap-

pearing before courts for three consecutive days since July 14. The thaw in the abstention from work comes after the members of the association met Union Law Minister Arjun Ram Meghwal on Thursday. The DHCBA was also called upon and assured by Chief Justice DK Upadhyaya that their concerns, submitted as a representation, shall be considered.

Several senior advocates also have flagged a lack of in-depth consultation process.

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Interested agencies are requested to visit the website, www.csmaiaadaniiairports.com and obtain the EOI documents. EOI documents shall be available for download till 5:00 pm IST on 27th July 2026.

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The Bidders may obtain the RFP documents on all working days between 10:30 hrs (IST) and 16:00 hrs (IST) from 17.07.2026 to one working day prior to bid submission for the project mentioned below on payment of a non-refundable fee of Rs. 5,00,000/- or USD 7,000 plus applicable GST @18% from 9th Floor, Wing – A, Statesman House, Connaught Place, New Delhi - 110001, Tel.: 91-11-23443996; e-mail: pfccl.itp@pfcindia.com. The RFP documents can also be downloaded from <https://www.mscccommerce.com> and <https://www.pfcclindia.com>, however, in such case, interested party can submit Response to RFP only on submission of non-refundable fee of Rs. 5,00,000/- or USD 7,000 plus applicable GST @18% separately. The survey report and clarification to RFP documents shall be issued to those bidders, who have obtained/ purchased RFP documents by paying requisite fee at least one working day prior to bid submission date. Bidders should regularly visit website to keep themselves updated regarding clarifications/ amendments/ time extensions etc., if any. The important timelines in this regard are as follows:

S. No.	Name of Transmission Scheme	Last Date for seeking clarifications (dd/mm/yyyy)	Last Date for submission of response to RFP (dd/mm/yyyy)	Date of opening of Response to RFP (dd/mm/yyyy)
1.	Transmission Scheme for establishment of 400/220 kV AIS Malegaon Saundane SS, Dist (Nashik)	06.08.2026	18.09.2026 up to 15:00 hrs (IST)	18.09.2026 up to 15:30 hrs (IST)

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State Transmission Utility Maharashtra

GOVERNMENT OF TELANGANA
DEPARTMENT OF EMPLOYMENT & TRAINING
ITI Mallegally Campus, 1st Floor, Vijayanagar Colony, Mallegally Hyderabad - 500057
Phone No. 040-23221705 E-mail: cettelangana@gmail.com
No: PM-SETU/3427/2024 Date: -07-2026
REQUEST FOR PROPOSAL (RFP) NOTIFICATION
(Through e-Procurement Portal)
Department of Employment and Training invites Request for Proposal (RFP) from Anchor Industry Partners (AIP) interested in Collaborating on the Upgradation of 6 HUB and 24 SPOKE ITI Institutions in the State under the Centrally Sponsored Scheme PM-SETU (Pradhan Mantri Skilling and Employability Transformation through Upgraded (ITIs) - Component-I: Upgradation of Industrial Training Institutes (ITIs). This Request For Proposal (RFP) is issued in accordance with the Government of Telangana's e-Procurement Portal.
The Request for Proposal (RFP) document for another three (3) clusters can be downloaded from the Telangana e-Procurement Portal starting from 13-07-2026. The last date for uploading the completed RFP along with supporting documents through the e-Procurement Portal is 28-07-2026 before 5:00 P.M. The corresponding Tender IDs are: 716412, 716415 and 716418.
For more information, please visit the Website: <https://etenders.telangana.gov.in> For assistance, you may contact: 040-23221 705/ or visit the office in person during working hours.
Sd/- **A.KANTHI WESLEY**
DIRECTOR
Dept. of Employment & Training
DIPR R.O.No.320-PP/CL-AGENCY/2026-27 Dt:16-07-2026

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(Dr Savita Arora)
Director, DSCI
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F. No. 4/1/2020-RE
Government of India
Ministry of Finance
Department of Economic Affairs
(Financial Markets Division)
Filling up one post of Whole-Time Member in International Financial Services Centres Authority
The Government of India invites applications from the eligible candidates for filling up **one post of Whole-Time Member in International Financial Services Centres Authority, Gandhinagar, Gujarat.** The Whole-Time Member shall have an option to receive pay as admissible to an Additional Secretary to the Government of India or a consolidated salary of Rupees Five Lakh (Rs. 5,00,000/-) per month.
The particulars of the post and eligibility conditions may be seen on the Ministry's website at <https://dea.gov.in/offerrings-vacancies> under **Department of Economic Affairs.**
Applications of eligible candidates in the prescribed proforma along with certified copies of required documents may be forwarded, through proper channel (wherever applicable) so as to reach to the undersigned in the **Department of Economic Affairs, Ministry of Finance, Room No. 10042, Kartavya Bhavan-1, New Delhi-110001 on or before 14th August, 2026**
Incomplete applications and applications received after the last date shall not be considered.
Sd/-
Deputy Secretary to the Govt. of India
Tel: 011-2401 3064
CBC 15201/11/0003/2627



History Lessons

AFTER STAYING silent on Sonam Wangchuk's hunger strike over the NEET controversy, the Congress on Thursday extended its support to the activist on the 19th day of his fast. Congress general secretary, organisation, K C Venugopal assured Wangchuk that the Congress will confront the Narendra Modi government and demand the resignation of the Education Minister. Sources said it was Sonia Gandhi who wanted the party to back Wangchuk even though a section of Congress leaders was sceptical about joining the activist or the Cockroach Janata Party on the issue. Gandhi, party insiders said, pointed out that in 1984, the then PM, Indira Gandhi, had flown to Leh to meet Wangchuk's father Sonam Wangyal, who was on a hunger strike seeking Scheduled Tribe status for Ladakhis. Indira had persuaded Wangyal to end the hunger strike.

To Err Is Humour

A SLIP of the tongue during the announcement of Samajwadi Party MP Dimple Yadav's arrival on the stage, where activist Sonam Wangchuk is sitting on a hunger strike, lightened the sombre mood at Jantar Mantar for a moment. As she walked towards Wangchuk with other senior SP leaders, the Mainpuri MP was mistakenly introduced as "yuva MP Dimple Kapadia", before being corrected by the crowd. The announcer tried to make up for the error by repeating her name several times, eliciting laughter from the youth protesting at the site.

Catch 'Em Young

UNION JAL Shakti Minister C R Patil has launched a unique initiative to promote awareness about water conservation among school-children. As part of the campaign, notebooks featuring a photo of PM Narendra Modi and a message encouraging water conservation are being distributed to students in villages along the banks of the Ganga in Uttar Pradesh. The notebook focuses especially on Varanasi, which is also PM Modi's constituency. Earlier, the ministry had launched the Jal Sanchay Jan Bhagidari campaign following PM Modi's call for greater community participation in water conservation efforts.

NCP reunion buzz back: Tatkare says talks halted after Ajit Pawar's death

Alok Deshpande
Mumbai, July 16

REIGNITING TALK of a merger of the Nationalist Congress Party (NCP) and the NCP (SP), the former's state chief Sunil Tatkare said Thursday that the Sharad Pawar-led party had stopped the reunification process after Ajit Pawar's death earlier this year and that it would express its opinion if the talks restart.

The comments came a day after Tatkare's meeting with Maharashtra Deputy Chief Minister and NCP national president Sunetra Pawar, Ajit's wife, ended on a sour note. Sunetra, it is learnt, asked Tatkare why he and NCP working president Praful Patel didn't inform her about their meeting with CM Devendra Fadnis late Tuesday night. NCP (SP) senior MLA Jayant Patil's presence at the CM's Mumbai home, Varsha, Tuesday night fuelled speculation about the merger being back on the table.

The NCP had split in 2023, when the late Ajit broke away with a majority of MLAs to join the BJP-led Mahayuti alliance. However, since his death in an aircraft crash in January, there has been speculation about the two NCPs reuniting. This has played out amid a buzz about Sunetra facing pushback from the old guard as she and her son try to assert control over the organ-



NCP state chief Sunil Tatkare

isation. "Both parties discussed the merger when Ajit Pawar was alive. We would have supported the merger decision to be taken by him. But after his death, the talks stopped. Their (NCP-SP) leaders later, at their state-level programme, announced that the issue of merger is over for them. If the talks start again, only then can we tell our opinion," according to Tatkare.

This is the first time a senior NCP leader has publicly acknowledged that the merger of the two parties was set to happen and that Ajit was on board with it. The day after Ajit's death, *The Indian Express* reported that the two NCPs were set to make the reunification announcement on February 8 before the tragedy struck. The talks were at an advanced stage at the time and leaders from the two sides were preparing the ground for a formal reunification following the Zilla Parishad poll results. Asked about the status of the merger talks, Patil said, "We repeatedly

E. EXPLAINED

Turbulence in the party

The turbulence in the NCP has been brewing since Ajit Pawar died in an aircraft crash earlier this year. Sunetra Pawar has tried to hold on to the organisation along with her sons. However, this has led to friction between her and the senior leadership. Murmurs among MLAs also indicate that merger could energise the party, but no one has officially raised the matter with the leadership.

said after the unfortunate death of Ajit Pawar that the merger talks were almost concluded. We were not taken seriously back then. I don't think any proposal has gone from our side."

Patil said he would meet Deputy CM Eknath Shinde Thursday night to raise the issue of the disqualification of a municipal council chairman in his constituency. He claimed to have raised the matter at the Tuesday meeting with Fadnis.

Asked about the meeting at Varsha, Tatkare said, "We had gone to discuss work related to

our constituency. We did not meet Jayant Patil there." He, however, denied reports of a rift with Sunetra Pawar. "I had a very good equation with Ajit dada and I share the same with Sunetra vahini (sister-in-law). There is no question of miscommunication or her being upset with me for anything," he said.

Sources, however, said that at a meeting with Tatkare Wednesday, Sunetra expressed unhappiness at being kept out of the loop about the meeting at the CM's home. Tatkare told Sunetra that he and Patel met Fadnis after coming to know that the NCP(SP) might support the Delimitation Bill. They wanted to ensure there's no miscommunication between the CM and their party. Tatkare is learnt to have told Sunetra. "She asked why neither of the two thought it was important to let her know in advance about it," a source said.

Divided into 2 camps

The NCP increasingly looks fractured, with one group clinging on to the Pawars — Sunetra and her sons — because they are the ones at the helm and in power and the other feelings sidelined after the emergence of Parth Pawar, the Deputy CM's elder son. Sources close to Sunetra have hinted that Parth is looking to replace Tatkare with one of the MLAs from north Ma-

harashtra, while Tatkare has maintained that he will continue to head the party in the state.

The party has also decided it will not respond to the legal notice from its national secretary Sachchidanand Singh challenging Sunetra's appointment as NCP national president. "It is unnecessary to even respond to it. If there is any malafide intention behind sending this notice, let that be out in the open after we decide not to respond to it," said a source close to the Pawars.

The infighting and lack of communication in NCP have left the organisation hamstrung, with several key appointments kept on hold. It doesn't have presidents for the youth and women's wings. It has failed to appoint a new chairperson for the state Women's Commission after Rupali Chakankar's resignation. The finance portfolio that it had been assured of also appears to be out of reach now. Ajit used to hold the portfolio, but after his death the department's responsibility was taken up by Fadnis. Murmurs among the MLAs also indicate that the merger of the two NCPs could energise the party, but no one has officially raised the matter with the leadership. Sources informed that unless the Pawar family reaches a consensus on the leadership issue, things are unlikely to move forward.



Former Punjab Chief Minister Charanjit Singh Channi at the Congress headquarters in New Delhi on Thursday. ANIL SHARMA

Cong refuses to blink, Channi says 'will abide by party decision'

Man Aman Singh Chhina
Chandigarh, July 16

WITH THE Congress refusing to blink on the issue of Punjab leadership, former chief minister Charanjit Singh Channi and former deputy chief minister Sukhjinder Singh Randhawa on Thursday professed adherence to the party high command's decision.

"All is well. We are with the party and will obey all the directions of the party high command," Channi said. He was talking to reporters in Delhi after a meeting with AICC general secretary (Organisation) K C Venugopal. Apart from Channi and Randhawa, MLAs Pargat Singh and Rana Gurjeet Singh too attended the meeting that lasted around three hours.

Channi, and the others who owe allegiance to him, had been sulking after the high command asked Amrinder Singh Raja Warring to continue as party's Punjab unit chief ahead of Assembly polls in the state early next year. "We were called here today and have put across our point of view. I want to make one thing absolutely clear and that is that we stand with the party. Rahul Gandhi is our leader, we love him and we will live and die with him. Mallikarjun Kharge is

our party president and all our workers and leaders stand firmly with the party and will continue to do," Channi said.

He also sought to scotch any speculation on the widening rift within the party in Punjab. "There has been an unnecessary media trial. We had no intention of embarrassing anyone or belittling anyone. We want to take the party forward. The high command heard us and whatever decision it takes, we will accept it and move forward accordingly," he said, adding that when "we held the meeting in Chandigarh, our only intention was to put across our point of view to Bhupesh Baghel ji".

With voices of dissent getting stronger after Warring was retained as PPCC chief, the central leadership had rushed Baghel to Punjab where he stayed for six days, met the leaders, and gave a report to Venugopal in Delhi on Wednesday. Baghel had also indicated status quo in Punjab leadership change "is not a game of puppets". Sources in Congress say that the riot act was read out to the dissident leaders and it was made clear to them that they will have to obey the decisions of the high command. It was also conveyed to them that their public statements were showing party in poor light.

EXPRESS special Hydrogen Train rolls out today; leak detectors, auto shutdown, real-time monitoring on track

Express News Service
Chandigarh, July 16

INDIA'S FIRST hydrogen-powered train, to be flagged off by Prime Minister Narendra Modi from Haryana's Jind railway station Friday, has multiple layers of safety features that can detect gas leak, heat, and smoke, and an automatic shut-off system that will cut off the hydrogen supply, without waiting for manual reaction, in case anything unusual is found.

"The train is fitted with devices that continuously watch for hydrogen leaks, unusual heat, flames or smoke, so any problem is caught within seconds. On top of this, non-stop ventilation keeps air moving through the train at all times, so that even if a tiny amount of hydrogen were to leak, it gets safely carried away and diluted in the open air instead of collecting anywhere," a statement issued by the Ministry of Railways read. "There is also an automatic shut-off system. If anything unusual is detected, it can automatically cut off the hydrogen supply on its own, without waiting for a person to react."

With the launch of the 10-coach train, which will operate between Jind and Sonipat section of Northern Railway, India will join a select group of nations that has adopted the clean technology. "India becomes one of



X/ @RAILMININDIA

The train has 10 coaches with a capacity of 2,600 passengers

Real Creator IAS Edition https://t.me/+2RvD_RGf9mljMzg1

the select group of nations that have such trains. This will go a long way in ensuring that India adopts clean technology in the railway sector," Modi said. Unlike electric trains that draw power from overhead wires, the Hydrogen Fuel Cell Trainset generates electricity on board through a Proton Exchange Membrane (PEM) fuel cell. Hydrogen stored in cylinders reacts with oxygen from the atmosphere to produce electricity for the traction motors, with water vapour and heat as the only direct by-products.

"In a sense, the train carries its own source of power, but instead of burning traditional fuels, generates electricity using oxygen from the atmosphere," as per the ministry's statement. As electricity is generated on board through clean hydrogen technology, the train represents the greenest form of

Real Creator IAS Edition <https://whatsapp.com/channel/0029Van2VRb6RGJOXK6b8Df>

Mann to receive PM, skip event

Chandigarh: Punjab Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann will receive Prime Minister Narendra Modi "as per the protocol" in Chandigarh Friday, but is unlikely to attend an official function in Jalandhar where the PM will lay the foundation stone of rail and road infrastructure projects worth over Rs 5,470 crore.

The ruling AAP's lone Rajya Sabha member from state and environmentalist Balbir Singh Seechewal will, however, attend the PM's Jalandhar event. The PM's helicopter is likely to land at Rajindra Park, Chandigarh, located opposite the CM's house. From there Modi will proceed to the PGIMER before leaving for Jalandhar. "The Chief Minister will receive the Prime Minister at Rajindra Park and fulfil the protocol. Beyond that, however, the Chief Minister is unlikely to travel to Jalandhar," a senior official said. KANCHAN VASDEV

Jind-Sonipat route. The train has 10 coaches with a capacity of around 2,600 passengers, demonstrating the scalability of hydrogen-powered rail transport for high-capacity passenger operations on non-electrified or difficult-to-electrify routes.

Koel Mallick took oath as TMC Rajya Sabha MP on April 6. FILE

TMC's Koel Mallick resigns from Rajya Sabha, meets Bhupender Yadav

Ravik Bhattacharya
Kolkata, July 16

AMID THE exodus of leaders from the Mamata Banerjee-led TMC, actor Koel Mallick resigned as the party's Rajya Sabha MP Thursday, three months after being nominated to the Upper House of Parliament.

Shortly after, she met Union Minister and BJP veteran Bhupender Yadav at his home in Delhi, sparking a buzz about her next move. Mallick is the fourth Rajya Sabha MP to quit after Sukhendu Sekhar Ray, Sushmita Dev and Prakash Chik Baraik, who joined the BJP earlier this month. Later, the BJP nominated them for the election to the three seats they vacated.

Reacting to Mallick's resignation, Banerjee, without naming her, said those who are leaving have "pressure of CBI, ED and police cases" and urged that "those who want to leave should do so before July 21 (Martyrs' Day)".

PM speaks to Amir of Qatar, conveys condolences on passing of the Father Amir

Express News Service
New Delhi, July 16

PRIME MINISTER Narendra Modi on Thursday spoke to the Amir of Qatar, Sheikh Tamim bin Hamad Al Thani, and conveyed his heartfelt condolences on the passing of the Father Amir, Sheikh Hamad bin Khalifa Al Thani.

Modi also said the departed leader's enduring legacy will continue to guide the two nations for further strengthening the strategic partnership. Father Amir died on July 12 at the age of 74. After his death, the Central government had declared one-day national mourning on July 13 as a mark of respect, with the national flag flown at half-mast throughout the country.

"Spoke with H.H. Sheikh Tamim bin Hamad Al Thani, the Amir of Qatar and conveyed heartfelt condolences on the

passing of H.H. the Father Amir, Sheikh Hamad bin Khalifa Al Thani. Recalled his deep affection for India, his warmth towards the Indian community in Qatar and his steadfast commitment to India-Qatar relations. His enduring legacy will continue to guide our two countries as we further strengthen our Strategic Partnership," Modi said in a post on X.

Recalling the Father Amir's contributions as the chief architect of modern Qatar, "Prime Minister paid tribute to his visionary leadership, and recalled his pivotal role in strengthening India-Qatar relations over the years as well as his deep affection for India and the Indian community in Qatar," the PMO said. It also said the Amir of Qatar thanked the PM for his call and conveyed his appreciation for the words of support in this difficult hour.

Channi, Satluj & ghosts of Punjab's past: A note of pre-poll caution for parties



IN THE past couple of weeks, "Channi" and "Satluj" have dominated Punjab's political lexicon and are likely to play a role in shaping the poll narrative in the state ahead of Assembly elections early next year. However, amid the churn triggered by the two, there is something that all parties vying to capture power in the state must bear in mind: they are dealing with a sensitive border state at a time when the neighbourhood is unsettled and the global order equally uncertain. Both may damage the prospects of the Congress in a state that, like Kerala, has been a low-hanging fruit for the party. That is, unless the Congress displays flexibility and brings on board Charanjit Singh Channi, its

miffed former Chief Minister who wants to be the person at the helm of the party leading into the elections.

Channi became Punjab's first Dalit CM in September 2021, only four months before the elections were due. In a scramble to decide who would be CM, his name was virtually pulled out of the hat following Captain Amarinder Singh's resignation. Singh, the Raja of Patiala, had become the target of attacks led by former cricketer Navjot Singh Sidhu that, according to several insiders, were encouraged by the high command.

Thanks to its warring factions, the Congress failed to capitalise on the historic moment of having a Dalit CM. Until Channi came along, the state had seen CMs from only the Jat Sikh community. While Sikhs comprise 58% of Punjab's population, as per the last Census, Dalits number around 32%, the largest number in any state. However, the appointment left the party in disarray and the AAP swept the 2022 election, with Channi losing both the constituencies he

contested. He went into hibernation but resurfaced ahead of the 2024 Lok Sabha elections, which he won from Jalandhar.

And now, he has suddenly mobilised several state leaders to stand by him as he tries to push the high command into handing over the party's reins in Punjab once more before elections. Channi's detractors in the Congress see the BJP's hand behind his recalcitrance to accept the high command's decision not to change the state leadership so close to yet another election. Whether he moves to the BJP or breaks away from the Congress to float a new party, either move will hurt the Congress.

Today's Channi is not what he was five years ago. This time, the Punjab election may hinge on how Hindus (40%) and the Dalits (32%) vote. And that is a constituency the BJP is angling for. To spurn a Dalit in Punjab could also have national consequences. Channi is a Ramadasia — there are other communities such as the Mazhabis and Ravidasias in Punjab — and it could affect the Congress's standing



People at a screening of *Satluj*, in Amritsar last week. ANI FILE

with Dalits in other states, particularly when Rahul Gandhi's caste census-driven politics revolves around Dalits and the Other Backward Classes (OBCs).

Satluj controversy

The controversy triggered by the decision to pull the Diljit Dosanjh-starrer *Satluj* from the OTT platform Zee5 may also leave its imprint on Punjab politics in the run-up to the elections. The film is based on an ugly and painful reality of the militancy years of the 1980s and

90s: the deaths in police encounters during anti-terror operations and the disappearance of thousands who were secretly cremated as "lawaris (unclaimed)". The film's protagonist is Jaswant Singh Khaira, a bank employee who documented these disappearances — he put forward the figure of 25,000 that is disputed by many — and died in police custody himself.

Every filmmaker views events through his or her creative, artistic, or ideological lens — or a combination of these —

and an open society is expected to ride the differences of opinion such a work may unleash. Every filmmaker is also selective in the choice of what she or he includes or excludes. In the case of *Satluj*, it is the papering over of the other side of the story that stands out. The film does not allude to the cold-blooded killings by the Khalistani terrorists, be it the gruesome death of DIG AS Atwal at the entrance of the Golden Temple in 1983; the gunning down of Ramesh Chander, the chief editor of the Hind Samachar group of newspapers, in 1984; or several instances of the singling out and killing of Hindus travelling in public transport.

The ban on the film, however, has added to its allure and it is being screened in the villages of Punjab and has become a talking point. The AAP has demanded its release on the grounds of free speech, while the Shiromani Akali Dal of the Badals has promised to take it to every corner of Punjab in the hope of winning over the young Jat Sikhs. And yet, if the film resonates with them, they are

more likely to veer towards the pro-Khalistani Akali Dal (Waris Punjab De) headed by Khadour Sahib MP Amritpal Singh, who is in jail at present. The Congress's discomfiture is apparent even as it has spoken up for freedom of expression, even though the film focuses on police excesses during Congress rule.

By taking down *Satluj*, the BJP may hope to get the support of all those who never want Punjab to return to those dark days, particularly Hindus. It is of late that the BJP has turned its attention to winning Punjab, where its standing suffered during the farmers' agitation of 2020-21. It has been quietly attempting to create a village-level cadre, and if a multi-party contest leads to a hung Assembly, it can hope to emerge as the kingmaker.

The Punjab lesson

The Punjab story is about competitive politics. It was the Congress in the late 1970s that encouraged a charismatic small-time preacher called Jarnail Singh Bhindranwale to counter the Akali Dal. And

when he grew too big, running a parallel government and occupying the Golden Temple, the Congress could not dismount the tiger it had mounted. The Army had to enter the Golden Temple to flush him out.

The chain of events that were triggered led to Prime Minister Indira Gandhi's assassination by her own Sikh bodyguards, the anti-Sikh riots and reprisal killings in north India, the strengthening of the insurgency that claimed the life of an incumbent Chief Minister (Beant Singh was assassinated in 1995), a leading editor, senior police officers, and thousands of innocent people. Competitive politics is a tempting proposition for parties. But in Punjab, they must think it through many times before crossing the *lakshman rekhas*.

Neeraja Chowdhury,
Contributing Editor,
The Indian Express, has covered the last 11 Lok Sabha elections. She is the author of *How Prime Ministers Decide*



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- One District One Product (ODOP) generated 3.26 lakh+ jobs, empowering local artisans & entrepreneurs.
- Programs including Mukhyamantri Gramodyog Rozgar Yojana, PM Rozgar Srijan Karyakram, Mukhyamantri



Matikaala Rozgar Yojana, and Toolkit Vitaran Karyakram, provided employment to 4.63 lakh+ individuals

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Proposals in 9 Years

3.26 Lakh+
Jobs Created
Through ODOP

4.20 Lakh+
Artisans Equipped
with Modern
Toolkits Under
Vishwakarma Shram
Samman Yojana

9 Lakh+
government
jobs

18.55 Lakh
Lakhpati Didis
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40,000 BC Sakhis strengthening rural banking services while creating self-employment opportunities.

530 drone didi trained, 114 Self-Help Groups equipped with free drones, and 131 drones deployed for fertilizer spraying

59.75 crore seedlings are being produced through Women Self-Help Groups, creating employment opportunities for around 60,000 women.

Record Investments, Unprecedented Opportunities



- Potential to generate over 1.10 crore employment opportunities.
- Four Groundbreaking Ceremonies have translated investments into projects, generating nearly 60 lakh jobs.
- Upcoming Ground Breaking Ceremony 5.0 to feature projects worth ₹7.5 lakh crore.
- Reforms based on the mantra of Reform, Perform and Transform, supported by a robust single-window clearance system.

ODOP: Empowering Local Enterprise

- 20,396 beneficiaries supported with assistance worth ₹903.64 crore.
- Over 1.46 lakh artisans and entrepreneurs trained and provided toolkits.
- 30 Common Facility Centre projects approved across 24 districts.
- ₹80.48 crore assistance provided to artisans for participation in trade fairs and exhibitions.
- Dedicated ODOP e-commerce portal enabling access to national and global markets.



Defence Corridor Creating High-Value Jobs

- Six defence manufacturing nodes being developed across Uttar Pradesh, strengthening both industrial growth and employment generation
- 197 MoUs signed with proposed investments of ₹ 39,000 crore. Expected to generate over 52,000 direct employment opportunities.
- 62 defence industries allotted land, bringing investments worth nearly ₹12,000 crore. These units alone are expected to create over 14,000+ direct jobs.
- Major projects include the BrahMos Aerospace Facility, Lucknow and Bharat Dynamics Limited unit, Jhansi.





Donyi Polo Airport, Itanagar

- Arunachal Pradesh's first Greenfield Airport
- Best Airport under RCS-UDAN 2026
- Tezu, Pasighat, and Ziro Airports operational

10 Years, One Vision

Vikas | Sewa | Virasat

TEAM ARUNACHAL

A DECADE
OF GROWTH

A JOURNEY OF
TRANSFORMATION

Decade of Hydropower 2025-2035

- 19 HEPs with 19 GW capacity
- 74.9 Billion Unit annual green energy generation
- 2,270 MW operational
- Pare (110 MW) & Kameng (600 MW) HEP commissioned
- Subansiri Lower (2,000 MW): 4 units operational
- Dibang (2,880 MW), Heo (240 MW), Tato-I (186 MW) & Tato-II (700 MW) work commenced



Sela Tunnel

dedicated to nation
on March 9, 2024



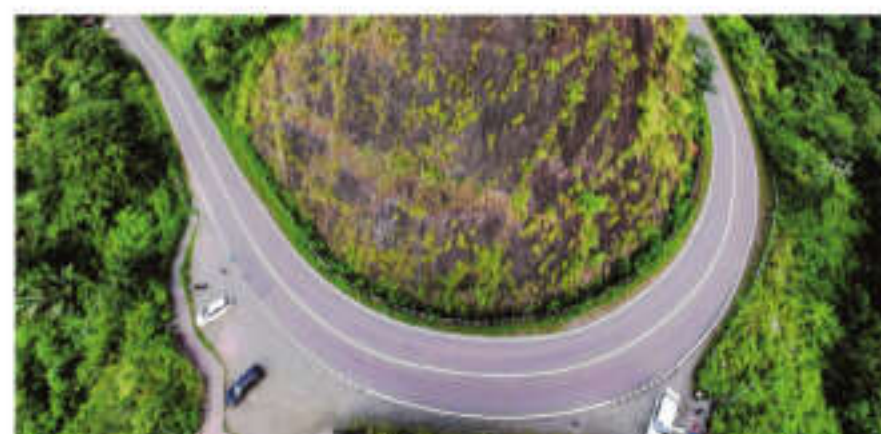
Nechiphu Tunnel

on September 12, 2023



251% Increase in Road Length

- National Highways: 2,538+ km.
- Rural Roads: 13,976 km
- Bridges: 207+



TRIHMMS

State's 1st Medical College
100 MBBS Seats



Gauhati High Court, Itanagar Permanent Bench Building,

Naharlagun
inaugurated on August 10, 2025



AB-PMJAY and
CMAAY
86%+ families
covered



20+ GI-tagged products



Golden Jubilee Outdoor Stadium, Yupia
Football Stadiums at
Tawang, Anini, Jang, Ziro & Seppia

Vibrant Villages Programme

- ₹2,798 Cr invested in India's "First Villages"
- 577 villages covered
- Total Road Length 1,022 km
- 2,100+ projects approved



Atmanirbhar Scheme
61,000+ farmers & SHGs



Cabinet Aapke Dwar, conducted across State
People First, Governance at Doorsteps



SELF-HELP Groups
1.5 lakh+ women
14,244 Lakhpatti Dids



Best Performer States' Startup Ranking 5.0

Ahead of the big deal, strike a careful balance

FOLLOWING THE US Trade Representative's proposal to levy tariffs on 60 countries under Section 301 of the US Trade Act, 1974, the government has introduced a new section in the foreign trade policy regarding forced labour. India is not the only country to do so — Indonesia, Canada, Cambodia and Peru have responded with similar commitments after the USTR's proposed tariffs. Simultaneously, India has sought a review of the USTR's proposed tariffs of 12.5 per cent, alluding to inconsistencies in its examination. The country's tariff challenges don't end here. US President Donald Trump's tariff policy is, as of now, operationalised through Section 122 of the Trade Act. However, the 10 per cent universal rate currently levied can only be imposed for at most 150 days (without Congressional approval), which end on July 24. Trump is trying to reinforce the tariff wall through other pathways. Alongside the investigation into forced labour, USTR is examining the issue of "structural excess capacity and production in manufacturing sectors" in economies, including India. The outcome of that investigation, and if it attracts additional tariffs, is yet to be released.

This, however, is not the only contentious area — energy is another lever. A few days ago, a group of US senators unveiled a new version of the Russia sanctions Bill that proposes to levy tariffs of up to 100 per cent on the top five buyers of Russian oil and natural gas — China, India, Slovakia, Hungary and Azerbaijan. Imports from Russia account for a significant share of India's energy basket. Here, too, New Delhi has taken US concerns on board — PSUs have signed a deal to import 10 per cent of LPG requirements from the US.

In the recent past, the Indian government has pushed through trade deals with countries such as the UK and Australia, as well as the EU. A deal with the US now — the largest economy in the world — will go a long way in reducing the uncertainty that has marred relations between the countries, while expanding trade. The upside for both countries is significant. On its part, the White House will likely continue to exert pressure on India in order to extract maximum concessions. As Delhi moves ahead to expand its market and protect its interests, it will have to carefully navigate its way, mindful of an unpredictable White House.

A game bigger than its grand spectacle

AS SPAIN and Argentina face off on Sunday in what will be their first meeting in the FIFA World Cup since 1966, the finale promises a grand spectacle. Spain's near-impregnable defence will encounter Argentina's potent attack in a game that will see the long-anticipated meeting between Lionel Messi and Lamine Yamal, whom Messi famously cradled as a baby almost 20 years ago. Yet, whatever the outcome at the New York New Jersey Stadium, this World Cup will be remembered for far more than the team that lifts the trophy.

The tournament's expansion from 32 teams to 48 had drawn criticism, particularly in Europe, on the grounds that it would make the competition less compelling. Far from it, the expanded format has not only made the Cup more inclusive, with Africa and Asia enjoying greater representation, but also produced some of its most enthralling encounters, featuring Japan, Senegal, Egypt and tiny and underrated Cape Verde. Technology was a defining feature of the tournament. If FIFA believed that AI-assisted officiating tools, sensor-equipped match balls and semi-automated offside technology would finally settle refereeing disputes, then VAR (video assistant referee) interventions over contentious fouls and strange offside ensured the opposite. The question is not whether technology belongs in football, but how far its adjudicators should allow it to shape the game's crucial moments. Finally, controversies over immigration, ticketing, the treatment of Iran's national team, and the reversal of Folarin Balogun's red card are a reminder that the World Cup has never been just about football. From Mussolini's Italy in 1934 to Argentina's military junta in 1978, the World Cup has long been a stage on which host governments project prestige and power and legitimacy.

The 2026 edition was no different. Nor are the players immune from it. Following the semi-final victory over England, Argentina now faces the prospect of disciplinary action after its players unfurled a banner backing the country's claim to the Falkland Islands. Yet, for all the debates over inclusivity, technology and politics, the World Cup has ultimately lived up to football's enduring moniker as the beautiful game. Last-minute winners, dramatic comebacks, extraordinary underdog performances and teeming moments of individual brilliance have made sure that the football itself has never been overshadowed. The spotlight now falls on Spain and Argentina.

The mysterious new cousin in the wild

IF A monkey croaks in a forest, with no humans to hear it, does it even exist? Five million years ago, the recently classified *Colobus congoensis* split from the common ancestor of its closest simian relative. It was only in 2008 that researchers captured blurry photos of the reclusive, yellow-lipped monkey that makes a croaking sound at the Lomami National Park in Congo. People from the Balanga ethnic group call the animal — roughly the same size as a rhesus monkey — Likweli, and after years of study and genetic testing, it has now been classified as a new species.

Its population, habits and social life will likely occupy zoologists for years to come. The question, though, is whether the Likweli monkey was better off "undiscovered". There is, of course, a chance that the classification of the new species will help conserve it, that knowing it's there may prevent hunting and habitat destruction. Human beings, though, don't have the best record in this regard.

Since the age of European colonial expansion, indigenous populations of entire continents have been all but wiped out by the excesses of "discovery". Animals, once classified, enter the language of the creatures that have destroyed so many of them: They will be "conserved" till, perhaps, some rare mineral or the strategic imperative of a nation-state — far younger than the five-million-year life of the Likweli as a species — makes them part of a utilitarian calculus in which they are simply a variable on a ledger. Meanwhile, let's hope the mysterious new cousin in the simian family croaks away without interruption or interference from its dominating relative.

The Editorial Page

No one did it, it happens: War to exam scandals, pollution to crumbling cities

YESTERDAY, WITHIN minutes, I encountered two statements that seemed to capture the core pathology of contemporary politics: The return of malfeasance or evil without agents. Sonam Wangchuk, on the 15th day of his fast, was outlining the core of his thinking behind asking for the resignation of Dharmendra Pradhan: It was to fix accountability and agency for an exam fiasco that affects hundreds of thousands of lives. In a completely different context, I encountered this reflection by one of the sharpest contemporary philosophers, Raymond Geuss, in an essay, "Without Causes," published in *New Left Review*. The essay discusses an interview Hillary Clinton gave on Gaza. There is one striking line in the essay, "When Clinton must refer to conditions on the (Gaza) Strip her sentences break down and suddenly lack a grammatical subject: 'Reconstruction frozen. Investment absent. Civilians trapped in dependency and despair, with reportedly up to 1,000 killed since the ceasefire'. We are not told who killed them."

The two examples illustrate the same phenomenon. Across an astonishing range of policy challenges, from war to pollution, exam scandals to crumbling cities, we encounter seemingly causeless phenomena; sentences without subjects. At the international level, our Prime Minister sets the tone. "This is not an era of war," he intones with sagacity, without ever naming who the actors are who start the wars. You might think this is diplomatic finesse. But it turns out to be a full-blooded technique of ruling. If there are no agents behind the action, no one needs to

be held accountable. Your success is not stopping the war, condemning aggression, or upholding the law. Your success is that you can immobilise the need for responsibility altogether without appearing immoral.

Now, just think how useful this strategy is domestically. Sentences without grammatical subjects or in the passive voice can easily make passive citizens. Exam leak. Happens. Cities flooding. Happens. Himalayas crumbling. Happens. Stampedes. Happen. Air Pollution. Happens. Just as we know this is not an era of war, but we don't name who starts it, we also know this is not an era of crumbling cities, polluted air and rivers, disenfranchisement and corruption, and any other evil you can mention. But no one makes it happen.

The beauty of the passive voice is that the government can join the citizens in a common language and a common objective. These days, it has become the norm for government ministers, civil servants, or recently retired decision-makers to write about their departments with impressive expertise. They will outline lofty goals, even share citizens' concerns. But the one thing missing in all that writing is the fixing of accountability. You will read hundreds of op-eds on air pollution, including by policymakers. But no one will name or shame, as it were. For example, no one will pointedly say who decided to relax pollution norms for coal-fired power plants and why. Who makes the decisions to give clearances to build roads and buildings in ecologically sensitive zones? I was recently at a meet-



PRATIK BHANU MEHTA

Wangchuk's insistence on a resignation is not simply about one minister or one examination. It is a defence of the proposition that democratic politics requires a grammatical subject

The woman is out of the building



SUKSHAM TANU

LAST MONTH, the firm Zaha Hadid founded in 1979 and led until her death in 2016 dropped her name. Zaha Hadid Architects became ZHA, in what her successor Patrik Schumacher called a natural brand evolution. What that framing left out was the decade-long legal fight behind it: A licensing agreement under which the firm paid Hadid's foundation a share of its revenue to keep her name on the door, and a court ruling this year that freed Schumacher from that obligation. Frank Gehry's name has stayed on his firm's door for nearly 70 years without a court getting involved. Iraq-born Hadid — the only woman to ever win the Pritzker Prize — didn't get that courtesy.

It is tempting to file the story under "architecture's problem with women", as though the problem is somehow contained to one London firm and one unusually famous case. It isn't. The same instinct — celebrate a woman as an exception, then withdraw the recognition once it stops being convenient — runs through India's own architectural institutions.

In 2023, an architect named Vandana Sehgal came closer than any woman ever to leading India's Council of Architecture (COA), the country's statutory architecture regulator. She lost the presidential election by a single vote. Not once since the Architects Act created the Council in 1972 has a woman held its top job. The closest formal foothold any woman has had is its vice-presidency.

The Indian Institute of Architects (IIA), the older and more storied of the profession's two national bodies, does slightly better — but only slightly, and only recently. Founded in 1917, the IIA went 98 years before electing a woman, Divya Kush, as its president in 2015. She served until 2020. Before her and after her, the list of names is a wall of men. This is what happens when institutions built by men, for men, in a profession that has always treated women as guests, are asked to share power. They will let a woman in — eventually, symbolically — and then close the door again.

India's architectural establishment likes to imagine that its exclusions belong to a colonial past it has since outgrown. It has not. Consider Perin Jamsetjee Mistri, who in 1936 became the first woman in India — and reportedly in Asia — to qualify as an architect. She went on to run her father's

firm for half a century, designing everything from Art Deco bungalows to Salvation Army hospitals across two continents. Ninety years later, her name is barely known. Her male contemporaries are still cited as the architects of modern Bombay.

Or, consider Urmila "Elulie" Chowdhury, the only Indian woman on Le Corbusier's team that designed Chandigarh in the 1950s. Chowdhury was the crucial link between Corbusier, his cousin Pierre Jeanneret, and the Indian planners on the ground, fluent enough in French to translate Corbusier's writing and trusted enough to be handed sole charge of major buildings, including the Government Home Science College and the Women's Polytechnic. She also helped design the furniture, including the "Jeanneret chair", that made Chandigarh internationally famous. The Victoria and Albert Museum remains one of the few institutions that has bothered to note Chowdhury's role in that design.

The usual defence of institutions like IIA and COA is that once enough women graduate, representation will follow on its own. The numbers say otherwise. A 2023 exhibition at the Delhi Architecture Biennale found that although women make up roughly 60 per cent of architecture students today, they account for only around 20 per cent of practising, registered architects. Most women drop out because the field doesn't build the career ladders, firm partnerships, or institutional leadership to keep them.

There is a temptation to read Sehgal's 2023 loss as a hopeful sign — proof that change is close, that a woman almost got there. It's worth resisting that reading. "Almost" is not a threshold institutions cross by accident; it is a threshold they cross when they decide to. COA's president is chosen by its own sitting members, in a small internal election, not by a public vote of registered architects. A one-vote margin does not mean the institution is one election away from equity. It means the institution came within reach of a different outcome and chose, by the narrowest possible margin, the outcome that kept its record unbroken. That is not a profession in transition. That is a profession that has learned how far it can let a woman go — and where, every time, to stop her.

The writer is a Dubai-based architect. Her work focuses on sustainability and inclusivity

Real Creator IAS Edition <https://whatsapp.com/channel/0029Van2VRb6RGJOKH6oBd0f> ing where there was eloquent holding forth on "ease of doing business, especially for MSMEs". But not one policymaker could actually name and explain why particular regulations were put in place or even who put them. If you ask a pointed question, all policy, all events, all decisions suddenly become anonymised through invoking "The Bureaucracy" or "The System" or "The Court" or "Norms". As if policy is made by abstractions, if even made at all.

Now you might demur and say, "Isn't this an age of personalised politics, not events without subjects? Don't we attribute all evils to leaders, Vladimir Putin or Narendra Modi, or Donald Trump?" But the cult of personality is one more way in which accountability gets evaded; it's like holding God responsible. When God is responsible, no one is. The personality is meant to disguise the myriad of actions that go into the making of catastrophes. Yes, the person at the top has to shoulder the blame for setting the norms. But that is also a convenient alibi for not fixing individual responsibility. "Modi" and "Trump" become a vast impersonal force that governs everything, so we can stop interrogating actual chains of decisions.

Now, speaking in euphemisms, without a subject, allows a certain civility. Perhaps in the international sphere, it allows for diplomacy. A culture of individual naming and shaming can also be misused and be cruel. There might be some truth to these concerns. But at the present conjuncture, this really has become a technology for creating a passive world in which everything,

● WORDLY WISE
Football is a game of mistakes. Whoever makes the fewest mistakes wins.
— Johan Cruyff

NATO's transformation opens possibilities for India



SAKTI PRASAD SRICHANDAN

THE 2026 NATO Summit held in Ankara a few days ago confirmed that the alliance is entering a new era of strategic transformation rather than strategic decline. Ukraine remains central, but NATO's ambitions now go much further. It is preparing for a world shaped by long-term rivalry, technological competition and unstable supply chains. This shift matters for India.

The first message from Ankara is clear: Russia will remain NATO's principal security challenge for years to come. Even if the war in Ukraine ends, NATO has decided that deterrence must become permanent. The second message is that Europe is being asked to do much more for its own security. The US remains indispensable, but Washington is increasingly unwilling to carry the burden alone. The third is perhaps the most important. Modern wars are won not only on the battlefield but also in factories and laboratories. The Ukraine war exposed serious weaknesses in ammunition production, missile manufacturing and defence supply chains. Technology is completing this transformation. AI, cybersecurity, quantum computing, autonomous systems and space capabilities are today's strategic priorities.

India is not a NATO member. But its security environment is increasingly shaped by decisions taken far beyond its neighbourhood. Europe's growing investment in defence opens new possibilities for India's defence industry. Indian firms can become partners in supply chains that are being diversified away from dependence on a few countries. India's ambition to become a manufacturing hub fits well with Europe's search for trusted partners. If New Delhi moves quickly, defence cooperation can become part of a broader technology and industrial partnership. Further, NATO's strategic outlook increasingly links European security with developments in the Indo-Pacific, maritime security, critical technologies and supply chains. This reflects a broader reality: Security today is interconnected. For India, this creates both opportunities and dilemmas. The opportunity lies in expanding cooperation with European countries on maritime security, cyber resilience, critical technologies and defence innovation. The dilemma is Russia, which remains one of India's major defence partners and an important energy supplier. At the same time, India has deepened strategic ties with the US and Europe. As NATO's confrontation with Moscow grows more entrenched, balancing these relationships will become more difficult.

This is why India's policy of strategic autonomy remains relevant. It should avoid the temptation to see NATO only through the prism of the Ukraine war. NATO is evolving into an organisation where defence, technology, industry and economic resilience are increasingly interconnected. That evolution will shape global standards, defence innovation and strategic partnerships. Instead of asking whether NATO is relevant to India, policymakers should ask: How can India benefit from Europe's security transformation while preserving its strategic autonomy? Done well, India can gain economic and security advantages from the transatlantic rearmament wave. Handled poorly, the same wave could push New Delhi into costly dependencies and strategic choices that weaken the autonomy it has worked hard to preserve.

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40 YEARS AGO

July 17, 1986



PM says UCC Bill ready

THE PRIME Minister, Rajiv Gandhi, said that the Government "is ready" with a Bill for a voluntary uniform civil code. Disclosing this during his meeting with the leaders of opposition parties on the eve of Parliament's monsoon session, the Prime Minister, however, did not give any further details about the proposed legislation. Nor did he say whether the Bill would be introduced during the monsoon session.

China rejects intrusion charge

CHINA REJECTED as "unjustified" a strong Indian protest over an intrusion by Chinese frontier personnel into Indian territory in the

in the Sumdorong river valley area in the eastern sector last month. "This area has always been in Chinese territory. It is not only well known internationally but also located on the Chinese side of the line of actual control," a foreign ministry spokesman said.

Sri Lanka to reframe proposal

THE SRI Lankan government agreed to reformulate some of the proposals with regard to the vexed issue of land settlement following talks between a Tamil United Liberation Front (TULF) delegation and the Lands Minister G. Amirthalingam. TULF secretary-general A. Amirthalingam, said they discussed with Disanayake the provisions contained in annexure "C" of the government proposals on land

settlement for resolving the ethnic problem.

No bomb in Pakistan, says US

THE US insists Pakistan does not have the bomb. Notwithstanding Soviet allegations to the contrary, despite recent American newspaper reports, and despite the refusal of US administration spokesmen to comment on a US newspaper report that stated CIA sources had claimed that Pakistan is very close to possessing a bomb, if it does not have one already. The officials refused to comment on a section of the same report saying Pakistan had enriched uranium at its Kahuta plant in excess of the 5 per cent ceiling, set in 1984 by President Ronald Reagan as a condition for continuing the \$3.2 billion aid package.



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THE BEST OF BOTH SIDES

A weekly column, which offers not this-versus-that, but the best of both sides, to inform the debate



ILLUSTRATION: C.R. SASIKUMAR

Private players are making their presence felt in health and education. What are the implications?

Remember who real stakeholders are



SHAILAJA CHANDRA

PRIVATE EQUITY in health and education is to be welcomed. Several lakh crores are being invested by foreign and Indian PEs, especially into hospitals, diagnostics and home healthcare services, and to a comparatively lesser degree, into education. Groups such as Apollo, Fortis, Max, Manipal and Narayana account for less than 5 per cent of India's total private-hospital beds. Care continues to be delivered by smaller, fragmented facilities. But the infusion of equity into corporate hospitals marks two things: India has the capacity to provide quality care in health, and the country has a huge market, both Indian and international, which will assure wholesome returns.

For over three decades, policy has encouraged private investment in hospitals and allied sectors. Public hospitals have not been able to meet rising demand. India needs thousands of additional hospital beds, diagnostic facilities, specialised medical services, rehabilitation centres, home-care services and medical colleges. Without such private investment, India will struggle to meet the healthcare needs of an ageing population. The issue is not whether private investment is good or bad, but whether India has built institutions that allow investors to earn legitimate returns without leaving patients captive to the pursuit of profit.

Private equity funds carry a fiduciary duty to deliver attractive returns to their investors within a defined investment horizon. PEs have no mandate to protect patients. Their focus is almost exclusively on financial performance. Hospital boards typically track EBITDA, margins, occupancy, average revenue per occupied bed, return on capital and growth. This is neither improper nor unusual: Capital seeks returns, and boards must show financial progress while ensuring compliance with SEBI's listing obligations and the Companies Act.

However, the government has the responsibility to ensure that returns are achieved not merely through cost-cutting or expansion, but through efficiency and quality. Unlike other industries such as banking, telecom, electricity, and civil aviation, healthcare has no independent regulator with statutory powers, appellate processes, reporting obligations, penalties, or mechanisms for public accountability. Private equity's demand for high returns can push hospitals to raise charges for common procedures, use aggressive billing practices or restrict access through selective insurance arrangements. Transparency on both costs and outcomes is therefore essential.

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This only requires hospitals to disclose the relevant information on a public portal.

Because healthcare cannot be judged by consumers at the point of purchase, patients cannot assess the necessity or quality of treatment in advance. They remain unaware of which institutions have lower infection rates, better surgical outcomes, fewer readmissions within 30 days, offer shorter waiting times, or show higher patient satisfaction. Hospitals often resist the idea of such transparency, arguing that they already operate under checks such as NABH and JCI accreditation. While these are valuable, they are voluntary. They have no authority to mandate disclosure of standardised data on quality and outcomes.

Hospitals also point to the multitude of laws they already comply with — the Clinical Establishments Act, the National Medical Commission's directives, the Drugs & Cosmetics Act, the Pollution Control Acts, and a host of fire, labour, and environmental regulations. They lament the fragmentation of oversight, but fragmentation is precisely the problem. None of these statutes mandates that hospitals provide patient-centric data in a transparent, comparable format.

Other countries, too, allow private equity investment in the hospital sector, but they regulate outcomes. England's Care Quality Commission inspects both National Health Service hospitals and private hospitals. Its reports are public. In the US, hospital-level information is published on mortality after common conditions and procedures, readmission rates, hospital-acquired infections, complications, patient experience scores and emergency department waiting times. This allows patients to compare hospitals.

Investors know that every year their hospitals' performance will be compared with others. Once hospitals know that their mortality, infection rates, readmissions, patient complaints and average charges for common procedures will be publicly compared, market discipline begins to work.

PEs know all this, but why should they raise it? They will follow it through their boards once it becomes a statutory requirement. The education sector is more fragmented. Private equity has entered through privately-run universities, K-12 chains, coaching businesses, and ed-tech platforms. The risks include M&A-led expansion, premium schools for affluent families, steep fee increases, coaching that crowds out education, and standardised teaching that discourages questioning. When universities treat students mainly as customers, intellectual development suffers.

The challenge before the government is not to discourage investment but to ensure that patients and students remain at the centre of the health and education systems. Institutions already collect outcome data. Government now needs the resolve to direct that it be made public.

The writer is a former health secretary and former chief secretary of Delhi

More education entrepreneurs needed



MANISH SABHARWAL

INDIA HASN'T created mass prosperity alongside its magnificent creation of mass democracy because of an uneasy relationship with entrepreneurship in general. But this relationship is particularly emotional in the private provision of public goods like education and healthcare, where idealism picks solutions that are moral, simple, obvious, and wrong. Our default position in education should be idealism without illusions for five reasons: Supply, biodiversity, meritocracy, excellence, and honesty.

Supply: Princeton Professor Avinash Dixit's suggestion that life is second-best at best implies a pragmatic acceptance that the most expensive school is no school. Ideological debates over school ownership (private or public), domicile (domestic or foreign), funding (loans, savings, or private equity), and structure (firm, company, or trust) are redundant because India will never have enough good schools. But the only way to discover good schools — those that reconcile the conflicting objectives of cost, quality, and quantity — is massively increasing supply and competition. Only half of our kids are left in government schools; if anything constitutes the infrastructure of opportunity and should be free in a country, it is K-12 education. Yet, the private sector now teaches 120+ million students. Millions of India's poor parents pay something to avoid something free.

Biodiversity: Goodhart's Law holds that when a metric becomes a goal, it ceases to be useful. The state's failure to fix government schools stems from confusing school buildings with building schools. This obsession with hardware over software, like performance management, organisational culture, and governance, fails to deal with coaching factories, soft skill acquisition, multilingual instruction, exam leaks, nursery-school interviews, entrance exams that eliminate rather than select, seat shortages, uneven teaching quality, and unemployability.

Cracking this complexity requires inspiration from Hayek's discovery principle: Unlike infrastructure, educational quality cannot be mandated; it must be discovered through competition, experimentation, and replication. Entrepreneurs making many independent and diverse tries with differing goals, strategies, and resources will not solve our education problems but will surely catalyse the innovation that could.

Meritocracy: India's education regulations prescribe land size, building norms, and legal structures. These make setting up a school or university capital-

intensive, given rising building costs and mispriced land so early in our development (a new Bengaluru or Mumbai school with a reasonable commute will pay more per acre for land than in Chicago). It's unsurprising that most schools are not started by principals, teachers, or education technocrats because regulations are hostile to transparently raising equity capital from financial investors.

This creates an adverse selection among education entrepreneurs — most are politicians or land sharks — because success requires upfront capital and lifelong regulatory skills. First-generation entrepreneurs need financial investors; given my policeman father's frugal savings, I couldn't have become an entrepreneur straight after college without venture capital.

Excellence: AI is bringing weaker students to the median while making strong students stronger. The second is accelerating; the power law of 80 per cent of results coming from 20 per cent of the people in technology, innovation, research, and science is shifting to 90/10. Countries that aspire to lead the world will need to complement mass education programmes (that count students) with gifted-student programmes (that weigh them). These programmes are considerably harder and more expensive and often fail in the public sector given the scrutiny of taxpayer funding for uncertain returns and small enrolment. Elite programmes are a better fit for private institutions with risk appetite, diverse objectives, and longer horizons.

Honesty: My unscientific survey suggests that 75 per cent of capacity in K-12, engineering, business, and undergraduate education over the last three decades is legally, but not spiritually, non-profit. This massive mislabelling of organisations confuses parents, confounds regulators, and denies the Indian state legitimate tax on surplus. The lack of trust around price vs cost also motivates ineffective price controls; private schools need to cover their costs and invent 20 different fee categories. A dishonest legal structure discourages financial investors who bring superior governance, technology, and management, higher accountability for labour law and child safety compliance, and reduced education inflation by funding technocrats.

Educator John Gardner challenged policymakers and entrepreneurs to design education systems that are equal and excellent. The difficulty of this trade-off is dismissed as a lack of idealism by thinkers who don't do and a lack of pragmatism by doers who don't think. Historian Thucydides warned us that any army with a big gap between its thinkers and doers will have its fighting done by fools and its thinking done by cowards. The same doer-thinker disease that hurts Indian education has a simple medicine: Idealism without illusions.

The writer is co-founder of Teamlease Services and co-author of Made in India

Dear PM, a thousand days of Gaza, many questions for India



MANOJ KUMAR JHA

NOW AND then, we face moments that pose questions whose answers lie beyond notions of nations and borders. Such moments compel us to confront our moral imagination and the choices we make when confronted by unbearable human suffering. Mr Prime Minister, such a moment confronts us now.

A thousand days have passed since the beginning of the tragedy on October 7, 2023. Since then, Gaza has witnessed unprecedented devastation. I have written to you on several other occasions, but this time, I request you to read this letter not as a note from a parliamentarian, but as a message from a fellow Indian who, like you and millions of our compatriots, has inherited a civilisation that has long believed that moral courage is the highest expression of political leadership. This is a moment when the consequences of the Indian state's stance echo far beyond the calculations of diplomacy or the compulsions of statecraft. Experts have discussed military operations, diplomatic negotiations, strategic victories and geopolitical realignments, but I am convinced that future generations will look back at this period as something far more unsettling — as the moment when humanity itself was placed on trial, and much of the world struggled to answer whether its commitment to justice was truly universal or merely selective.

Independent India's greatest strength has been its moral vocabulary. Do we need to remind ourselves that it was Mahatma Gandhi who transformed the language of politics by insisting that the means were inseparable from the ends? This stance was not merely a strategy to achieve India's freedom. Through this insistence, Bapu enabled India to possess and offer to the world a philosophy for humanity. When Jawaharlal Nehru spoke of non-alignment, peaceful coexistence, and international solidarity, he was building on this legacy. He consistently positioned India as a conscience-keeper among nations, capable of speaking uncomfortable truths and defending human dignity without fear. I realised that when Rabindranath Tagore said, "where the mind is without fear, and the head is held high", he may have been describing not only a moral state that every democracy must strive to preserve internally, but also an ethical condition it should push other nations to accept.

The first casualty of every war has always been truth, but what the world has witnessed over these thousand days shows something even more disturbing. We have witnessed how the powerful calibrate truth according to their strategic convenience and ideological preference. Compassion, which ought to arise spontaneously upon witnessing the suffering of innocent civilians, now appears burdened with political qualifications. Is the value of a child's life determined by nationality, geography or the calculations of power? Surely, these are not the civilisational values that India has



ILLUSTRATION: TANUSHRI MITRA

aspired to represent.

For decades, the international community painstakingly built a language around human rights, believing that universal principles on dignity would transcend race, religion, nationality and military power. Israel's ethnic cleansing of the Palestinian nation, however, compels us to ask whether these ideals remain genuinely universal or whether they have gradually become privileges extended or held back as per the geopolitical interests of powerful states.

Our Constitution has taught generations of Indians that liberty, equality, and dignity are not rewards bestowed selectively, but guarantees flowing from the equal worth of every human being. International law, too, draws legitimacy not from the force of armies but from the consistency of its moral application. No institution can establish its credibility by censoring the powerless. Impartiality alone gives justice its enduring legitimacy.

Bapu reminded us that a seemingly neutral stance in the presence of sustained injustice can mean acquiescence, and eventually complicity, towards such acts. My concerns about what the Indian government has chosen not to do are also because the government's acquiescence has made many Indians weary because their repeated exhortations have had no impact. I cannot stress enough that when remembrance is selective, it stops being a moral lesson and becomes a political tool. If one atrocity deserves eternal remembrance while another is couched with qualifiers, the former is just a partisan story that has forfeited its credibility.

My letter is not an argument against any nation, any people or any faith. I do, however, wish to make an impassioned appeal against the normalisation of collective punishment. My letter is an appeal against the dangerous illusion which holds that overwhelming military superiority can be a substitute for moral legitimacy. It is an appeal against the dangerous lies of the powerful who claim they are "establishing

peace" while continuing to inflict prolonged humiliation on an entire people.

Mr Prime Minister, the future of humanity will not be determined by technological innovation, military capability or economic might. It will ultimately depend on the moral capacity of societies to preserve the ability to be disturbed by another human being's suffering, regardless of identity or geography. Governments will change, and new international alliances will evolve. But no generation has ever been able to evade the judgment of history.

When future generations ask where India stood during one of the defining moral crises of our age, I am sure they will judge the moral turpidity of our times very severely. Have we been able to ensure that our universities, our media, our intellectuals, and our public institutions remained guardians of independent moral judgment or were they reduced to echoes of political convenience? Above all, Mr Prime Minister, we will be judged on whether India dared to push the world to recognise its reflection when it looked into the mirror of its own conscience during these thousand days. With regards.

The writer is Member of Parliament (Rajya Sabha), Rashtriya Janata Dal

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Engage with Wangchuk

THIS IS A cry of rage at the government's unresponsiveness to its citizens' demands ('Government must talk to Sonam, that's its duty', *IE*, July 16). The peaceful protest at Jantar Mantar, seeking justice in the case of the NEET paper leak and the subsequent student suicides, has been going on for almost a month. It is disheartening to see a government elected by citizens, and entrusted with representing their concerns, become completely indifferent. The presence of Sonam Wangchuk lends legitimacy and gravity to the movement, but we must collectively demand a better education system and a more accountable government.

Anangsha Rajguru, Jorhat

SONAM WANGCHUK'S hunger strike is a stark reminder that this government struggles to engage with anyone who disagrees with it ('Government must talk to Sonam, that's its duty', *IE*, July 16). Be it farmers, citizenship law protesters, or now an education reformer demanding accountability, its instinct to silence

rather than engage reflects a discomfort with dialogue that is not transactional. Wangchuk's demand resonates with millions of young Indians who have lost faith in a broken system. While the government may dismiss his methods as theatrical, his cause is genuine and his dedication undeniable.

Babu Crishna, Bengaluru

Ocean health

THE SCOTTISH Association for Marine Science completing 175 years of ocean research is a useful occasion to reflect on how little institutional attention India gives to its own marine ecosystems ('The sea has a seat at the table', *IE*, July 16). India needs dedicated, long-term oceanographic institutions with stable funding rather than short-term project grants that make sustained data collection difficult. Coastal states should also be brought into research planning, since fishing communities often possess generational knowledge about changing sea conditions.

Prajesh Paramasivan, Neeilambur

The cybersecurity lesson in e-rickshaws



DEEP PAL AND SUKANYA THAPLIYAL

RECENTLY, E-RICKSHAWS in Delhi suddenly began stalling in the middle of the road. It turned out that one could use certain Chinese apps to disable their batteries by exploiting their Battery Management Systems (BMS). The Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY) swiftly had Google and Apple remove the errant apps.

The apps were diagnostic tools for technicians to remotely monitor battery health, diagnose faults, and perform maintenance. Certain BMS units accepted Bluetooth connections with weak or default credentials, allowing unauthorised users to access critical functions. The issue is not where the software originated, but that batteries are now software-defined, connected systems. Vul-

nerabilities can disrupt operations or disable critical equipment. That is a significant problem: Such systems support power grids, telecom tower systems, warehouses, ports, industrial automation, and defence platforms.

India has robust institutions for cybersecurity guidance, including the Indian Computer Emergency Response Team (CERT-In) and the National Critical Information Infrastructure Protection Centre (NCIIPC) for critical infrastructure. However, a coherent strategy for connected battery systems is missing. CERT-In has expanded its focus to guidance on secure software development, coordinated vulnerability disclosure, Software Bills of Materials (SBOMs), and security requirements for original equipment manufacturers against AI-assisted vulnerabilities. But the guidelines are not binding and offer limited guidance on cybersecurity requirements for connected battery products.

The NCIIPC protects sectors such as power, transport and telecommunications.

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Grid-scale Battery Energy Storage Systems may fall within their remit when deployed as part of designated critical infrastructure. However, connected battery systems in EVs, commercial storage deployments and consumer BMS remain outside its jurisdiction.

Sectoral regulators such as the Central Electricity Authority have sought to address battery risks through fragmented lenses, focussing on organisational cybersecurity or functional safety. The Department of Telecommunications and MeitY have introduced security assurance mechanisms for connected devices. But these mandatory regimes do not specify Bluetooth-enabled BMS and the apps used to manage them.

Modern battery systems comprise hardware and software sourced from around the world. Consequently, the security of the battery depends on the integrity of its digital supply chain as much as its physical one.

Global regulations reflect the focus on evaluating digital supply chains. The Secure

The writers are policy professionals at Koan Advisory Group

LAKHIMPUR KHERI CASE

No proof of intimidation against Ajay Mishra, son: Cops to SC

Express News Service
New Delhi, July 16

THE UTTAR Pradesh police told the Supreme Court Thursday that it had not found any evidence to link former Union minister Ajay Mishra or his son Ashish Mishra to allegations of intimidation of witnesses in the Lakhimpur Kheri case.

A three-judge bench presided by CJI Surya Kant, monitoring the progress of the case in which Ashish Mishra is accused of running over anti farm law protesters in 2021, was told that a status report filed in the matter reveals that probe is over in the witness intimidation FIR but nothing was found.

Appearing for Mishra, Senior Advocate Siddharth Dave said, "I have not been even named in the chargesheet." The bench recorded that the chargesheet names only one Amandeep Singh and that cognisance had been taken by the competent court.

Bulldozers will have to roll when encroachers thwart law, says SC

Observation amid hearing of case on state authorities flouting the apex court's 2024 order

Ananthakrishnan G
New Delhi, July 16

OBSERVING THAT bulldozers will have to roll "when a comfortable corruption between municipal authorities and illegal encroachers thwarts the rule of law", the Supreme Court on Thursday refused to consider a batch of pleas alleging widespread contempt of the apex court's 2024 judgment against "bulldozer justice", and asked aggrieved parties to move their respective High Courts.

A three-judge bench presided over by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant heard petitioners who sought contempt of court proceedings against

various state authorities for allegedly flouting the SC's November 13, 2024 judgment, which held that using bulldozers to demolish homes of people merely because they are accused in some cases is contrary to the rule of law.

The bench, also comprising Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana, pointed out to the petitioners that their pleas involved disputed questions of fact which will have to be adjudicated by someone.

Agreeing, Additional Solicitor General Aishwarya Bhati said the petitions are from across the country, and a factual inquiry will be required in each case.

The CJI said, "And the facts are bound to vary from case to case. The court might be required to summon the record and examine it."

He said the SC had already laid down the broad principles, and it is now for the High Courts and courts below them to ensure compliance.

As Senior Advocates Sanjay Hegde, C U Singh and Huzefa

Amadi pressed the bench to decide the case in the light of the November 13 judgment instead of leaving it to the High Courts, Justice Bagchi said, "It can be used... Question is whether this person had an authorisation or the process of law was followed or not."

Hegde said in his case, there was a TV anchor who sat on a bulldozer and came there. The CJI said all these facts will have to be looked at by someone.

Ahmadi said in his matter, which involved the demolition of a mosque, there was an egregious breach of the court's order.

"The High Court gave me protection and said you will give time to file reply etc and till then don't pass a final order. Even before a final order was served upon me, they came and demolished and then I had to move for contempt before this court and your lordships gave me order of status quo."

He said, "So far as I am concerned, there was no action taken by authorities from 1999 to 2024. This action only got

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chi said.

Hegde said his client Ganesh Gupta had a fruit juice stall on which a bulldozer was used. Justice Bagchi said, "It can be used... Question is whether this person had an authorisation or the process of law was followed or not."

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"The High Court gave me protection and said you will give time to file reply etc and till then don't pass a final order. Even before a final order was served upon me, they came and demolished and then I had to move for contempt before this court and your lordships gave me order of status quo."

He said, "So far as I am concerned, there was no action taken by authorities from 1999 to 2024. This action only got

initiated on account of a letter which was issued by a local politician where he said how can you have Asia's largest mosque in this particular state... So, therefore, this is not one of those standard cases, it is one of pick and choose... In my case, there was also no allegation of encroachment on public property..."

Senior Advocate Singh argued that if the SC doesn't stand up for its own judgment, then who will?

"Who said we will not? We will stand for our judgments. We will direct the HC to ensure compliance with our judgment," said the CJI.

Justice Bagchi said what the bench intended to convey is that the judgment "cannot be read as a statute. Judgment has to be read in the context...", more so when there is a caveat attached to it that the directions will not be attracted if there is unauthorised structure in any public place such as road, street, footpath, abutting railway line or any river body or water bodies.

EXPRESS special

Drones reduce time and cost of TB diagnosis: Study

Cost for diagnosis went down from Rs 9,451 to Rs 91, shows ICMR study

Anonna Dutt
New Delhi, July 16

DRONES CAN be very effective in reducing the time and cost of tuberculosis diagnosis, found a study conducted by the Indian Council of Medical Research (ICMR) in Telangana.

In the areas where drones were used to carry patient samples to centres with molecular diagnostics, the average time to receive a TB diagnosis reduced from 16.6 days to 6.9 days. Importantly, the cost for this diagnosis went down from Rs 9,451 to just Rs 91, according to the study.

This comes at a time when the government is looking towards various innovations, including several AI tools, to catch up. India missed the deadline it set for itself for eliminating TB by 2025. The global deadline for ending TB is set for 2030. "Affordable and timely access to diagnosis remains central to India's TB elimination efforts."

This study demonstrates how technology can help bridge geographical barriers and reduce the burden on patients, particularly those living in remote areas.

"The evidence generated through the i-DRONE initiative will help inform future public health innovations while complementing existing healthcare delivery systems," said Dr Rajiv Bahl, director general, ICMR.

A hub-and-spoke drone network was established between 60 sub-centre, 11 primary health centres and four TB units in Telangana — Alair, Bhongir, Ramannapet, and Choutuppal — where the samples from these centres



Drones can transform TB diagnosis in rural India by speeding up sample transport, reducing costs and easing travel burdens for patients, found the study.

Real Creator IAS Edition https://t.me/+2RvD_RGf9mjlMzgj were being tested. The aim was to see whether it can actually improve the efficiency of TB diagnosis in remote and rural areas, especially hilly regions where poor road infrastructure, unpredictable weather, and long distances to the laboratories hamper timely diagnosis.

Around 840 people who had been diagnosed at these four centres were enrolled for the study, with 206 individuals receiving their diagnosis before the i-drone initiative and 634 afterwards.

Usually, the patients would have to travel from their respective villages to the TB units to get the test if they were thought to have the infection. Before the i-DRONE initiative, patients would have to travel anywhere between 10 and 30 kilometres by road with often limited transport facility.

Afterwards, they could go to their nearest sub-centre or primary health centre — which do not have the molecular diagnostic tests but can collect sample — and give their sputum that could be transported using the drones.

"Patients reported travel difficulties, loss of daily wages, and stigma as reasons for delaying care," the study said. Almost all of the participants were poor patients, reporting a

monthly income of less than Rs 5,000.

Two types of drones were used for the initiative — an 11.5 kg drone that could carry a 2-kg payload and a 24-kg drone that could carry an 8 kg payload. Detailed flight routes were pre-programmed, keeping in mind the terrain, population density, and no-fly zones. Safe take-off and landing sites were also created at these health centres and TB units.

What did the pilot study find?

The study also found that the proportion of persons receiving their diagnosis within a day or two also went up.

The proportion of patients receiving results the same day as the sample is sent increased slightly from 6.3% to 7.4% with the drones, but the number of people receiving the results next day went up sharply from 1.5% to 76.3%.

The study also found that the proportion experiencing delays more than 2 days fell from 92.2% in the pre-drone phase to 16.3% in the drone phase, according to the study.

It went on to say that the findings mirror what was also observed in Manipur and Nagaland where similar drones have been successfully used.

ISRO moves to halt exodus of staff from critical projects

Anjali Marar
Bengaluru, July 16

AFTER A spate of exits from crucial projects - including human spaceflight programme Gaganyaan - rattled the Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO), the body has decided to not accept requests for voluntary retirement or resignations of senior scientific staff associated with important missions without a review.

In 2020, ISRO had authorised the heads of its various centres and units across the country to accept resignations or requests for voluntary retirements of Group A scientific or technical staff of up to a certain rank. In a fresh order dated July 14, ISRO has said that such requests would now have to be referred to the department (Department of Space) for action.

"Any such requests received from scientific/technical personnel, even of and below the rank of scientist/engineer-SG, may be sent to the Department with clear recommendations of the directors of centres/heads of units for final decision," it said.

Private sector perks

The space sector was thrown open to private parties in the last decade. This created new opportunities with better pay and perks for scientists and engineers in the field. Staff at almost all private space companies in India comprise former ISRO employees.

Multiple sources told *The Indian Express* that the U R Rao Satellite Centre (URSC) in Bengaluru and the Vikram Sarabhai Space Centre (VSSC) in Thiruvananthapuram, two of the largest and most prestigious centres of ISRO, witnessed the bulk of the exodus. This,

they said, prompted the space department to issue the order.

While VSSC focuses on research and development of rockets and launch systems, URSC is involved in design and development of satellites. The knowledge and experience of scientists working with these bodies is the most sought after in the Indian industry.

"ISRO management, the work culture and environment of a government sector is no longer considered attractive and is not being appreciated by the younger employees. Then, there have been instances when the employees have felt that the management has favoured some sections of employees with promotions, while ignoring others. It is a fact. A lot of employees at ISRO are not very happy working in this kind of a set-up," an ISRO official said on condition of anonymity. The latest order has attracted criticism, said one official, as it has amounted to curtailment of powers of ISRO's centre directors who were very high-ranking officials.

"Any government employee, including those at ISRO, is entitled to apply for voluntary retirement after 15 years of service, and this request has to be processed within three months. So, the issuance of this order, dated July 14, is itself questionable," said the official.

In Delhi, Science and Technology Minister Jitendra Singh, also the minister-in-charge of Space, sought to play down the issue of attrition in ISRO. He said the ISRO memo in question was just an administrative order, and said it was not unusual for a large workforce like that of ISRO to see some level of attrition. "Some people decide to go, but others also join," he said.

BIMSTEC meet in Delhi: Security chiefs vow to combat terror

Shubhajit Roy
New Delhi, July 16

NATIONAL SECURITY chiefs of BIMSTEC countries on Thursday vowed to jointly combat regional security challenges and endorsed new guiding principles to streamline maritime law enforcement coordination.

This is significant since BIMSTEC (Bay of Bengal Initiative for Multi-Sectoral Technical and Economic Cooperation) comprises India, Sri Lanka, Thailand, Bangladesh, Myanmar, Nepal and Bhutan, and all of them have stakes in the developments in the Indian Ocean.

The meeting held in New Delhi was hosted by National Security Advisor Ajit Doval. The Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) said the national security advisors and heads of delegations discussed practical and result-oriented solutions to combat terrorism and organised crime, and to ensure security in the cyber, maritime and energy domains.

It said they also deliberated on boosting connectivity, facilitating efficient disaster management.

"They adopted guidelines for the maritime component of humanitarian assistance and disaster relief. These will help

BIMSTEC member states to undertake relief operations in the region," the MEA said.

"They also endorsed a set of guiding principles on the conduct of maritime law enforcement agencies during interactions at sea," it said.

The MEA said these principles are expected to outline reference points for increasing predictability and promoting safety during maritime engagements among member states.

"As BIMSTEC approaches its 30th anniversary next year, the National Security Advisors/Heads of Delegations reiterated their resolve to further enhance collaboration and knowledge sharing towards strengthening regional security, building resilience, and enhancing institutional capacities to address diverse security threats," it said.

Doval underscored the need for closer regional cooperation to tackle evolving security challenges, saying the current global landscape marked by conflicts, geopolitical uncertainties and disruptions requires BIMSTEC member states to work together and take "decisive actions" for their mutual benefit.

The NSA said BIMSTEC have built strong cooperation across security sectors and made significant progress in countering threats.

NORTH WESTERN RAILWAY

ई-निविदा आमन्त्रण सूचना
मंडल रेल प्रबंधक, इंडीनिग्रिया, उत्तर पश्चिम रेलवे, जोधपुर द्वारा भारत के राष्ट्रपति के लिये एवं उनकी ओर से ई-निविदा के माध्यम से प्रचलित नियमों के अन्तर्गत निर्धारित प्रपत्रों में निविदा निम्न कार्यों के लिए क्रमानुसार आमंत्रित की जाती है। ई-निविदा सूचना सं०: 107/0206-27; कार्य का नाम व स्थान: Replacement of 0.61 mt. multiple span bridges (16 nos bridges) by RCC box bridge in KQW-SWF section in the Jurisdiction of Sr.DEN/Centra; अनुमानित लागत रुपये: 5,14,58,277.59; बयान की राशि रुपये: 10,29,200.00; निविदा सूचना संख्या 107/0206-27 निविदा प्रस्तुत करने की तिथि 03.08.2026 को 15:00 बजे तक है। वेबसाइट का विवरण जहाँ पर ई-निविदा देखी व भरी जा सकती है www.ireps.gov.in

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EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY

OPEN TENDER NOTICE
NOTICE INVITING OPEN TENDER, Tender Notice No. 05/TRD/DNR/OT/26-27 The Divisional Railway Manager, E.C. Railway, Danapur invites sealed open tender on behalf of the President of India for the following works.

Tender No.: TRD/DNR/OT/05/26-27
1. Name of work with its location: POH of 05 nos. 21.6 MVA, 132/25 KV Power Transformer of JAJ/TSS (2 Nos.), KOO/TSS (1 No.), NLD/TSS (1 No.) & DNR/TSS (1 No.) for improving power supply over Danapur Division, 2. Approx cost of the work (NIT value): ₹ 2,27,53,908.20/-, 3. Earnest money to be deposited: ₹ 4,55,100.00/-, 4. Date & time for online submission of tender: Date & time for online submission of tender: 12.08.2026 before 12.00 hrs. 5. Website particulars, notice board location where complete details of tender can be seen and address of the office from where the tender form can be purchased etc.: Detailed tender notice, eligibility criteria & tender documents can be seen from the CRIS website: <http://www.ireps.gov.in> & full details of notice can be seen on notice board of Sr. DEE (TRD)/E.C. Railway/ Danapur. All corrigendum will be uploaded on website, if required. Divisional Railway Manager, E.C.Railway, Danapur PR/0556/DNR/TRD/T/26-27/40

AP POWER GENERATION CORPORATION Ltd.,
VS, VIJAYAWADA-520004
(A Govt. of A.P. Undertaking)

NIT No: S10000302

Name of the work: "Dr. NTPPS - Procurement of steel material required for units 1 to 8 of Dr. NTPPS for the year 2026-27" through e-procurement.

Schedule available Date & Time: 15.07.2026-18.00 Hrs onwards. Bid submission Closing Date & Time: 05.08.2026-15.00 Hrs. For other details visit the website: www.approcurement.gov.in Ph: 0866-2524646, 2526455.

No. 5257PP/CL/ADVT/1/1/2021-22 Date: 16/07/2026

NORTHERN RAILWAY
CORRIGENDUM

Ref.: Tender Notice No. 19/2026-2027 dated 12.06.2026 S. No. 07
Tender No. 77269008RGC Opening date 15.07.2026.

In reference to above, tender opening date has been extended from 15.07.2026 to 15.08.2026. All other terms and conditions remain unchanged.

The corrigendum has been published on website www.ireps.gov.in.

Note: This is the First Corrigendum in above referred tender.

Dated: 15.07.2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 CrPC / 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Vikki @ Vikram S/o Man Singh, R/o Jhuggi No. 19/59, CD Park, Jahangirpuri, Delhi**, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 80/2014, U/S 324/542/149 IPC, PS Jahangirpuri, North-West Distt., Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Vikki @ Vikram** cannot be found, and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Vikki @ Vikram** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant); Proclamation is hereby made that **Vikki @ Vikram** the said accused of **FIR No. 80/2014, U/S 324/542/149 IPC, PS Jahangirpuri, North-West Distt., Delhi**, is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **25.08.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Sahil Gupta
Judicial Magistrate First Class-07,
North Distt., Court No.-06, Ground Floor,
Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/9723/NW/2026
(Court Matter)

कार्यालय: नगर निगम गोरखपुर

पत्राक:- 225 / मु03अमि0 / चार-साणिनिगि0 / 2026-27 दिनांक: 16 / 07 / 2026

अति अल्कालीन निविदा आमन्त्रण सूचना

नगर निगम, गोरखपुर द्वारा नगर निगम के समस्त पंजीकृत ठेकेदारों / अनुमयी फर्मों से उनकी श्रेणी के अनुसार ऑफलाईन / ई-निविदा के माध्यम से 01 कार्य की निविदाएं आमंत्रित की जाती है। शासनादेश सं0 3890 / नी-5-149सा / 2019, नगर विकास अनुभाग-05 उ0300 शासन लखनऊ, दिनांक 20 सितम्बर 20.09.2019 के क्रम में उक्त निविदा में नगर निगम, गोरखपुर में अपंजीकृत ठेकेदारों के द्वारा भी प्रतिभाग किया जा सकता है। सर्वन्यून निविदादाता होने पर सम्बन्धित ठेकेदार को नगर निगम, गोरखपुर में पंजीकरण की अर्हता पूर्ण कराकर नगर निगम, गोरखपुर में पंजीकरण कराना होगा। पंजीकरण की अर्हता सम्बन्धी विवरण / आवश्यक प्रपत्र की सूचना किसी भी कार्य दिवस में नगर निगम कार्यालय के निर्माण विभाग में देखी जा सकती है। ई-निविदा प्रपत्र उ0300 की ई-प्रखोस्पेन्ट की वेबसाइट <http://etender.up.nic.in> व नगर निगम की वेबसाइट <https://gorakhpurnagarnigam.up.gov.in> पर देखी जा सकती है। शासनादेश सं0 4848 / नी-5-2018-470सा / 2018 नगर विकास अनुभाग-5 उ0300 शासन, लखनऊ दिनांक 10 सितम्बर, 2018 के क्रम में निविदा शुल्क + जी0एस0टी0 एवं घरोहर घनराशि पृथक-पृथक ऑन लाईन / NEFT/RTGS के माध्यम से नगर निगम कोष में नगर निगम, गोरखपुर के खाता सं0 10174963707 (IFSC Code: IDFB0021561) IDFC First Bank, शाखा-पाक रोड, गोरखपुर में जमा किया जाना अनिवार्य होगा, जिसकी स्कैन कपी ई-टैण्डर अपलोड करते समय अपलोड करनी होगी। ई-निविदाएं निम्नानुसार आमंत्रित की जाती है:-

क्र०सं०	विवरण	दिनांक एवं समय
	ऑफलाईन निविदा क्र०सं० 01	
1	ऑफलाईन निविदा विक्री की तिथि / समय	21-07-2026 @ 10:00 AM to 12:00 PM
2	ऑफलाईन निविदा खालने की तिथि / समय	22-07-2026 @ 10:00 AM to 12:00 PM
3	ऑफलाईन निविदा खोलने की तिथि / समय	22-07-2026 @ 02:00 PM

कार्यों का विवरण, नियम व शर्तें नगर निगम, गोरखपुर के वेबसाइट <https://gorakhpurnagarnigam.up.gov.in> एवं <http://etender.up.nic.in> पर उपलब्ध है साथ ही नगर निगम कार्यालय के नोटिस बोर्ड पर चरखा कर दी गयी है। किसी परिवर्तन, संशोधन व अतिरिक्त सूचनाओं के लिये उक्त वेबसाइट एवं नोटिस बोर्ड पर देखी जा सकती है।

अधिश्रासी अभियन्ता
नगर निगम, गोरखपुर

NORTH WESTERN RAILWAY

ई-निविदा आमन्त्रण सूचना
मंडल रेल प्रबंधक, इंडीनिग्रिया, उत्तर पश्चिम रेलवे, जोधपुर द्वारा भारत के राष्ट्रपति के लिये एवं उनकी ओर से ई-निविदा के माध्यम से प्रचलित नियमों के अन्तर्गत निर्धारित प्रपत्रों में निविदा निम्न कार्यों के लिए क्रमानुसार आमंत्रित की जाती है। ई-निविदा सूचना सं०: 2026-27: 1050/2026-27; कार्य का नाम व स्थान: Capacity Augmentation and Advancement of Mechanized departmental Laundry over Jodhpur Division; अनुमानित लागत रुपये: 35531045.92; बयान की राशि रुपये: 710600.00; ई-निविदा सूचना सं०: 2026-27: 1060/2026-27; कार्य का नाम व स्थान: Construction of 4 units of Type-IV quarters, 2 units of Type V officer bungalow and improvement of quarter works under ADEN HQ अनुमानित लागत रुपये: 80893914.66; बयान की राशि रुपये: 1617900.00; निविदा सूचना संख्या 1050/2026-27 & 1060/2026-27 निविदा प्रस्तुत करने की तिथि 28.07.2026 को 15:00 बजे तक है। वेबसाइट का विवरण जहाँ पर ई-निविदा देखी व भरी जा सकती है www.ireps.gov.in

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SC: No live-streaming of cases argued by litigants in person

Express News Service
New Delhi, July 16

THE FULL Court of the Supreme Court has approved a new protocol in cases where petitioners personally appear before it to argue their case. In its meeting on Wednesday, it resolved that such proceedings will not be live-streamed or allowed to be recorded.

The Full Court decided that those who wish to appear in person will also be given the option to appear through virtual mode. If they insist on appearing in person, the conditions will apply.

The decision comes close on the heels of the incident where a petitioner who appeared before a bench of Justices K V Viswanathan and Alok Aradhe on July 10 shouted at the judges and hurled papers before being removed by the security personnel.

He also used expletives for the Chief Justice of India. The bench, however, decided not to act against him. Video clips of the incident were widely shared on social media.

Monsoon Session: BJP likely to table 5 new Bills; ‘delimitation package’ not on its agenda

Jatin Anand
New Delhi, July 16

THE BJP-led NDA government is likely to table five new Bills, including one aimed at making provisions for registration of births and deaths more stringent, in addition to taking up the contentious Foreign Contribution (Regulation) Amendment Bill in the Monsoon Session, which starts Monday.

The agenda for the session does not include the “delimitation package” of which the Nari Shakti Adhinyam, or women’s reservation Bill, is a significant component. The Bill was defeated in the Lok Sabha after the NDA failed to secure the two-thirds majority required for a Constitutional amendment.

Sources said this “package”, which requires both total and special majority in the House of the People, will need to be tabled and ratified by the Union Cabinet to be put into motion yet again, which could be taken up

Cong to raise temple donation row, fuel blending, paper leak issues in House

Express News Service
New Delhi, July 16

THE CONGRESS will raise the Ram Temple donation theft, ethanol-blended fuels and question paper leaks, among other issues, in Parliament during the Monsoon Session that begins Monday, the party’s communication in-charge Jairam Ramesh said.

He said the party would also work to unite the Opposition against any delimitation Bill the government may introduce.

Leader of the Opposition in Rajya Sabha Mallikarjun Kharge wrote to Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Thursday, demanding an all-party meeting on the delimitation Bill before it is introduced in Parliament.

during the session. BJP insiders said the matter was likely to come up for discussion at a meeting to be chaired by Defence Minister Rajnath Singh with NDA leaders on Friday.

The FCRA Amendment Bill, which seeks to amend the FCRA (Regulation) Act, 2010, that governs the acceptance and utilisation of foreign contribution and foreign hospitality to “ensure that such inflows do not adversely affect national interest, public order or national security”, was listed for “consideration and passing”. The proposed legislation was tabled March 25.

According to the agenda, the “Viksit Bharat Shiksha Adhishthan Bill, 2025”, which was introduced in the Lok Sabha on December 15, 2025 but later referred to a Joint Committee of both Houses, will also return to centre stage with the 31-member committee’s report scheduled to be presented and considered during the session.

A Bill seeking to further

amend Section 13(3) of the Registration of Births and Deaths Act, 1969 (as amended in 2023), in order to make provisions of registration “more stringent”, and the Supreme Court (Number of Judges) Amendment Bill, 2026, which is intended at replacing an existing ordinance in this regard, were among the two new significant legislation proposed to be taken up during the session.

The other proposed legislative business includes the Income-Tax (Amendment) Bill, 2026, which aims to “deepen India’s sovereign debt market”, attracting stable global capital inflows and enhance liquidity.

The other Bills likely to be tabled are Prevention of Insults to National Honour (Amendment) Bill, 2026, and a Bill which seeks to align the Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises Development Act, 2006 with the “changing MSME landscape” and enhance ease of doing business in the sector.

IMD: Dry conditions to prevail in most parts until month end

Express News Service
Bengaluru, July 16

DRY CONDITIONS will prevail over large parts of the country for the remaining days of July, except for the east and north-east regions where rainfall will continue, the India Meteorological Department (IMD) said on Thursday.

“Overall, rainfall activity is likely to be normal to above normal over most parts of east and northeast India and below normal over the remaining parts of the country during July 16-22. Normal rainfall is likely over central India during July 22-29,” the IMD said in its weekly forecast.

The IMD had forecast below-normal rainfall (about 94 per cent of the long period average) over the country during July. At the end of the first half of the month, the country’s rainfall deficit stood at 8 per

cent. With the rainfall having taken a break since July 9 over most parts of the country, the country-wide seasonal deficit has slipped to 24 per cent.

As for most of the remaining days of July, the monsoonal trough - an elongated zone of low pressure areas prominent during this season - would be positioned much to the north of its normal position and remain closer to the Himalayan foothills. Correspondingly, the rainfall over south, central and northwest India expected to remain subdued. Rainfall over central India is likely to pick up towards the last week of July, when this trough would swing back to its normal position, the Met office said.

IMD also said that strong northwesterly winds will be dominant and prevent the inflow of monsoonal winds that cause rainfall.

According to the latest forecast Real Creator IAS Edition https://t.me/+2RvD_RG9rmljMzg1

cast, heavy to very heavy rainfall is likely to occur over Jammu and Kashmir, Himachal Pradesh, Uttarakhand, Punjab, Haryana, Chandigarh, Delhi and east and western regions of Uttar Pradesh till July 22. Very heavy rain (120-200mm in 24-hours) warning prevails for Jammu and Kashmir, Himachal Pradesh, Uttarakhand and east Uttar Pradesh during July 19-21.

Likewise, Arunachal Pradesh, Assam, Meghalaya, Nagaland, Manipur, Mizoram and Tripura are bracing for very heavy rainfall which is expected to continue till July 19.

Heatwave conditions will prevail over coastal Andhra Pradesh, Yanam, Rayalaseema, Tamil Nadu, Puducherry, Karikal on July 17. Muggy weather will prevail over Punjab, Haryana, Chandigarh, Delhi, Uttar Pradesh, Telangana, coastal Andhra Pradesh, Yanam and Rayalaseema till July 22.

Real Creator IAS Edition https://t.me/+2RvD_RG9rmljMzg1

715/720: Panshul Bansal, Aryan Gupta share top NEET-UG rank

Express News Service
New Delhi, July 16

THE NATIONAL Testing Agency (NTA) on Wednesday declared the result of the National Eligibility cum Entrance Test (Undergraduate), NEET (UG) 2026, with Aryan Gupta from Punjab and Panshul Bansal from Haryana jointly securing the highest score of 715 out of 720 marks.

Among the State Toppers, Jigmet Yangchan Lamo from Ladakh scored 530 marks, Dhruv Tripathi from the Andaman and Nicobar Islands scored 606 marks, and Fahmida Anees from Lakshadweep scored 573 marks.

State Toppers were recorded across every North-Eastern state as well. Of the State Toppers, 17 scored 700 marks or above, while 26 scored above 690 marks.

Beyond the top scorers, the NTA data showed that 1,492 candidates scored 650 marks and above, 10,160 candidates scored 600 marks and above, and 90,780 candidates scored 500 marks and above.

According to the NTA, a total of 19 candidates scored above 700 out of 720 marks.

The Top 17 rankers who scored more than 705 marks came from eight states — Punjab, Haryana, Rajasthan, Uttar Pradesh, Maharashtra, Bihar, Tamil Nadu, and Telangana.

In all, 138 candidates scored above 690 marks, coming from 66 cities across the country. Of these top scorers, over 93 per cent appeared for NEET (UG) for the first time, and 99 per cent were between 17 and 19 years of age.

Close to 20 lakh candidates appeared for NEET (UG) 2026, held on June 21, 2026, at 5,440 centres spread across 551 cities in India and 14 cities abroad.



Panshul Bansal at his residence

Of these, 11.21 lakh candidates have qualified for admission to undergraduate medical, dental, AYUSH, and allied programmes.

The NTA said the result was declared in time to keep the medical admission and counselling calendar on track.

Scorecards for all candidates, along with the full list of Top Rankers, State Toppers, category-wise toppers, category-wise cut-off marks, and language-wise participation data, are available on the official website, neet.nta.nic.in.

More than 58 per cent of all qualified candidates are women.

The NTA noted that women also qualified at a higher rate than men — 56.8 per cent of women who appeared qualified, compared to 55.1 per cent of men who appeared.

As per the NTA, the category-wise break-up of qualified candidates is as follows: General category, 2.91 lakh; OBC-NCL, 5.12 lakh; SC, 1.59 lakh; ST, 63,716; Gen-EWS, 95,026; PwBD, 3,666; and PwD, 303. Category-wise cut-off marks and percentiles have also been published simultaneously.

NEET-UG was conducted in 13 languages

Driving Infrastructure, Industry, Employment and Growth

Ghaziabad

Inauguration/Foundation Stone Laying of 90 Development Projects Worth ₹868 Crore+

Across the Muradnagar and Modi Nagar Assembly Constituencies

Distribution of Laptops/Cheques/Keys/Appreciation Letters to Beneficiaries of Various Government Schemes

by **Yogi Adityanath**
Chief Minister, Uttar Pradesh

Sunil Kumar Sharma
Minister, Electronics and Information Technology, Uttar Pradesh

Narendra Kumar Kashyap
Minister of State (Independent Charge), Backward Class Welfare, Divyangjan Empowerment, Uttar Pradesh

Sunita Dayal
Mayor, Ghaziabad

Mamta Tyagi
Chairperson, District Panchayat, Ghaziabad

Atul Garg
MP, Ghaziabad

Dr. Rajkumar Sangwan
MP, Baghpat

Shrichand Sharma
MLC

Dinesh Kumar Goyal
MLC

Dharmendra Kumar Bhardwaj
MLC

Nand Kishor Gurjar
MLA, Loni

Ajit Pal Tyagi
MLA, Muradnagar

Sanjeev Sharma
MLA, Ghaziabad

Dr. Manju Shiwach
MLA, Modi Nagar

Dharmesh Singh Tomar
MLA, Dholana

and other dignitaries

Date: 17th July, 2026 | Time: 4:00 PM | Venue: Tejpal Singh Tyagi Kushal Pal Tyagi Memorial Degree College, Rawli Road, Muradnagar, Ghaziabad

Key Projects for Inauguration

856 EWS housing units under the PM Awas Yojana at Madhuban-Bapudham Residential Scheme worth **₹47 Crore+**

Barracks for PAC personnel at the 47th Battalion PAC worth **₹15 Crore+**

Key Projects for Foundation Stone Laying

Drinking Water Supply Schemes worth **₹14 Crore+** covering Patti, Bhadaula, Hirdalpur Bhandola, Kanakpur, Sheerpur, Shakurpur, Shikhaida Hajari and Yusufpur Ishapur.

Drug Warehouse worth **₹10 Crore+**

Flyover at Hapur Chungi Intersection worth **₹125 Crore**

2-Lane bridge over the Hindon River between Mataura and Daulcha Border, along with approach roads, additional approach road & protective works, worth **₹21 Crore+**

Widening and strengthening of the Modi Nagar-Hapur Road worth **₹38 Crore+**

Widening and strengthening of the Muradnagar-Rawli-Surana Road (Chainage 0.00-5.00 km) worth **₹20 Crore**

Vikas Ki Gati Apaar-Double Engine Sarkar

Information and Public Relations Department, U.P.
[LIVE TELECAST](#) DD NEWS & Youtube.com/DDNEWS

Every Effort, Every Step Towards Development

epaper.indianexpress.com

New Delhi

Monsoon Session: BJP likely to table 5 new Bills; ‘delimitation package’ not on agenda for now

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Wife a suspect as Karnataka doctor is killed, son stabbed

Express News Service
Bengaluru, July 16

A 45-YEAR-old anaesthetist was allegedly murdered inside his apartment in Karnataka’s Dharwad, while his eight-year-old son was left critically injured with multiple stab wounds. The police have detained the doctor’s 42-year-old wife, the only other adult present in the flat, who was allegedly found sitting beside her husband’s body and looking at her mobile phone when officials arrived on Wednesday night.

The police said they are treating the case as suspected murder and attempted murder and investigating the sequence of events and the motive behind the incident.

The victim, Dr Kiran Honanavar, was an anaesthetist at Chirayu Hospital. His body was found with multiple injuries in-

side a room of the family’s sixth-floor apartment at Ranka Apartment, opposite Pawan High School. In another room, the couple’s son was found lying in a pool of blood with multiple stab injuries. He was rushed to a private hospital, where he remains in critical condition. According to police, the only occupants of the apartment at the time of the incident were Dr Kiran, his wife, Dr Priyanka Katanahalli, 42, an ophthalmologist, and their son. Investigators said there were no signs of forced entry into the apartment and suspect Priyanka’s involvement in the crimes.

Hubballi-Dharwad Police Commissioner N Shashikumar said: “There were only three people inside the house—the husband, wife and child.” There are no signs of forced entry. We need to investigate what happened.”

T Srinivasa Kumar appointed Earth Sciences Secy

Express News Service
New Delhi, July 16

T SRINIVASA Kumar, former head of the Hyderabad-based Indian National Centre for Ocean Information Services (INCOIS), has been appointed the new Secretary in the Ministry of Earth Sciences, a government order said on Thursday.

Srinivasa was currently working as the head of the Indian Ocean Tsunami Warning and Mitigation System (IOTWMS) secretariat in Perth, Australia. Srinivasa has been appointed for two years, the government order said.

He succeeds M Ravichandran, who retired in May this year after a nearly five-year stint in office. Srinivasa is one of the architects of India’s tsunami early warning system, having served as its project director.

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Sunita Dayal
Mayor, Ghaziabad

Mamta Tyagi
Chairperson, District Panchayat, Ghaziabad

Atul Garg
MP, Ghaziabad

Dr. Rajkumar Sangwan
MP, Baghpat

Shrichand Sharma
MLC

Dinesh Kumar Goyal
MLC

Dharmendra Kumar Bhardwaj
MLC

Nand Kishor Gurjar
MLA, Loni

Ajit Pal Tyagi
MLA, Muradnagar

Sanjeev Sharma
MLA, Ghaziabad

Dr. Manju Shiwach
MLA, Modi Nagar

Dharmesh Singh Tomar
MLA, Dholana

and other dignitaries

Muradnagar

Inauguration
21 Projects worth **₹153 Crore**

Foundation Stone Laying
42 Projects worth **₹614 Crore+**

Modi Nagar

Inauguration
12 Projects worth **₹30 Crore+**

Foundation Stone Laying
15 Projects worth **₹71 Crore+**

Key Projects for Inauguration

- 856 EWS housing units under the PM Awas Yojana at Madhuban-Bapudham Residential Scheme worth **₹47 Crore+**
- Barracks for PAC personnel at the 47th Battalion PAC worth **₹15 Crore+**

Key Projects for Foundation Stone Laying

- Drinking Water Supply Schemes worth **₹14 Crore+** covering Patti, Bhadaula, Hirdalpur Bhandola, Kanakpur, Sheerpur, Shakurpur, Shikhalda Hajari and Yusufpur Ishapur.
- Drug Warehouse worth **₹10 Crore+**

Key Projects for Foundation Stone Laying

- Flyover at Hapur Chungi Intersection worth **₹125 Crore**
- 2-Lane bridge over the Hindon River between Matauri and Daulcha Border, along with approach roads, additional approach road & protective works, worth **₹21 Crore+**

Key Projects for Foundation Stone Laying

- Widening and strengthening of the Modi Nagar-Hapur Road worth **₹38 Crore+**
- Widening and strengthening of the Muradnagar-Rawli-Surana Road (Chainage 0.00-5.00 km) worth **₹20 Crore**

Vikas Ki Gati Apaar-Double Engine Sarkar

Information and Public Relations Department, U.P.

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New Delhi

SC judge flags Class 9 stress, suggests third language from Class 6

Remarks came after TN raised concerns over the three-language policy during a hearing on Navodaya schools

Express News Service
New Delhi, July 16

THE SUPREME Court said on Friday that the third language should be introduced in Class 6, not Class 9, observing that learning a new language a year before board examinations can be stressful for students.

Presiding over a two-judge bench, Justice B V Nagarathna made the remarks while hearing an appeal by the Tamil Nadu government challenging a Madras High Court direction to facilitate the establishment of Jawahar Navodaya Vidyalayas (JNVs) in every district of the state. The High Court had held that the state's refusal to permit JNVs curtailed students' right to choose educational institutions and was inconsistent with the Right of Children to Free and Compulsory Education Act of 2009.

The bench, also comprising Justice R Mahadevan, counselled the state not to oppose every Central scheme merely because they come from the Centre. "You may have your education system, but don't prevent the Central government schools. Don't have this attitude that 'it is the Union government, why should we accept it,'" Justice Nagarathna said.

'Beef raid' on house in UP: Police arrest four more after 'encounter'

Manish Sahu
Lucknow, July 16

NEARLY THREE weeks after it arrested three women after a raid on a house in Kaushambi's Sarai Akil area over allegations of cow slaughter and cooking of beef, police have made more arrests in connection with the case following an "encounter".

According to police, they received information that the accused were hiding in an orchard. When they reached the spot, the suspects opened fire, police said, and in the exchange, Mohammad Arshad alias Chedan sustained a bullet injury to his leg. Three other suspects, Sunne alias Iliyay Khan, Nafees and Fakrul, were arrested, while two of the accused managed to escape, police said.

Kaushambi Circle Officer Shivank Singh said a forensic report from a laboratory in Mathura had confirmed that the meat samples seized during the June 24 raid from Arshad's house in Kaushambi were that of beef. The accused have been booked under various provisions of the Uttar Pradesh Prevention of Cow Slaughter Act at Sarai Akil Police Station in Kaushambi.

The three women who were held during the June 24 raid, Shama Parveen, Shaista and Fatima, are related to Arshad, who has six previous criminal cases registered against him, the last of them in 2016. All four

The CBSE's three-language policy has been challenged before the Supreme Court in petitions pending before a bench presided over by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant.

While the three-language policy was not a direct issue in the matter heard on Thursday, the Tamil Nadu Government counsel flagged the state's concerns regarding the policy during the hearing. This invited the comments from the bench.

Justice Nagarathna pointed out that as per the policy, "The state language has to be taught, English has to be taught and any third language. It doesn't say Hindi." The counsel appearing for the petitioner, on whose plea the Madras HC passed its order, said the National Education Policy (NEP) bars the imposition of any language on any state. This prompted Justice Nagarathna to ask, "You don't want Hindi, but if it's Sanskrit, what is the issue?"

When informed that the third language becomes mandatory only from Class 9, Justice Nagarathna said, "That is very bad. The ninth standard is stressful. Why do you introduce a new language in the ninth grade? You introduce it in the sixth."

"Union of India, please don't have a third language in the ninth standard," she said. "CBSE, ICSE, State Board, tenth standard is a board exam. From the end of the eighth standard onwards, the pressure starts... Don't start a new language in 9th. Start it in 6th..."

Fixing the matter for hearing next on August 11, the court noted that discussions between the Centre and the state on the issue are still on and that the question of hearing it on merits would arise only if they fail.

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are residents of Panara Gopalpur village.

The other two held are from the neighbouring villages of Khanpur Pathanpurwa and Khopa. Police said Nafees and Fakrul's names had come up during the course of the investigation.

The absconding accused are the husbands of Shaista and Fatima, identified as Irfan and Badkau.

Police had announced a reward of Rs 25,000 for information leading to the arrest of the accused.

Officials said they raided Arshad's house based on a tip-off that beef was being cooked there. When they reached the spot, police said, several men ran out of the house and fled, and they arrested the three women present.

Panara Gopalpur is a village of about 6,000 residents with a mixed population, and located around 30 km from the Kaushambi district headquarters.

Sushil Pathak, a "representative" of Panara Gopalpur sarpanch Cheedi Lal, said Arshad had previously been accused of cattle smuggling but had recently switched to trading goats. Expressing surprise at the allegations against the family, Pathak said their relatives who also live in the area are caring for the children of the women.

The relatives could not be contacted.

DAYS AFTER ASSAM RIFLES CAMP TARGETED IN SENAPATI DISTRICT

CRPF redraws SOP for Manipur

Lays stress on use of bulletproof vehicles, women personnel in troop movement

Mahender Singh Manral
New Delhi, July 16

DAYS AFTER a mob attacked an Assam Rifles camp in Senapati district of Manipur, the Central Reserve Police Force (CRPF) has reworked its strategy for troop movement and field deployment in the state.

Sources said the revised instructions place strong emphasis on protected and guarded movement of personnel, both for administrative duties and operational tasks.

Around 100 bulletproof vehicles have been sent to Manipur to strengthen force protection and mobility, officials



Charred remains of a vehicle that was torched by a mob in Manipur's Senapati district, Wednesday.

said. CRPF personnel have been directed to move only in bulletproof vehicles in sensitive areas, said sources.

"Administrative movement, which often involves routine deployment, supply,

coordination and movement between camps or duty points, has also been brought under tighter security protocol. Such movement will now have to be well-guarded and planned in advance," an official said.

As part of the revised strategy, women personnel will be included in troop movement teams, as and when required. This decision was taken in view of recent instances when women protesters took the lead in surrounding security forces during operations or movement, an official said.

The CRPF has also deployed two CoBRA (Commando Battalion for Resolute Action) battalions in the state. "One of the key responsibilities of the CoBRA units will be to destroy bunkers allegedly set up by outlawed groups belonging to the Kukli, Meitei and Naga communities. Security forces are also clearing suspected ambush points, particularly along curves, hilly stretches and for-

ested routes, where convoys are considered vulnerable," the official said.

According to officials, around 320 companies of the Central Armed Police Forces (CAPFs), excluding the Assam Rifles, are currently deployed in Manipur, as part of the Centre's efforts to stabilise the security situation in the state, which has witnessed prolonged ethnic violence.

The CRPF is also working to reduce hostility from Kuki groups with confidence-building measures and careful deployment patterns to prevent further escalation, said officials.

On Tuesday night, a mob targeted an Assam Rifles camp, following a search operation to tracks suspected armed cadres of the NSCN (IM). The mob resorted to stone-pelting, arson and vandalism, prompting security forces to fire blank rounds and teargas shells to disperse the crowd, officials said.

EXPRESS special

A hospital visit, a forgotten family name: How a murder accused from Kerala was caught after 39 years

Shaju Philip
Thiruvananthapuram, July 16

WHEN HE slipped into Tamil Nadu 39 years ago after his brother-in-law was hacked to death, Mohanan Pillai from Veliyam village in Kerala's Kollam district hoped to shed all traces of his past. He allegedly changed everything about himself – he slipped into a new identity, married and rebuilt his life.

That is, until a tiny slip during a hospital visit led the police straight back to him. This week, Mohanan Pillai Kodyattu was arrested for the murder of his brother-in-law Chandrasekharan Pillai, bringing an end to a four-decade-long search. In the time that passed, much had changed: Mohanan, now 64 and going by Rajan Keshavan, became the father of two children, earned a living through odd jobs at hotels and shops, and had allegedly become an alcoholic.

"We probed into details of Mohanan's family. Our team accidentally stumbled on a person who told us that a few months ago, he had met someone at the Kottayam Government Medical College Hospital asking about the Kodyattu family in Veliyam," says investigating officer



This week, Mohanan Pillai Kodyattu (left) was arrested for the murder of his brother-in-law Chandrasekharan Pillai (right), bringing an end to a four-decade-long search.



and Pooyappally SHO O P Shajimon. According to the police, Mohanan hacked his brother-in-law Chandrasekharan Pillai to death on January 11, 1987. Chandrasekharan, then 35, used to brew illicit liquor and allegedly kept it at Mohanan's house, leading to disagreements between them. That day, the disagreements allegedly came to a head, and Mohanan went to get a machete from a neighbour's house and slit Chandrasekharan's neck. Investigators would find this weapon at the house.

Soon after, he allegedly went into hiding, slipping into Tamil Nadu and working as a hotel agent in the Christian pil-

grimage town of Velankanni in Nagapattinam district. Here, he met his wife Valsa, who worked with a Kottayam-based family on pilgrimage.

"While staying at a hotel, Rajan struck up an acquaintance with all of us. He was offered a job by the family at their rubber nursery in Kottayam," Valsa says. Taking up the family's offer, Rajan went to Kottayam months later and eventually asked to marry Valsa. The couple have two children — a 37-year-old daughter and 35-year-old son.

"My family was poor and my older brother was struggling to marry me off. Hence, the propo-

sal from Rajan, who pretended to be an orphan, was irresistible for all of us. We started living in my house and he was known after our house name Kalayil," Valsa says.

Investigators back in Veliyam went on a manhunt, conducting searches as far away as Mumbai, where Mohanan had worked earlier. Then, even without a suspect in custody, a chargesheet was filed but the trial was kept in abeyance. Soon, the crime faded from everyone's memory except a few police officers and the case went cold.

Recently, the police revived the case and began looking for fresh leads. It was during this that they allegedly found the information that led them to Mohanan. "That person was learnt to be inquiring after the Kodyattu family, and had also revealed that he was living in Kottayam's Kallara village," the SHO says. "Our team went to Kottayam district and shared details with various stations."

In Kottayam, the police found that Mohanan was now married and a father, had taken up jobs at hotels and local shops.

The police are now waiting to conduct DNA tests to formally confirm his identity as Mohanan.

Kandhamal riots investigation reports missing, former CMO officials summoned in Odisha

Sujit Bisoyi
Bhubaneswar, July 16

THE ODISHA Police have summoned two former senior bureaucrats who served in the chief minister's office (CMO) under the previous Biju Janata Dal government as part of an investigation into the alleged disappearance of two inquiry commission reports.

Summons have been issued to retired IAS officer Rajesh Verma and former Indian Railway Traffic Service (IRTS) officer Manoj Mishra as part of the investigation into the alleged

disappearance of two reports — one pertaining to the killing of Hindu seer Laxmananda Saraswati in Kandhamal in 2008, and the other on the fire at SUM medical college in 2016.

The two retired bureaucrats have been asked to appear on July 22. They did not respond to calls and texts for a comment.

"You are requested to bring with you any documents, records, electronic devices or any other material relevant to the investigation that may be in your possession or control," the notice issued to Verma on Wednesday said.

Verma served as principal secretary to former chief minister Naveen Patnaik between 2017 and 2019 and served as secretary to President Droupadi Murmu after joining the central deputation in 2022. Mishra served as secretary of the Electronics and IT Department and as officer on special duty (OSD) in the CMO during the BJD rule. Mishra resigned after the change of government in June 2024.

Police sources said that since the two retired officials appear to be acquainted "with the facts and circumstances of

the case", they were asked to appear for examination and extend cooperation.

The complainant alleged that while several other reports and files forwarded by the home department to the CMO were returned on June 4, 2024 — when the Assembly election results became clear — these two are still missing.

The FIR claimed that the "disappearance" of the reports created a reasonable suspicion that they may have been "intentionally removed, retained, concealed, destroyed or otherwise unlawfully dealt with".

• BRIEFLY



Firefighters douse the bus fire in Ramban's Karol on Thursday.

JAMMU AND KASHMIR

Narrow escape for 47 Amarnath pilgrims after their bus catches fire

FORTY SEVEN Amarnath pilgrims, on Thursday had a narrow escape after their bus caught fire along the Jammu-Srinagar national highway near Karol in Ramban district of Jammu and Kashmir. The pilgrims from Rajasthan were on their way home after darshan at Amarnath shrine in South Kashmir Himalayas, officials said, adding the incident took place around 4.15 pm. The police control room at Ramban confirmed the fire incident, adding that all the passengers were evacuated safely. Eye witnesses said the CRPF personnel deployed at Karol noticed the fire and immediately started evacuating the passengers. Teams of Army, SDRF, Fire and Emergency Services, and others joined them. ENS

3 minor boys drown in pit in Chhattisgarh

TWO MINOR siblings and another boy drowned in a rainwater-filled pit in Chhattisgarh's Rajnandgaon district, police said on Thursday. A 4-year-old boy and two brothers, both aged 8 went out to play. When they didn't return, their family and villagers launched a search and found the bodies in a water-filled pit at night, a police officer said. The pit was allegedly created after excavation of soil for some work several months back. It got filled with rainwater following recent showers, he said. Villagers alleged the deep pit was left unsecured and demanded stern action against those responsible. The exact cause would be ascertained after an investigation, the official said. PTI

Mumbai FDA suspends licence of Parsi Dairy

THE MAHARASHTRA FDA suspended the food licence of Mumbai-based Parsi Dairy Farm Pvt Ltd after finding serious food safety and hygiene violations, officials said on Thursday. It was part of a statewide enforcement drive in which food items worth more than Rs 1.90 crore were seized, they added. The inspection conducted on July 14, found fungal growth on walls of the storage and production areas, raw material stored on the floor and no protected Raw Milk Reception Dock for receiving raw milk. During the suspension, the establishment is barred from manufacturing, storing, selling, or distributing food items, and any violation will invite legal action. ENS

At least 2 dead, many hurt in crowd surge during Puri Rath Yatra

Sujit Bisoyi
Puri, July 16

AT LEAST TWO men died and over 100 were hospitalised following an "unprecedented rush" of devotees during the Rath Yatra of Lord Jagannath in Puri on Thursday, officials said.

The two men who died were aged 60 and 35. Officials said the 60-year-old collapsed during the rush, after which he was rushed to a hospital, where doctors declared him dead. The exact cause of his death remains to be ascertained. The 35-year-old man suffered a cardiac arrest and died despite receiving immediate medical attention, the officials said.

As many as 100 devotees were admitted to the district hospital in Puri with injuries and other medical issues due to the commotion, officials said, adding that all those hospitalised were in stable condition. The state government had deployed nearly 12,000 police personnel, 19 senior IPS officers and over 100 senior administrative officers, and sought "proper coordination and

seamless communication" among inter-departmental agencies, in an effort to ensure a safe and incident-free Rath Yatra as Puri prepared to welcome lakhs of devotees from across the globe for the nine-day festival that started on Thursday. Nearly 30 lakh devotees from India and abroad are expected to visit Puri during the course of the festival.

Despite persistent rain and inclement weather, an estimated 8-9 lakh devotees had arrived in Puri to witness the Rath Yatra, during which the sibling deities, Lord Jagannath, Lord Balabhadra and Goddess Subhadra, are believed to embark on an annual sojourn from their 12th-century temples to Gundicha Temple. Devotees pull three large decorated chariots to mark the day. The Bahuda Yatra, scheduled for July 24, marks their return.

A statement issued by the Chief Minister's Office claimed the overall conduct of the festival was peaceful, orderly and well managed. It said there was no stamped incident or any systemic breakdown of crowd management.

SEXUAL ASSAULT CASE

Tarun Tejpal's counsel claims complainant not 'sterling witness', points to 'contradictions'

Pavneet Singh Chadha
Panaji, July 16

WHILE OPPOSING the state's plea challenging his acquittal, Tarun Tejpal, the former editor-in-chief of *Tehelka*, who was accused of sexually assaulting his then colleague in a Goa hotel in 2013, told the High Court of Bombay at Goa on Thursday that the complainant's testimony was not of a "sterling witness", claiming that there were contradictions in her testimony.

A journalist had complained that Tejpal sexually assaulted her in the hotel elevator on November 7, 2013, and November 8, 2013. In 2021, a sessions court in Goa acquitted

Tejpal of all charges, observing that the complainant "did not demonstrate any kind of normative behaviour" that a victim of sexual assault "might plausibly show". The Goa government had subsequently filed an appeal in the High Court of Bombay at Goa, challenging the acquittal, and arguments in the case are ongoing.

Relying on the CCTV footage played in the court, Aabad Ponda, the counsel for Tejpal, told the High Court that there were contradictions in the testimony of the complainant during the trial regarding the circumstances and sequence of events in the lift of the hotel on the day of the alleged incident.

Skyroot to launch Vikram-1 orbital rocket tomorrow

Anonna Dutt
New Delhi, July 16

INDIAN SPACE-TECH startup Skyroot Aerospace will attempt the first orbital launch of its indigenously developed rocket, Vikram-1, on Saturday, July 18, at 11.30 am, from the country's premier spaceport at the Satish Dhawan Space Centre in Sriharikota. The mission, named 'Aagamam', meaning 'arrival', marks a milestone for India's private space sector: the nation's first-ever attempt to place a payload into orbit using a completely privately developed launch vehicle.

All necessary airspace and maritime notices have been issued establishing restricted zones during the launch window, according to the company.

"We have done everything that could be done to test Vik-

ram-1 on the ground. On July 18, we are eager to see how Vikram-1 performs in a real flight environment for the first time," said Pawan Kumar Chandna, co-founder and CEO of the company.

"This is our first test flight, and we will be getting valuable data from it. This will be foundational to Skyroot's aspirations of establishing launch cadence. We are excited to see this through," he added.

Even in its first flight, Vikram-1 will carry several technology demonstrations from the Indian earth-observation nanosatellite maker Grahaa Space, Indian space debris removal company CosmoServe, space component developer DCubed, and its own SCOPE satellite, which will collect important flight data. Aside from this, Vikram-1 will also carry a

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India's first private orbital rocket, Vikram-1, stands fully stacked at Sriharikota for the upcoming 'Mission Aagamam' test flight.

CREDIT: INSTAGRAM/@SKYROOTAEROSPACE

diamond art piece called Cosmic Bloom from Cosmos Diamonds and a micro-art piece. "This test flight will show us how every technology we have developed over the years performs in real-world conditions. With the in-flight data gathered from this mission, we will return to the shop floor to learn, improve, and build further. This test flight is the first step towards creating a reliable, on-demand launch company for the world from India," said Naga Bharath Daka, co-founder and COO of the company.

Vikram-1 launcher

Named in honour of Dr Vikram Sarabhai, the father of India's space programme, the launcher stands seven storeys tall. It is engineered to deliver small satellites weighing up to

350 kg to Low Earth Orbit (LEO). For this launch, it is targeting a 450 km orbit at a 60-degree inclination.

Alongside Skyroot's Vikram-1, Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO)'s own Small Satellite Launch Vehicle (SSLV) and Agnikul's under-development rockets are set to expand India's capability to launch satellites in this region of space. This is significant given the increasing number of companies developing small satellites intended for low Earth orbit, such as the fleets by internet providers Starlink and OneWeb.

So far, two Indian launch vehicle developers, including Skyroot, have demonstrated sub-orbital flights — vehicles that take a satellite to outer space but lack sufficient velocity to put it into orbit.

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If there are questions of current or contemporary relevance that you would like explained, please write to explained@indianexpress.com

DONATION CONTROVERSY

Vaishno Devi ‘silver’ row: How the shrine stores, guards offerings

Arun Sharma
Jammu, July 16

A COURT in Jammu is hearing a plea claiming possible adulteration and misappropriation of silver worth around Rs 550 crore donated by devotees at the Shri Mata Vaishno Devi Shrine. The controversy arose from reports that only around 5-6% of the approximately 20 tonnes of the shrine’s accumulated silver offerings was found to be actual silver. The complainant sought an investigation into whether devotees had been sold fake silver articles, or whether genuine silver offerings had been diluted and pilfered after their receipt.

What is offered at the shrine?

Each year, nearly one crore pilgrims visit the Shri Mata Vaishno Devi Shrine in the Trikuta hills in Jammu division. They commonly donate cash, and gold and silver items. In earlier years, the gold items donated at the shrine each month would weigh a total of 2-2.5 kg. But as prices increased over the years, donations of the yellow metal mint dipped to around a kilo each month.

Meanwhile, offerings of “silver” are at nearly 100 kg each month. This silver is in the form of “chhatars” (umbrellas or parasols), coins or ornaments. These donated chhatars, coins and ornaments have now reportedly been found to contain a very low proportion of the metal.

Shrine officials say they have found no purity issues with the gold items donated at the shrine. They say these gold offerings are found to contain 70-75% of pure gold on testing. But these officials also believe that this purity may also decline in the future owing to the increasing prices of the yellow metal and the circulation of 16 gram (gm), 14 gm and even one gm gold jewellery in the market.

PURITY DEBATE

Shrine Board officials say the low percentage of silver does not necessarily imply wrongdoing as the items may not have been of the highest purity in the first place.

But others claim that pilgrims would not deliberately donate ‘fake’ silver items to their deity.

How did the controversy arise?

The Shri Mata Vaishno Devi Shrine Board had reportedly sent around 20 tonnes of accumulated silver, stated to be worth around Rs 550 crore, for testing, melting and processing to a government mint outside Jammu and Kashmir. When the melted material was tested to check its purity, it was reportedly found to contain only 5-6% of silver. The rest was cadmium, iron and cheap materials. Cadmium is a cheap, toxic metal that resembles silver.

The question that arises here is this: Were the offerings made by the devotees made of adulterated silver in the first place, or whether any adulteration took place after the donations were made.

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How are these offerings tracked at the shrine?

Pilgrims place gold, silver and cash in donation boxes within the shrine complex. These boxes are double locked, kept under 24x7 CCTV surveillance and guarded by CRPF personnel and the guards from the shrine board. When these boxes get filled, an officer of the rank of Sub Divisional Magistrate (SDM) and a shrine board official open them and count the cash. The gold and silver items are weighed separately and then sealed in packets for safe custody in a strongroom. The entire exercise is carried out under CCTV surveillance. The strongroom, too, is guarded round the clock by CRPF personnel. After five-six months, when an ample quantity of these gold and silver items get accumulated, they are brought down to Katra town, sometimes via helicopter, under the watchful eyes of CRPF personnel, shrine board officials and the SDM. The seals on the packets are checked and weighed again before keeping them in another strong-room at the shrine board office, again guarded by personnel from a Central Armed Police Force.

What happens to the melted material?

After deriving gold and silver in their pure form from it, the shrine board gets coins manufactured from the government mint itself with photographs of Mata Vaishno Devi inscribed on them. These coins are later sold by the shrine board to pilgrims with a guaranteed purity of 99.9%.

‘THE ODYSSEY’ RELEASES TODAY

Nolan’s vision and India’s screens

Only 41 theatres across the world can project *The Odyssey* in its native 15/70mm format. India doesn’t have one



ARAV SHAH

THE RELEASE of *The Odyssey* today marks a landmark technical achievement in cinema — it is the first full length feature film shot entirely on an IMAX camera. Christopher Nolan has advocated that his films be watched on an IMAX screen that projects the analog 15 perforation/70mm film reel developed from the original colour negative (OCN).

While IMAX cameras capture better image resolution and details than others, they are both expensive and inconvenient to regularly handle due to their size and deafening internal motors. To bypass this, Nolan and the IMAX team created a new camera titled the ‘Keighley Camera’. This camera is housed inside a novel carbon-fibre casing termed “The Blimp”, reducing the sound of the motors by 30-50%.

India, however, will only screen digital versions of the film.

First, the basics

The 15 perforation/70mm film reel refers to the physical reel where the strip’s width is 70mm with 15 perforations or sprocket holes punched alongside its edge. These holes advance the film frames during projection. This technique yields an image resolution equivalent to 18K and a towering 1.43:1 aspect ratio.

This aspect ratio is the proportion between the width and height of the displayed image. A 1.43:1 aspect ratio essentially means that the projected film appears taller with a square finish as opposed to the standard rectangular images in most films. This set-up results in each frame of the movie being roughly 10 times larger than a standard 35mm film frame.

Post-production

The Odyssey’s OCN was spliced together manually. In a conversation with *The Indian Express*, Andrew Oran, Senior Vice President at FotoKem Labs (did *Oppenheimer*’s prints; only lab that can do features of this length for 15p/70mm) said: “It is true that the film was spliced together by hand, and that all 70mm/15perf. prints were made from the original cut negative.” Once the film is captured on celluloid, the post-production process is what sets apart the analog print of *The Odyssey* from other versions. The process largely followed these steps:

- Once the raw film leaves the movie sets, it reaches the lab where it goes through a processor — running through developer and fixer baths — before hitting the drying rack.
- By the end of production, these rolls are digitised and scenes requiring VFX edits sent to the appropriate workshop. After the limited digital edits, these parts of the film are printed back onto the 15 perf./70mm film.
- Then, the negatives are physically cut and glued together by the post-production lab — in this case, FotoKem in Burbank, California.
- The OCN then undergoes a photo-chemical colour correction process.
- The photonegative is run through a contact printer that projects light through the OCN onto blank positive film stock to create the final print. These release prints are then dried after a final chemical bath.

Massive image, massive reels

The labour-intensive process involved



Christopher Nolan shoots ‘The Odyssey’ on an IMAX camera.

Not all IMAX screens are built the same

The theatre near you may advertise an IMAX screen, but there are multiple variants. The first two, the highest-grade offerings, are not available in India.

IMAX 15/70 MM: Christopher Nolan’s recommendation, it reproduces the true analog version of the film. The physical film runs horizontally through a projector. The maximum aspect ratio is 1.43:1 — which provides the biggest image possible. The resolution is between 12K-18K.

IMAX GT (Grand Theatre) Dual Laser: The only digital IMAX format capable of achieving a 1.43:1 aspect ratio. It uses two in-sync 4K laser projectors. The resolution is 4K (4096x2160 pixels).

IMAX CoLa: Digital projector used for medium-to-large halls using a single 4K laser. The resolution is 4K & maximum aspect ratio is 1.90:1. Employs dual-lens to project two overlapping images for deeper contrast

IMAX XT: Single lens 4K laser projector. While aspect ratio is 1.90:1, only one image is projected instead of two overlapping ones. An option for smaller/retrofitted auditoriums.

IMAX Xenon: Oldest of the three technologies available in India. The resolution caps out at 2K. Aspect ratio remains 1.90:1.

What’s an IMAX camera?

A special movie camera that records much larger and more detailed images than a regular camera.

Nolan shot the entirety of ‘The Odyssey’ on the novel Keighley camera — named after two top IMAX executives

in preparing the film ensures that the visual data remains purely analog from the lens to the projector.

“The most intensive period of the post-production process for FotoKem was when we were creating the master printing negatives in all three film formats — 70mm/15 perf., 70mm/5 perf. and 35mm—all at the same time,” Oran said.

This maintains a theoretical resolution equivalent to 18K—up to three times the fidelity of the best digital cinema cameras available today. This enhanced resolution and aspect ratio delivers a final print weighing approximately 240 kilograms (530-600lbs), requiring a specialised 68-inch transport platter just to hold the reel.

“Our (FotoKem) role in relation to the 70mm/15 perf. release on *The Odyssey* was to provide prints of each of the film’s 54 reels to IMAX, who QC-screened and assembled the prints for shipping,” Oran said. The official theatrical run-time of 2 hours and 52 minutes comprises more than 17 kilometres of celluloid for a single 15/70mm print.

Differing from standard 35mm film, the 15/70mm film runs horizontally (instead of vertically) through a cinema projector, pulling 15 perforations per frame.

Today, there are only 41 theatres across the globe equipped to project *The Odyssey* in its native 15/70mm format. India doesn’t have any such commercial theatre.

What India gets to see

The Indian IMAX landscape is currently populated by three tiers of digital projection: dual 2K Xenon systems, single-lens 4K Commercial Laser (CoLa) and the 4K XT Laser.

Both IMAX CoLa and XT systems are restricted by their architecture and digital systems to a maximum aspect ratio of 1.90:1. The CoLa projector is utilised for medium-to-large auditoriums and is typically paired with IMAX’s 12 channel audio system. The IMAX XT system is a newer

and cost-effective solution deployed in retrofitted multiplex screens (typically under 50 feet wide).

When *The Odyssey* — shot to fill a towering 1.43:1 canvas — is projected onto India’s 1.90:1 CoLa or XT screens, the image is expanded horizontally to fit the screen width, but the top and bottom of the frame are permanently truncated.

This does provide an advantage —Indian exhibitors do not receive a 300-kg metal platter containing sensitive film inside; they receive an encrypted, digital hard-drive (known as a key delivery mechanism) that greatly democratises the distribution of the film.

That one screen in Ahmedabad

Imagine a fully operational, meticulously maintained 15-perforation 70mm IMAX projector and a colossal 1.43:1 screen (measuring 97 feet by 67 feet) — the likes of which Nolan himself might enjoy watching his creation on.

Located in Ahmedabad, Gujarat Science City (GSC) boasts of exactly such a screen. But GSC, a government-owned venue, has a strictly educational mandate, aimed at fostering a scientific temperament for students and visitors.

Demand and permission issues aside, there are other barriers prohibiting *The Odyssey* from being screened here. First, the equipment and film prints imported by GSC are likely to benefit from specific customs duty exemptions reserved for educational material. Screening a for-profit feature could violate these import tariffs and breach the institution’s charter of focussing on science and education.

Second, the mechanical layout for projection is strictly tailored for short-form content, lasting around 40-50 minutes. Such features require considerably smaller film platters. *The Odyssey*’s 172-minute runtime means that the GSC’s platter ecosystem is not engineered to support its weight or spatial demands.

Before watching *The Odyssey*, a primer on the epic



ANAGHA JAYAKUMAR

CHRISTOPHER NOLAN’S adaptation of *The Odyssey* arrives in cinemas today, introducing one of the oldest surviving and foundational works of Western literature to a new generation of viewers.

Despite its enduring influence, many readers and filmgoers know *The Odyssey* more by reputation than by its story. Written nearly 3,000 years ago, it is a story of homecoming after war, set in a world populated by gods, monsters and mortals. Its themes, characters and adventures have influenced storytelling ever since.

What is *The Odyssey*?

The Odyssey is one of two epic poems traditionally attributed to the Greek poet Homer, and generally dated to the eighth century BCE. The other is *The Iliad*. Today, “epic” is often used to describe something monumental. In literature, however, an epic is a long narrative poem that typically deals with extraordinary figures, heroic deeds and the intervention of gods or other supernatural forces.

The Odyssey’s central figure is Odysseus, the king of Ithaca, renowned for his intelligence. The poem follows his long journey home after the war.

Both *The Iliad* and *The Odyssey* have sparked debate about their authorship, triggering what is known as the Homeric Question. Scholars continue to debate whether Homer was a historical individual, a name attached to an oral poetic tradition, or some combination of both.

KEY CHARACTERS

ODYSSEUS

The king of Ithaca. Known as Ulysses in Roman tradition. Known for his intelligence and adaptability, rather than brute strength. Played by Matt Damon.

PENELOPE

Queen of Ithaca, wife of Odysseus. Renowned for her intelligence, patience and resilience while resisting suitors. Played by Anne Hathaway.

TELEMACHUS

Son of Odysseus and Penelope. Comes of age while searching for news of his missing father. Played by Tom Holland.

ATHENA

Goddess of wisdom and warfare. Odysseus’ divine protector. Played by Zendaya.

POSEIDON

God of the sea and storms. Odysseus’ greatest adversary. No physical actor.

POLYPHEMUS

The cyclops who changes the course of the hero’s voyage. Played by Bill Irwin.

CALYPSO

Nymph who keeps Odysseus on her island for years. Played by Charlize Theron.

While *The Iliad* recounts the Trojan War, the poem follows Odysseus’ decade-long journey home after the war has ended. It is often cited as one of literature’s earliest and most influential “hero’s journeys”. The film, meanwhile, reportedly begins with the episode of the Trojan Horse, in which Odysseus devises the ruse that leads to Trojans dragging a giant wooden horse into their city.

AP reports that the film also includes elements from related stories such as Virgil’s poem *The Aeneid* and the play *Agamemnon*, a Greek tragedy by Aeschylus. The film appears to draw on the wider Trojan tradition, rather than being a page-for-page adaptation.

What’s the poem’s relevance?

Classical scholar Emily Wilson, in her 2018 translation of *The Odyssey*, says the poem is the story of a man who is “not ‘the’ man, but one of many men — albeit a man of extraordinary cognitive, psychological and military power”. She notes that, contrary to the reader’s expectations, *The Odyssey* recounts “the story of a man whose grand adventure is simply to go back to his own home... For this hero, mere survival is the most amazing feat of all.”

During the 2022 World Cup, meanwhile, Serbia were fined 20,000 Swiss francs for a banner they had hoisted in their dressing room which showed Kosovo as a part of Serbia and read: “No surrender.”

At the same World Cup, German players had covered their mouths with their hands ahead of a match, in a symbolic gesture to convey that FIFA were forcibly silencing players. The football body had warned teams against using OneLove armbands, celebrating gender inclusivity, with the tournament being held in Qatar, where same-sex relationship is criminalised.

FIFA did not sanction Germany for the protest.

SPORT

Argentina’s Falklands banner: Political gestures at World Cups and FIFA’s rules

Shuvaditya Bose

New Delhi, July 16

Why is the banner controversial?

The answer lies almost two centuries in the past. The Falkland Islands — or Islas Malvinas, as they are known in Argentina — have remained at the centre of a sovereignty dispute between Argentina and the UK since Britain reasserted control over the islands in 1833. Argentina argues that it inherited the sovereignty of these islands from Spain upon gaining independence in 1816, and therefore regards Britain’s occu-

pation as illegal. In 1982, the two countries fought a 74-day war that resulted in 649 Argentine casualties and 255 British deaths. Officially, Britain continues to administer the islands, with the majority of the residents voting to remain a British overseas territory during a referendum in 2013. But Argentina still considers the British protectorate essential to its national identity.

What are the rules on such gestures?

FIFA’s regulations state that any political banner or flags with political messages are strictly prohibited before, after and during a match in the immediate vicinity of the stadium. International Football Association Board (IFAB) regulations also prohibit players from using sporting equipment with political messaging.

FIFA’s code of conduct also says fans cannot “curse or chant in a political, offensive and/or discriminatory manner”. The world body is currently reviewing the on-field gesture in Atlanta under its rules prohibiting political messaging.



Argentina’s Giovanni Lo Celso holds a banner saying ‘The Falklands are Argentine’. AP

What have Argentina fans said or done at the World Cup on the dispute?

At the 2026 World Cup, Argentina’s unofficial anthem has been ‘Muchachos’:

En Argentina nací, (I was born in Argentina)

Tierra de Diego y Lionel, (Land of Diego and Lionel)

De los pibes de Malvinas, (Of the boys of the Malvinas)

Que jamás olvidaré (Whom I will never forget)

The last two lines are widely understood to be a tribute to the Argentine soldiers who died during the 1982 war. After the victory over England, the players also celebrated with the chant “*Por las Malvinas, por Diego y por el último de Leo* (For the Malvinas, for Diego, and for Leo’s last one)”

Have Argentina fans made references to the Falkland Islands earlier?

Something similar took place during Argentina’s friendly match against Slovenia in 2014. On that occasion, the players stood behind a banner with the exact wording of the one held up on Wednesday. On that occasion, FIFA had imposed a non-sporting sanction on Argentina. The federation was asked to pay 30,000 Swiss francs.

Have players made political gestures at World Cups before?

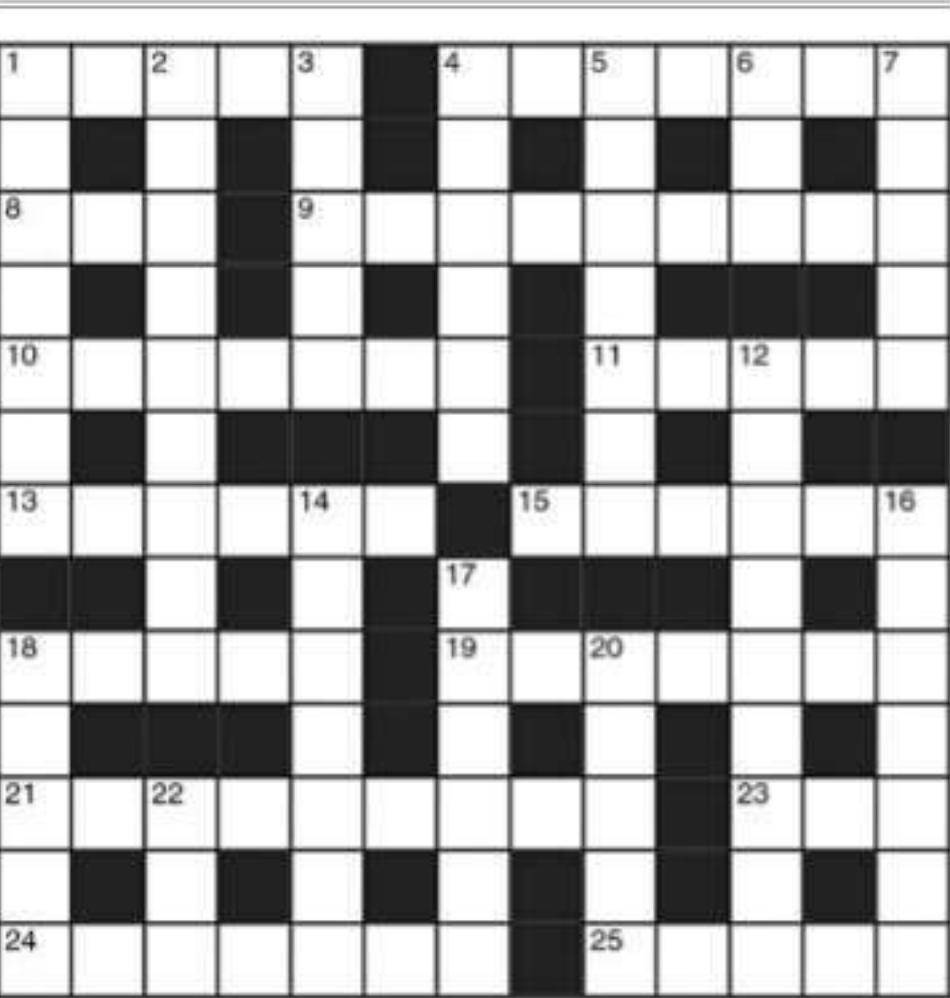
Yes. At the 2018 World Cup, for instance, Switzerland’s Xherdan Shaqiri and Granit Xhaka celebrated goals against Serbia by making the Albanian double-headed eagle gesture with their hands. Both players have ethnic Albanian roots linked to Kosovo, whose independence Serbia does not recognise. FIFA imposed a fine of 10,000 Swiss francs on both players.

During the 2022 World Cup, meanwhile, Serbia were fined 20,000 Swiss francs for a banner they had hoisted in their dressing room which showed Kosovo as a part of Serbia and read: “No surrender.”

At the same World Cup, German players had covered their mouths with their hands ahead of a match, in a symbolic gesture to convey that FIFA were forcibly silencing players. The football body had warned teams against using OneLove armbands, celebrating gender inclusivity, with the tournament being held in Qatar, where same-sex relationship is criminalised.

FIFA did not sanction Germany for the protest.

CROSSWORD



ACROSS
1 US spies capture the Spanish girl (5)
4 Kind of concrete that takes woven carpets (7)
8 Idiot rising without pressing need (3)
9 He doesn't have to be smart to fool the birds (9)
10 Get back into the middle of the procession (7)
11 Agree to be keen (5)
13 Songs the Fuhrer heard? (6)
15 Lines of poetry or music (6)
18 I'm illuminated round the edge (5)
19 Put into liquidation? (7)
21 Theatre company object to stage (9)
23 Some brief title for a newt (3)
24 Can a saint have a game of cards? (7)
25 If one delays one won't make it (5)

DOWN
1 Opportunity given to a number in the church (7)
2 Lear's wry smile is bright and penetrating (5,4)
3 A short island passage (5)
4 Mixed up Presbyterian not best in this? (6)
5 A feature of singular weather conditions (7)
6 Dry atmosphere? (3)
7 Building a tug? (5)
12 She instructs and her charges are small (9)
14 Values seem set for a change (7)
16 Staff held in a sort of respect (7)
17 Defrosted iceman is seen in the pictures (6)
18 Words in an early Richard Rodgers song (5)
20 Provider of a light fixture (5)
22 Elegant female writer (3)

SOLUTIONS CROSSWORD 6042
ACROSS: 1 Love letter, 8 Mated, 9 Lays off, 10 Simpers, 11 Title, 12 Utmost, 14 Andrew, 17 Remit, 19 Equator, 21 Distort, 22 Goods, 23 Runs to seed **DOWN:** 2 Optimum, 3 Endue, 4 Enlist, 5 Try it on, 6 Roost, 7 Afterwards, 8 Masquerade, 13 Sit down, 15 Rat-hole, 16 Beat it, 18 Miser, 20 Urges

JUMBLED WORDS

Given below are four jumbled words. Solve the jumbles to make proper words and move them to the respective circles below. Select the letters in the shaded circles and jumble them to get the answer for the given quip.

Quality is not an act, it is a _____. — Aristotle (S)

BDEAI **EEMNPH**
GHNOT **EKORRB**

SOLUTIONS: Quality is not an act, it is a habit. — Aristotle

OVER THE HEDGE



CALVIN & HOBBS



MARVIN



DIFFICULTY LEVEL 3s INSTRUCTIONS

To solve a Sudoku puzzle, every digit from 1 to 9 must appear in each of the nine vertical columns, in each of the nine horizontal rows and in each of the nine boxes.

DIFFICULTY LEVEL
1s = Very easy; 2s = Easy; 3s = Medium; 4s = Hard; 5s = Very Hard; 6s = Genius

SUDOKU 6382

			9	4			2	7
		4			5	3		9
			2		5			
4	1	7						
2								5
				9	1		3	
	2	6						
7	5	4			6			
6	8		3	7				

SOLUTION SUDOKU 6381

5	4	9	1	6	8	3	7	2
3	8	2	9	5	7	1	4	6
6	7	1	2	3	4	9	8	5
7	6	3	8	4	1	5	2	9
2	5	8	6	9	3	4	1	7
9	1	4	7	2	5	6	3	8
1	2	5	3	7	6	8	9	4
4	3	7	5	8	9	2	6	1
8	9	6	4	1	2	7	5	3

ROYAL STARS

ARIES (MAR 21 - APR 20): This is an excellent day to work and be productive. Use the energy of Mercury retrograde to finish old projects, and you will be surprised at how swiftly the job will go. Tonight: How is your health?

TAURUS (APR 21 - MAY 21): Today is full of creative opportunities, especially if you make art. It's also a great day to socialize. In particular, sports events and fun activities with kids will appeal. Tonight: Play.

GEMINI (MAY 22 - JUNE 21): With Mars in your sign now, you have a lot of energy to get things done. Admittedly, Mercury is still retrograde; however, you can use this energy to finish old projects. Meanwhile, today focus on home and family. Tonight: Relax at home.

CANCER (JUNE 22 - JULY 23): This is a great day to talk with everyone. You'll also have interesting interactions with new faces and appreciate your daily surroundings. Tonight: Enjoy discussions.

LEO (JULY 24 - AUG 23): Today you will enjoy buying beautiful things for yourself and loved ones. (Especially art objects, jewelry and lovely clothing.) Group activities, especially related to sports and physical competition, might appeal. Tonight: Maintain your belongings.

VIRGO (AUG 24 - SEP 23): Today the Moon is in your sign lined up with beautiful Venus, which makes you cheerful, sociable, warm and friendly. It's a great day to socialise. You will also enjoy making anything around you more beautiful, especially your home. Tonight: You're strong.

LIBRA (SEP 24 - OCT 23): Today is full of contradictions, because in one way, you are in the spotlight of the Sun, which is flattering to you. This is why you might be asked to take on increased responsibilities. However, today in particular you might want to hide or be low-key. It's your choice. Tonight: Enjoy time alone.

SCORPIO (OCT 24 - NOV 23): Friendships are important to you today. In fact, someone might be very special, perhaps to the point that a platonic friendship turns romantic. You will also be productive today. Tonight: Friendships.

SAGITTARIUS (NOV 24 - DEC 22): Today people notice you to the degree that some people know personal details about your life. Be aware of this, especially if you have to do some damage control. This could create problems with a spouse, partner or friend. Tonight: Be modest.

CAPRICORN (DEC 23 - JAN 20): Today you want to break free of your routine and do something different. Ideally, of course, you would love to travel and get a change of scenery. But if you cannot travel, you can still be a tourist in your own city. Tonight: Explore and learn.

AQUARIUS (JAN 21 - FEB 19): Although Mercury retrograde might create delays and silly mistakes in your work, today you can use it to your advantage. Work to wrap up loose ends. Tonight: Check your finances.

PISCES (FEB 20 - MAR 20): This is a playful, romantic time for you. However, your home scene might be somewhat busy dealing with guests, increased activity, even chaos. Do your best to make things run as smoothly as possible. Tonight: Show genuine interest.

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED
(See Section 82 Cr. PC)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person namely **Raja @ Achhu S/o Yudhveer R/o D-18, Gali No.12, Sant Garh, Tilak Nagar, West Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 1002/2020 U/s 33/38/58/52(2) Excise Act at PS: Khyala, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Raja @ Achhu** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Raja @ Achhu** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Raja @ Achhu** of **FIR No. 1002/2020 U/s 33/38/58/52(2) Excise Act of PS: Khyala, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **19.08.2026**.

By order
Sheetal Rani
Judicial Magistrate First Class-12
West Room No - 152
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/9774/WD/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
(See Section 82 Cr.PC)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Rinku Yadav, S/o Sh. Raghubir Dayal R/o A-2/32, Block-A, Rana Park, Village Siraspur, Samaipur, Delhi-110042** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **CT No.5771/2018 u/s 138 NI Act, P.S. KNK Marg, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Rinku Yadav** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Rinku Yadav** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Rinku Yadav** of **CT No.5771/2018 u/s 138 NI Act, P.S. KNK Marg, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **29.08.2026**.

By Order,
Sh. Rishabh Kapoor
Ld. Judicial Magistrate First Class-01, North-West Room No.116, 1st Floor, Rohini Court, Delhi

DP/9692/RD/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Satpal @ Satwan @ Gulati, S/o Mange Ram, R/o A-1182, DDA Flats, Loknayak Puram, Bakkarwala, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 672/2021, U/s 33 Delhi Excise Act, P.S. Mundka, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Satpal @ Satwan @ Gulati** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Satpal @ Satwan @ Gulati** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Satpal @ Satwan @ Gulati** accused of **FIR No. 672/2021, U/s 33 Delhi Excise Act, P.S. Mundka, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **15.09.2026**.

By Order - **Sh. Gaurav Singal**
Judicial Magistrate First Class-06, West Room No. 355, Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/9755/OD/2026

EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY
E-Tender Notice No. 27 of 2026-27 (Open)-Engg/DDU

On line (through e-tendering) for the following work is invited by DRM/Engg/DDU for and on behalf of the President of India from experienced and financially as well as technically sound contractors including those enlisted with the Railway, CPWD, BSNL, MES, PWD and other public sector undertakings:- (i) Name of work with its location: Tender No. 17-DDU-SR DEN-II-26-27 Replacing of plate girder by PSC slab under Sr.DEN/2/DDU (Br. No. 548.520.510.406 & 343) (ii) Advertised Value: Rs. 379800409.03 (iii) Earnest Money: Rs. 759600.00 (iv) Name of work with its location: Tender No. 18-DDU-SR DEN-II-26-27 Replacement of Bridge No. 466.471.480.484.499, and 516 by RCC precast box under Sr.DEN(III)/DDU (v) Advertised Value: Rs. 66542647.86 (vi) Earnest Money: Rs. 1330900.00 (vii) Name of work with its location: Tender No. 19-DDU-SR DEN-II-26-27 Strengthening of bridges by grouting and jacketing of Minor Bridge No. 464.470.478, 483.574, 595.539, 542.543 and replacement of RCC slab of Bridges No. 477.545.550.549.535A & 546 under Sr.DEN(III)/DDU. (viii) Advertised Value: Rs. 32314581.86 (ix) Earnest Money: Rs. 646300.00 (x) Closing Date & time for submission of e-tender: 05.08.2026, Up-to 12:00 hrs. (xi) Website particulars of e-tendering: www.irops.gov.in (xii) Divisional Railway Manager East Central Railway,DDU PR/0559/DDU/ENG/728-27/44

NORTH WESTERN RAILWAY
OPEN E-TENDER NOTICE

Dy. Chief Engineer (Const.), North-Western Railway, Bikaner for and on behalf of the President of India, invites open e-Tenders under **Two packet system** for the following works:-
Tender No. NWR-SC-BKN-02-2026-27-EPC; 2. Name of the work with its location: Major Upgradation of Bikaner Railway Station of North Western Railway on EPC mode. 3. Approx. cost of the work: Rs. 455,24,83,844.05; 4. Bid Security to be deposited: Rs.9,10,49,700.00; 5. Date for submission of e-Tender: On 14.08.2026 upto 15.00 hrs; 6. Date, time and place of pre bid conference: On 23.07.2026 at 11.30 AM in the office of Chief Administrative Officer (Construction), Head Quarter North-Western Railway, Jagatpura, Jaipur (Rajasthan) 7. Details and particulars of website where e-tender can be seen & filled up. www.irops.gov.in; 8. Official email address: dycebnkn@gmail.com; Note :-1. No manual tender will be accepted. 2. The Bid Security shall be deposited in cash through e-payment gateway or submitted as Bank Guarantee bond from a Scheduled Commercial Bank of India or as mentioned in the tender documents. The bank guarantee bond should be issued in favour of FA & CAO/Construction, North Western Railway Jaipur otherwise tender will not be considered. 1021-AM/26

Please join us on www.facebook.com/NWRRailways

Rajasthan State Road Development And Construction Corporation Ltd., JAIPUR.
No. NIT/2026-27/4669-78 निविदा सूचना/2026-27 Date: 15.07.2026

निम्नलिखित परियोजनाओं पर पक्कर सड़कें हेतु ई-टेंडरिंग प्रक्रिया से ऑनलाइन निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती है:-

कार्य का विवरण	कार्य की कुल अनुमानित लागत (₹.)	निविदा सूचना संख्या
Selection of Bidder for Collection of User Fee on the basis of competitive bidding through e-procurement basis for the following:- On Kishangarhbass-Khairthal-Bansur-Kotputli BOT Road for a maximum period of 90 days. UBN: RRC2627SL0B00371	281.92 Lakh	अनुकूलन ई-232/ 26-27
"Ahwar-Behror-Narnaul BOT Road" for a period of 01 Year. UBN: RRC2627SL0B00370	1994.48 Lakh	अनुकूलन ई-233/26-27

निविदा से सम्बंधित प्रश्न से निम्नित सूचना, पोस्टर, ग्राफ, वारंटिंग प्रक्रिया से कोलने की जातिगी प्रक्रिया सम्पूर्ण विवरण एवं सम्बंधित वेबसाइट: <http://proc.rajjasthan.gov.in> तथा <http://ppp.rajjasthan.nic.in> तथा <http://pwr.rajjasthan.gov.in/rsrde> पर देखा जा सकता है। अनुकूल संपर्क के अंतर्गत निम्नलिखित हस्ताक्षर के माध्यम से वेबसाइट <http://proc.rajjasthan.gov.in> पर रजिस्टर्ड करवाना आवश्यक है।

KERALA STATE ROAD TRANSPORT CORPORATION
Transport Bhavan , Fort P.O, Thiruvananthapuram-695023
E-TENDER NOTICE

Name of Item	Last Date of Bid submission
Hiring of AC Segment Buses (Diesel Fuelled) On Wet Lease Pre-bid meeting: 20.07.2026, 03.00 pm For the detailed tender document visit: www.etenders.kerala.gov.in , Chairman & Managing Director www.keralartc.com/tenders/purchase , e-mail: mngmrw@kerala.gov.in	28.07.2026, 06.00 PM 16.07.2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
(SEE SECTION 82(2) (ii) Cr.PC)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person(s) (1) **Uday Bhan Singh @ Tinku S/o Late Satya Pal Singh R/o VPO Dhatingra, PS Aliganj Kotwali, Distt. Etah, Uttar Pradesh;** (2) **Vinay Kumar S/o Sh. Suresh Kumar R/o Vill. Jatwara Mohalla, PS Mau Darwaza, Distt. Farukhabad (Uttar Pradesh)** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 732/2015 U/s 394/397/342/411/120B/34 IPC, PS Ranjit Nagar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a Warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) (1) **Uday Bhan Singh @ Tinku** (2) **Vinay Kumar** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) (1) **Uday Bhan Singh @ Tinku** (2) **Vinay Kumar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person(s) (1) **Uday Bhan Singh @ Tinku** (2) **Vinay Kumar** of **FIR No. 732/2015 U/s 394/397/342/411/120B/34 IPC, PS Ranjit Nagar, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before dated **24.08.2026 at 10:00 AM**.

By Order
Sh. Vijay Shankar
Addl. Session Judge-04 (West)
Room No. 202, Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/8854/CD/2026 (Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 Cr.P.C. / 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Pawan @ Joni @ Ankush, S/o Rajesh, R/o 1) Plot No. 06, Khasra No. 58/18, Ground Floor, Block-K-4, Agar Nagar, Delhi, 2) A-30, Gali No. 03, Amar Colony, Kamruddin Nagar, Nangloi, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **e-FIR No. 001268/2019, U/s 380/411 IPC, P.S. Prem Nagar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Pawan @ Joni @ Ankush** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Pawan @ Joni @ Ankush** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Pawan @ Joni @ Ankush** accused of **e-FIR No. 001268/2019, U/s 380/411 IPC, P.S. Prem Nagar, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **31.10.2026**.

By Order - **Ms. Shagun**
Judicial Magistrate First Class, North West Room No. 109, Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/9665/RD/2026

BY MICHAEL FRY & T LEWIS



BY BILL WATTERSON



BY TOM ARMSTRONG



DIFFICULTY LEVEL 3s INSTRUCTIONS

To solve a Sudoku puzzle, every digit from 1 to 9 must appear in each of the nine vertical columns, in each of the nine horizontal rows and in each of the nine boxes.

DIFFICULTY LEVEL
1s = Very easy; 2s = Easy; 3s = Medium; 4s = Hard; 5s = Very Hard; 6s = Genius

SUDOKU 6382

			9	4			2	7
		4			5	3		9
			2		5			
4	1	7						
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PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 CrPC

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Birender Khadka S/o Bhark Khadka, R/o H-4/74A, Sunrise Apartment, Bangali Colony, Mahavir Enclave, Palam, Delhi**, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 315/2019, U/S 279/337 IPC, PS Hari Nagar, West Distt., New Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Birender Khadka** cannot be found, and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Birender Khadka** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant); Proclamation is hereby made that **Birender Khadka** the said accused of **FIR No. 315/2019, U/S 279/337 IPC, PS Hari Nagar, West Distt., New Delhi**, is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **22.08.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Moksha Bains
Judicial Magistrate First Class-11, (West), Court No.-31, Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/9678/WD/2026 (Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 CrPC

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Sahiban @ Md. Imran S/o Md. Irfan, R/o Plot No.-2, Kh. No. 9/2023, Ground Floor, Village-Mubarakpur Dabas, Kanjhawala, Rohini, Delhi**, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 00191/2023, U/S 380/411 IPC, PS Kanjhawala, Rohini Distt., New Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Sahiban @ Md. Imran** cannot be found, and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Sahiban @ Md. Imran** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant); Proclamation is hereby made that **Sahiban @ Md. Imran** the said accused of **FIR No. 00191/2023, U/S 380/411 IPC, PS Kanjhawala, Rohini Distt., New Delhi**, is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **19.08.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Apoorv Bhardwaj
Judicial Magistrate First Class-02, North-West, Court No.-113, 1st Floor Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/9768/RD/2026 (Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Sameer S/o Salim R/o H. No. E-57/C-315, Jhuggi Sunder Nagri, Nand Nagri, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence **e-FIR No. 25022/2023 u/s 411 IPC at P.S. G.T.B. Enclave, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Sameer** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Sameer** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proceeding u/s 82 Cr.P.C. has been initiated in the case. Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Sameer** accused of **e-FIR No. 25022/2023 u/s 411 IPC at P.S. G.T.B. Enclave, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on **22.08.2026**

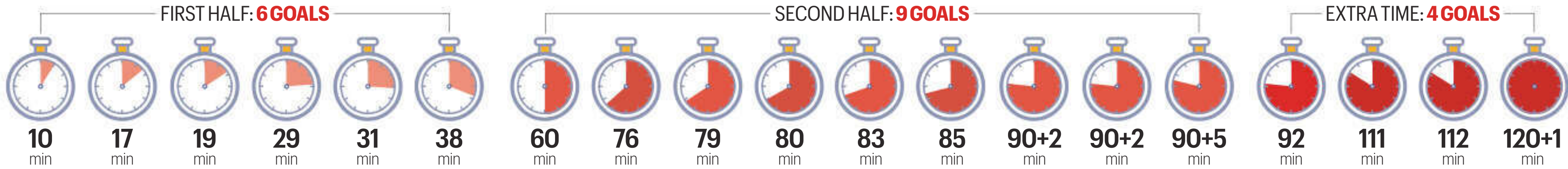
By Order: **Ms. Sanghmitra,**
Judicial Magistrate First Class-01, Room No. 54, Second Floor, Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

DP/9745/SHD/2026

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• AS THE CLOCK TICKS

Argentina have scored 19 goals in this edition of the FIFA World Cup, 12 of them coming after the 75th minute.



Legend's assists, goals from Fernandez and Martinez script Argentina's 2-1 comeback win



Sandip G
Atlanta, July 16

NEAR THE centre circle, Lionel Messi knelt, prayed, and stared poignantly into the skies through the translucent roofs of the arena. Tears of joy streaming down, his head drooped and he repeatedly punched the air like a judoka's underarm knock.

In 20 years of scaling greatness, he has felt the sport's elusive nirvana, achieved saintliness and experienced every conceivable emotion, suffered heartbreaks and felt disillusioned, and won every trophy football could offer him. But beating England 2-1 with collective courage, via late goals when everything seemed nearly lost, was special. Even for Messi.

With a faint but contented smile, he trudged towards the fans, where his teammates were already celebrating, with drums blaring incoherent beats in the background. Some of them unfolded a huge white flag with a message — "Las Malvinas son Argentinas" ("The Malvinas are Argentine") — a reference to the Falkland Islands, a self-governing territory of Britain over which the countries went to war nearly half a century ago. His teammates tossed Messi in the air, and car-



Lionel Messi didn't score but provided crucial assists for both goals. (R) Enzo Fernandez celebrating Argentina's equaliser in the semifinal. AP

ried him on their shoulders, which is now a ritual.

On his way back to the tunnel, he wrapped his arms around England captain Harry Kane, stopped for a chat with John Stone, and consoled Thomas Tuchel. He could relate with England's pain, he has felt similar torment. It was a poignant frame that captured the undulating emotions of a game that barely roused in the first half.

England couldn't beat Diego Maradona; they wouldn't his heir Messi either. Harry Kane said he was gutted, but the trauma could live forever. Another game into the alley of heartbreaks.

Yet, it could have been different. Just five minutes remained between a painful end to Messi's career, before he and his indefatigable men pulled off another miraculous escape, scoring two goals in six minutes



to nail their spot in the final. This one would be sweeter than the Egypt heist; the layers of history that underpin the two nations, the angst and acrimony that spilled onto the field, the nerves and the tension that clanged, the possible hollowness of becoming former champions.

But when adversity stares into their eyes, Argentina inevitably find a thread of hope. Perhaps, it's their ignition; they need a slap on their face to wake them up from slumber.

A more short-tempered referee would have flicked the cards in his chest-pocket more

often. Players pushed and pulled, tackles flew frequently. A header from John Stones off a Declan Rice cross was the first convincing attempt on goal. That came 33 minutes into the game. Before half-time nudged in, Enzo Fernandez unzipped a curler that soared over Jordan Pickford. The more apt portrait of the game was the 7-12 stat in Argentina's favour, the number of fouls committed.

The second Argentina conceded, through a startling defensive lapse that winger Anthony Gordon pounced upon, they transformed into a different team; they gathered a sense of authority.

When they are pushed to a corner, when the comeback paths are blocked, when all is nearly lost, they throw the carefully-conceived tactical sheets into the wind, eschew structures and formations, and just unlock chaos.

A rhythmic, systematic chaos, like the chorus of their anthem Muchachos. Messi, refined at La Masia, was never a man of chaos. Now, he is an agent of chaos. He defined foot-

ball in his image, now he is redefining it.

Before Enzo Fernandez's strike, a curling pearler that swung away from Pickford, Alexis MacAllister had hit the upright (he would slam the post again), Nico Gonzalez induced a low diving save from the England goalkeeper.

Each unfruitful attempt didn't wither them. Messi implored the crowd to raise the volume and keep believing. From a fleeting passage of shock, they picked up their voice. Argentina found their precision and purpose.

When Argentina got a corner, England packed the box, anticipating a wickedly swirling corner. It didn't. Messi took the corner, received it back and recycled it to Fernandez, in vast space. He took a touch and wrapped his foot around it. The ball whooshed past Pickford, who had put in a heroic shift.

Discernible was a shift in mood. One could hear the sound of England's belief creaking, thanks to their own self-destructiveness and defensive tactics.

Destroying belief

Argentina would now be unstoppable. They tigerishly reclaimed possession; they rav- enously attacked England's box, dismantling their cohesion and destroying their belief.

The dagger through the heart arrived soon. From the foot of Messi, again. He swirled a devastatingly arcing cross over Nico O'Reilly.

Lautaro Martinez was waiting. He strained every sinew of his neck to meet the ball and guide it past Pickford. This was the game; Argentina knew; England knew it too.

England could not beat Maradona; they couldn't beat Messi either. And Messi has one more game to experience the whole spectrum of emotions that he lives for. Perhaps the greatest game of his career; or the cruelest.

How Scaloni engineered another Argentine *remontada*

Shuvaditya Bose
New Delhi, July 16

THE GREATEST trick the devil ever pulled off was convincing the world he didn't exist.

There is a touch of Keyser Söze about Lionel Scaloni. There is a reason why Luis de la Fuente's positional organisation or Thomas Tuchel's strategic detail have been minutely analysed. Yet, no manager at this World Cup has slipped through tactical scrutiny quite like Argentina's.

For every time Scaloni has been asked to explain an Argentine *remontada*, his answer has been the same: it is inexplicable, he does not understand it either.

Wednesday's semifinal against England was another case in point. Argentina over-



Argentina coach Lionel Scaloni is in line to be a double winner. AP

turned a deficit to win 2-1. Asked how his team did it, Scaloni offered only a smile.

"My understanding is that when we smell blood, that's when we play our best football." And yet, footballing dis-

course does not have room for hyperbole. 'Smelling blood' cannot account for 12 goals after the 75th minute, seven of them after the 90th. There has to be an explanation.

Against England, there was.

64th minute

Substitution & the comeback



IN
Nico Gonzalez



OUT
Leandro Paredes

Argentina generated only 0.2 expected goals in the first 63 minutes. And then arrived Nico Gonzalez. On paper, a single substitution. In effect, it created three solutions. Gonzalez occupied his usual position on the left wing, allowing Alexis Mac Allister to move back into midfield and restore Argentina's numerical superiority there.

And Lionel Messi, instead of attempting through balls, went direct with aerial deliveries.

Before England realised what hit them, Messi had launched a raft of crosses towards Gonzalez.

In the next five minutes, the Messi-Gonzalez diagonal combination knocked on the English doors three times.

72nd minute

Tuchel falls for Scaloni's bluff



● After selling Tuchel a dummy with Gonzalez on the left, Scaloni strengthened the right wing with a Messi-Montiel-de Paul triangle.

Recognising that Reece James was struggling with Gonzalez, Tuchel reinforced his right flank. Ezri Konsa replaced goalscorer Gordon. Tuchel didn't realise he was walking into Scaloni's trap. As he committed resources to Argentina's left, Scaloni doubled down on his right by introducing Gonzalo Montiel and Rodrigo de Paul — both right-sided players. Messi, who had a central role till then, also switched to the right. The triangle of Messi-Montiel-de Paul launched 11 crosses. Argentina were knocking. They would soon bring the door down.

82nd minute

Tuchel reacts, but still falters

Tuchel, a Champions League winner, realised he had been sold a dummy. He tried to correct it by introducing left-back Nico O'Reilly, but the decision to take Declan Rice out would prove to be costly.

For much of the evening, Elliot Anderson's job had been simple: deny Messi space. He had done so with immaculate efficacy. But with Rice withdrawn, he was outnumbered in midfield. Three minutes later, Argentina worked a short corner. Messi exchanged a pass with De Paul, drawing Anderson towards the pair. What the English midfielder had not spotted was a third Argentine shirt lurking near the D: Enzo Fernandez.

A sublime long-ranger. 1-1. Four minutes before the goal, Scaloni had made another telling substitution. He had introduced another attacker — Lautaro Martinez — by withdrawing left-back Nicolas Tagliafico. This change would prove to be crucial 11 minutes later.

Argentina players taunt English with Falkland banner

Express News Service
Mumbai, July 16

AFTER ARGENTINA overhauled a 1-0 deficit against England into a statement 2-1 victory in the semi-finals, some of their players made a statement of another kind.

Giovani Lo Celso and Nicolas Otamendi brought a banner onto the pitch of the Mercedes Benz Arena that said 'Las Malvinas son Argentinas' (The Falkland Islands are Argentine). The banner was a reference to the Falkland Islands (as

known in England while in Argentina the island is called Islas Malvinas) which had led to a 74-day conflict between the two countries 44 years ago. The conflict had led to over 900 people — 649 Argentinians and 255 Britons — losing their lives.

England reasserted control of the Falklands after that 1982 war with Argentina's military government.

Argentina still considers the British protectorate essential to their national identity. The banner could land the Argentine football team in trouble



Argentina players carrying the banner after the semifinal against England. AP

with FIFA's rules on political messaging. Argentina will take on Spain in the FIFA World Cup final on Sunday hoping to retain their title won in Qatar 2022.

While it was uncertain where the banner had come from, according to a report from *The Associated Press*, Argentina fans had been banned from carrying Falklands flags into the World Cup semi-final.

Britain complains

Reuters adds: The British government on Thursday

urged FIFA to investigate Argentina's team after players posed with the banner. UK Business Secretary Peter Kyle said the players' behavior was "entirely inappropriate. I expect FIFA to do its investigation thoroughly."

FIFA can prosecute Argentina's players and soccer federation because its disciplinary code prohibits at stadiums any "message that is not appropriate for a sports event" including those of "a political, ideological, religious or offensive nature."

• HEARTBREAK HARRY

Kane and the World Cup semifinal that ended like all the others for England

Sriram Veera
Mumbai, July 16

HARRY KANE stood with his hands on his hips and looked at the grass. Around him the Atlanta stadium had split into two noises, one of which had nothing to do with him any more.

England had led since the 55th minute. Enzo Fernandez bent one in from distance in the 85th. Two minutes into stoppage time Messi crossed and Lautaro Martinez headed the winner. "It's a similar story to what's happened in previous tournaments," Kane said afterwards. "We'd done so well for that 60 minutes. We scored. We deserved to be ahead. And then, for one reason or another, we struggled to keep the ball."

He has said versions of this sentence in Moscow, at Wembley, in Al Khor, in Berlin. He is 32 and word perfect at it.

In 1999, on his first day at Ridgeway Rovers in Chingford, a coach named Dave Bricknell asked his six-year-olds if anyone fancied going in goal. Kane's hand went up.

"I thought I'd found a goalkeeper," Bricknell says.

The parents on the touchline put him right. Arsenal took him, looked at him, decided he was too chubby, too unathletic, and let him go.

Spurs took another look, then spent years lending him out, Leyton Orient, Millwall, a relegation battle, a forgotten Under-20 World Cup in Turkey.

Peter Taylor, who coached that team, says he could not have predicted the career. "You couldn't meet a nicer boy," he said. That is not the same thing as a prediction. "He didn't really care if he missed, because he knew another chance would come along."

The chance came. It always came. That is the part the record books show and the part that tells the least of it.

What the books do not show is the 30th minute in Moscow in 2018, England leading Croatia in a World Cup semi-final and Kane two yards out with a rebound sitting up. He shot. Goalkeeper Danijel Subasic got a hand to it. The ball came back. He shot again. The ball hit the post and ricocheted off Subasic's leg.

Subasic had sprinted back from nowhere and thrown himself along the ground to divert it with his foot, from two yards, at a ball that had already beaten him once.

What the books do not show is the 108th minute at Wembley in 2021, England leading Italy in a European final, Kane crossing from the right, the ball travelling across the six-yard



England's Harry Kane hugs Anthony Gordon after the semifinal AP

Six goals in six games, England's all-time World Cup record taken off Gary Lineker along the way, at 32, at the age strikers are supposed to be slowing down.

box, Stones arriving at the far post with his head. Donnarumma came off his line and punched it away with both fists. Two minutes of extra time remained.

What the books do not show is Al Khor, 2022 in Qatar. Level with France, 84th minute, Kane having already scored once from the spot. He placed it the same way he always places it, low, to the right, the corner he owns.

But this time it left his foot

differently, climbing instead of staying down, clearing the bar by several feet.

He knew before it landed. The shirt came up over his face before anyone in the ground had stopped watching the ball.

Last summer, Bayern Munich played a pre-season friendly at Tottenham. Kane walked back into the stadium he had given nineteen years to. Bayern won. At the end a small trophy was produced and the team gathered. Kane shook his head, would not lift it, would not hold something in front of the people he had left without one.

His striker coach Allan Russell once drew the distinction that unlocks him. "Is he a nice guy? No. He's a good guy. Nice guys get taken advantage of."

Beneath the mildness is something harder. Six goals in

six games here, England's all-time World Cup record taken off Gary Lineker along the way, at 32, at the age strikers are supposed to be slowing down. The mildness has a source too.

Kate Goodland has known him since they were pupils at the same Chingford school, both photographed with David Beckham in 2005, aged 11 and 12, before either had any idea what the picture would come to mean. He tapes his wedding ring before every match. Four children were watching somewhere on Wednesday night.

Afterwards, asked about his England future, Kane looked across at the man who had just beaten him, still deciding matches at 39. "As you see on the other end with Leo there, he's still performing at the highest level. So I never want to put a limit on these things."

Bricknell's boy never cared about the miss. Another chance might come along.

England kicked out by God's right foot

With future in doubt, Rohit struggles for rhythm in 2nd ODI

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'NO CENTRAL SUBSIDY FOR LAND ACQUISITION TO SET UP CHIP PLANTS, STATES EXPECTED TO TAKE LEAD'

Govt not keen to cover land, tech transfer costs in new chip scheme

Soumyarendra Barik
New Delhi, July 16

UNDER THE next phase of India's ambitious Rs 1.27 lakh crore Semiconductor Mission, the Central government may not offer subsidies to companies arising out of technology transfer costs, with the prevailing thought being that calculating such expenses is complicated, *The Indian Express* has learnt.

The Centre may also no longer offer subsidies for land acquisition to set up chip manufacturing plants, as state governments are expected to take the lead on that, a senior government official said.

Under the first iteration of the scheme, there was a provision for the government to cover a portion of technology transfer costs that approved companies may incur, but a senior government official said that it has been removed under India Semiconductor Mission (ISM) 2.0. Even though the provision existed under ISM 1.0, such disbursements were not made, it is understood.

"The reason we have de-

cided to not offer subsidies on technology transfer costs is because when we were evaluating proposals under the first leg of the scheme, there was a realisation that such transfer costs are quite opaque. It is almost impossible to reliably calculate the exact amount, so we have made changes accordingly," the official said, requesting anonymity.

Technology transfers are an important element in companies setting up semiconductor manufacturing operations in India, because many participants may not have access to such technology in-house. For instance, Tata Electronics, which is setting up a chip fabrication plant in Gujarat, is getting the manufacturing technology from Taiwan's PSMC.

These reconsiderations also point to the broader theme of India's shifting priorities under its new chip incentive scheme. The new policy is expected to place greater reliance on subsidising chip design, and the broader ancillary industry.

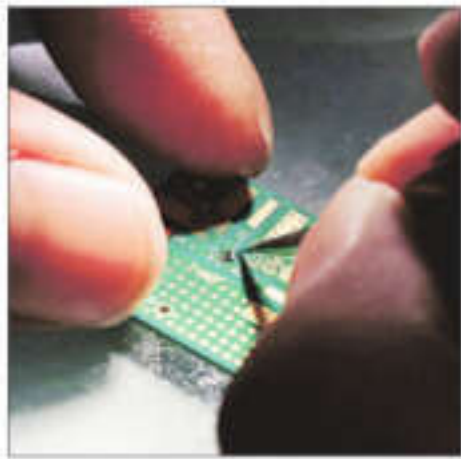
"In terms of our priorities for the new scheme, first would be chip designing, then bringing the broader supply chain

TECH TRANSFER COSTS

TECH TRANSFERS are an important element in firms setting up semiconductor manufacturing operations in India, because many participants may not have access to such tech in-house

UNDER THE first iteration of the scheme, there was a provision for government to cover a portion of tech transfer costs that approved firms may incur

BUT A senior government official said the provision has been



removed under ISM 2.0. Even though it existed under ISM 1.0, such disbursements were not made

Real Creator IAS Edition https://t.me/+2RvD_RGf9mliMzgl ecosystem to India, and then subsidising building of new chip manufacturing units," a second official said.

On Wednesday, the Union Cabinet approved ISM 2.0 with an outlay of Rs 1.27 lakh crore. Under the first scheme, India managed to attract 12 chip making plants, including a fabrication facility being set up by the Tata Group.

The country's foray into semiconductor production and

and manufacture chips required for nearly 70-75% of domestic applications, and by 2035, the country aims to be among the top semiconductor nations globally.

Compared to the first iteration of the ISM, government incentives for semiconductor manufacturing plants have been slashed in ISM 2.0. For instance, the first scheme carried a uniform capex subsidy of 50% for fabs and assembly plants. However, under ISM 2.0, silicon fabs will receive a subsidy of 40%, and other fabs will get 35%. Similarly, the incentive for advanced packaging has been kept at 35%, and 25% for conventional packaging.

Under the new scheme, the government will offer grants and may also take equity in large companies and start-ups that design semiconductor chips, which rank higher on strategic and commercial parameters. The government's investment will depend on whether these companies are able to raise money from private equity investors.

By 2029, India expects to achieve the capability to design

Soumyarendra Barik
New Delhi, July 16

INDIA MAKES almost every smartphone sold in the country. But when it comes to the names on those phones, Indian companies are conspicuously absent. A new Rs 62,500 crore mobile phone manufacturing scheme, approved by the Union Cabinet Wednesday, hopes to change that.

Under the new scheme, a five-year follow-on to the Production Linked Incentive (PLI) scheme for smartphone assembly, which helped India successfully localise production, the government is focusing on local sourcing to boost domestic value addition, and on design and R&D by Indian brands, along with incentives linked to the export of smartphones, Union IT Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw said.

For building Indian brands, an additional incentive at the rate of 3% on eligible sales will apply for design and R&D of the product under the scheme.

The push to build an Indian smartphone brand also signals that the government's ambition for the electronics sector is moving beyond simply attracting factories and boosting assembly. Having established India as a major manufacturing base, New Delhi now wants Indian companies to move deeper into the value chain — into product design, research and development, intellectual property, component ecosystems and brand ownership.

Though a long-term plan, what the government is essentially looking to subsidise to help propel an Indian smartphone brand is the immediate cost disability it may have against well-established competitors, particularly from China.

"We expect that four or five Indian companies will be inter-

India smartphone shipments market share

	Vivo	Samsung	Opportunity	Xiaomi	Realme	Others (in %)
Q4 2024	21	13	14	15	10	26
Q1 2025	22	17	15	13	11	22
Q2 2025	24	15	16	13	10	22
Q3 2025	24	13	16	13	9	25
Q4 2025	24	13	15	12	10	26
Q1 2026	23	17	17	12	9	22

SOURCE: COUNTERPOINT RESEARCH

ested in building a mobile phone brand that can compete with others on quality and price. But, they may have a cost disability of 10-15% initially, so through the new scheme, the government is looking to bridge at least 5-6% of that," a senior government official said.

Why an Indian smartphone brand

The push to build an Indian smartphone brand is rooted in a larger gap in India's electronics story. The country has succeeded in attracting global companies to manufacture mobile phones at scale, but much of the value generated by the industry, from product design and intel-

E.

lectual property to branding and technology, continues to be owned by companies headquartered elsewhere, though Indian companies like Tata Electronics and Dixon are establishing themselves in the contract manufacturing sector.

The government's new mobile phone manufacturing scheme hopes to explicitly address this gap by supporting Indian brands, with the stated objectives of achieving technological sovereignty, capturing a larger share of the economic value generated by the sector and creating Indian patents in design and research

and development.

This is important because manufacturing alone does not necessarily translate into control over an industry. A phone assembled in India may still be designed elsewhere, use foreign-owned intellectual property and be sold under a foreign brand. The government now wants Indian companies to move up this value chain. The scheme, with a Rs 62,500-crore outlay over five years, is intended to deepen domestic value addition, strengthen supply chains and improve global competitiveness, while providing incentives on eligible mobile phone sales.

The policy also reflects the limits of the first phase of India's mobile manufacturing push. Production-linked incentives helped attract global manufacturers like Apple and expand India's capacity to make phones, with the country emerging as a major manufacturing and export base. But India has not produced a smartphone brand with comparable scale and global reach. The new scheme is an attempt to fill that gap, to ensure that the next phase of growth is not only about more phones being made in India, but also about Indian companies owning the design, technology and brand behind those phones.

FULL REPORT ON
WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

Govt plans tighter fuel-economy norms, credit market from FY28

Sourav Anand
New Delhi, July 16

THE POWER ministry has proposed a tougher five-year fuel-economy regime for passenger vehicles from April 1, 2027, tightening fleet-average consumption targets while allowing carmakers to use carbon-neutrality benefits, super credits and a compliance-credit mechanism to meet the new standards.

The draft Corporate Average Fuel Economy-III norms, circulated for stakeholder consultation, will cover M1-category passenger vehicles manufactured or imported for sale in India between 2027-28 and 2031-32. The existing CAFE-II norms are likely to expire on March 31, 2027.

Under the proposed framework, the fuel-consumption target will progressively decline from 3.996 litres per 100 km, equivalent to 94.76 gCO₂ per km, in 2027-28 to 3.3273

litres per 100 km, or 78.90 gCO₂ per km, by 2031-32.

Compliance will be assessed across two blocks, comprising an initial three-year period followed by a second block of two years. The phased tightening is intended to provide automobile manufacturers a predictable regulatory path for developing and deploying more fuel-efficient models.

In a significant change, the ministry has proposed Carbon Neutrality Factors for ethanol, biofuel and compressed biogas for the first time. The mechanism will permit specified reductions in declared tailpipe carbon dioxide emissions before a manufacturer's compliance is assessed.

At the current ethanol-blending level, an 8% Carbon Neutrality Factor has been proposed. For compressed biogas and biofuel, the reduction will be linked to the prevailing actual

blending level.

Manufacturers will also be eligible to claim compliance benefits of up to 9 gCO₂ per km for approved fuel-saving technologies, with the benefit capped at 1 gCO₂ per km for each technology.

The draft provides super credits while calculating fleet-average fuel consumption for battery electric vehicles, range-extended electric vehicles, plug-in hybrids, strong hybrids and flex-fuel vehicles, giving manufacturers additional flexibility to expand cleaner vehicle portfolios. It also proposes a credit-and-debit system similar to the mechanism in the recently circulated draft amendment to the CAFE-II norms.

The proposed regime combines steadily tighter fuel-consumption targets with incentives for alternative fuels, electrified vehicles and fuel-saving technologies. FE

SPECIFIED NON-FINANCIAL ASSETS

RBI introduces SNFA category, bars banks from selling assets back to defaulters

George Mathew
Mumbai, July 16

The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) has introduced the concept of Specified Non-Financial Assets (SNFAs) in the event of loan defaults and mandated that disposal of such assets should primarily be through public auctions under SARFAESI Act principles and prohibited resale to the original borrower or related parties.

SNFAs refer primarily to immovable properties that banks acquire when borrowers fail to repay loans. Such assets typically include residential buildings, commercial properties, industrial land or other real estate accepted by banks in settlement of outstanding debt.

The RBI has issued the Third Amendment Directions, 2026 under its Commercial Banks – Resolution of Stressed Assets Directions, 2025. The new regulations establish a comprehensive framework for how banks should acquire, value, manage and dispose of non-financial assets obtained from defaulting borrowers.

According to the new directions, banks may acquire an SNFA only after a borrower's loan has been officially classified as a non-performing asset. The acquisition must involve either full or partial settlement of the bank's outstanding exposure. In cases where only part of the loan is settled through the transfer of property, the remaining debt



Specified non-financial assets are immovable properties that banks acquire when borrowers fail to repay loans. REUTERS

will continue to be treated under restructuring norms, ensuring that banks maintain appropriate provisioning and risk management standards.

The RBI has introduced strict valuation guidelines to prevent overvaluation. Every acquired property must be recorded at the lower of two values—the net book value of the extinguished loan or the distress sale value determined independently by at least two external valuers.

Banking experts believe this conservative valuation method will reduce the possibility of inflated asset values appearing on bank balance sheets while encouraging more realistic financial reporting. FULL REPORT ON
WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

UPI payments over Rs 2k to big merchants may see 0.5% MDR

New Delhi: The Centre may reintroduce a merchant discount rate (MDR) on UPI transactions of Rs 2,000 and above for large merchants to compensate banks and payment service providers for rising operational costs and technology investments, sources said.

The proposed MDR on UPI payments accepted by large merchants won't exceed 0.5% of the monetary value, a source said.

However, merchants and businesses with an annual turnover of up to Rs 1.5 crore are likely to be exempt from the levy, irrespective of the transaction amount. A decision on the proposal is expected within a month, the sources added.

Larger merchants are better placed to absorb the MDR or pass on the cost to customers, whereas small businesses have limited ability to do so, the government reckons. FE

BRIEFLY

SBI Funds IPO attracts bids worth Rs 3 L cr

Mumbai: The initial public offering (IPO) of SBI Funds Management Ltd witnessed overwhelming investor interest, closing with an overall subscription of 41.66 times on the final day of bidding and generating demand worth nearly Rs 2.97 lakh crore. The issue received bids for 518.93 crore equity shares against the 12.45 crore shares on offer, according to cumulative subscription data available on the BSE and NSE. The IPO was priced in the band of Rs 545-574 per share. ENS

'Social protection now covers 100 cr citizens'

New Delhi: India's social protection coverage increased to over 100 crore citizens in 2026, up from 25 crore in 2015, according to Union Labour and Employment Minister Mansukh Mandaviya. The minister, in a post on social media platform X on Wednesday, highlighted the landmark validation of the country's social security landscape by the International Labour Organisation (ILO). "India breaches 1 billion mark in Social Protection Coverage!" Mandaviya wrote on X. PTI

Tech Mahindra Q1 net profit rises 28.4%

New Delhi: IT services company Tech Mahindra on Thursday posted a 28.4% year-on-year rise in its consolidated net profit for the June quarter at Rs 1,465 crore. The company's revenue from operations was up 17.7% at about 15,712 crore during the quarter just ended. Total headcount at 146,760 was 863 people lower quarter-on-quarter, while the IT attrition stood at 11.8% on an LTM (last twelve months) basis. In dollar terms, the Q1 FY27 revenue at \$1,660 million came in 2.2% higher sequentially. PTI

I-T Dept adds foreign income data to AIS

New Delhi: The Income Tax Department has started displaying information on foreign assets and income to the taxpayers on the income tax e-filing portal as per information received under the Automatic Exchange of Information (AEOI) framework. The tax department is currently displaying information for 2022, 2023, and 2024 in the Annual Information Statement of taxpayers. Information for 2025 will be visible in the AIS once it is received in September or October, sources said. FE

THE LEAK INCLUDES A 14.3 GB DATASET COMPRISING 18,997 FILES RELATED TO THE KUDANKULAM NUCLEAR POWER PLANT

Kudankulam files on dark web: Inside the alleged data leak

Pratyush Deep
New Delhi, July 16

FOR MORE than a month, a large cache of files purportedly linked to the Kudankulam Nuclear Power Plant have been available on the dark web.

The data, leaked by ransomware group World Leaks, is purportedly linked to Anil Ambani-led Reliance Group, whose subsidiary, Reliance Infrastructure Ltd, was awarded the Engineering, Procurement and Construction (EPC) contract in 2018 for the plant's non-nuclear common service facilities, known as the Balance of Plant (BoP).

The leaked data, accessed by *The Indian Express*, includes a 14.3 GB dataset comprising 18,997 files related to

the Kudankulam Nuclear Power Plant. These files are part of a much larger cache of 1.2 terabytes containing over 858,000 files purportedly linked to the Anil Ambani-led Reliance Group.

A search in the leaked dataset using the term "KKNP" — an acronym for the Kudankulam Nuclear Power Plant — retrieves numerous internal documents, including inspection records, engineering design files for various plant facilities, minutes of meetings, and correspondence between Reliance Infrastructure and the Nuclear Power Corporation of India Ltd (NPCIL) on project execution and construction-related matters.

While *The Indian Express* could not independently verify the authenticity of these



The leaked dataset is largely related to Units 3 and 4 of the Kudankulam Nuclear Power Plant. REUTERS

documents, a spokesperson of Anil Ambani-led Reliance Group told this newspaper that there had been a "partial breach" of its data on a server hosted by third-party data

centre service provider Yotta, and the government had been informed about the incident.

In a statement to *Reuters*, Yotta also maintained that it had noted suspicious activity

on May 29 on a server it hosts that belongs to Reliance Infrastructure. It said the activity was immediately terminated and the suspected ransomware execution was prevented.

Following reports of data breach, state-owned NPCIL, the plant's operator, also clarified that the leaked information does not pertain to any nuclear safety or security systems and the compromised data relates only to the plant's conventional Balance of Plant common service facilities, for which Reliance Infrastructure Ltd was awarded a contract in 2018.

Located in Tirunelveli district of Tamil Nadu, Kudankulam Nuclear Power Plant consists of six units of Pressurised Water Reactors of VVER design, which were established in technical collaboration

with Russia.

The first two units (KKNPP Units-1 & 2) are already in operation, while Units 3 and 4 are still under construction and are due to be operational by 2027. The remaining two units are at different stages of progress.

The leaked dataset is largely related to Units 3 and 4 of the Kudankulam Nuclear Power Plant and contains documents associated with the EPC contract executed by Reliance Infrastructure Ltd.

From tender documents and invoices to engineering drawings and design files for various structures, the folders appear to be organised according to different aspects of the project.

FULL REPORT ON
WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

MARKETS

Sensex 77,186.87	NIFTY 24,072.75	Gold ▼ ₹1,41,679	US Dollar ▲ ₹96.35
1.44	-5.75		
0.00%	-0.02%	Silver ▼ ₹2,17,434	Oil ▼ \$81.62

NOTE: GOLD, SILVER RATES AS PER INDIA BULLION AND JEWELLERS ASSOCIATION DATA
GOLD PER 10G, SILVER PER 1 KG; CRUDE OIL (INDIAN BASKET) AS OF JULY 15, 2026

Classifieds

PERSONAL

I,Aftab S/o Gulam Mohammad Khan,R/o,N-151,Second-Floor,Abul Fazal-Enclave Part-I,Jamia-Nagar, Okhla, New Delhi-110025,have changed my-name to Aftab Ahmad, for-all-purposes.

0040866386-6

I, Moojim S/o Abdul Halim R/o Plot No. 49, Gali No.6, Geetanjali Park, Sagarpur, New Delhi, have changed my name to Mohd Moazziam

0130066852-1

I, Name Chandra S/o Hari Prasad resident of F-2/726, Sangam Vihar, New Delhi-110080, inform that in the school leaving certificate of class VII(2025-26) Pass, issued by Anand Vidya Bharti School of my son DEEPAK his father's name written as NEM CHANDRA which is wrong whereas his father's correct and full name is NAME CHANDRA and also, his mother's name written as 'RAKHI DEVI' which is wrong whereas his mother's correct and full name is RAKHI.

0040866367-1

I,KARAN CHAUDHARY,S/O-SHRI KESAR SINGH CHAUDHARY,R/O 1/6010,GALI NO.4,KABOOL-NAGAR,SHAHDR-NORTH EAST,DELHI-110032,Do hereby solemnly affirm and declare that KARAN CHOWDHRY & KARAN CHAUDHARY both refer to one and same person,which is myself.

0040866384-4

I Nitisha Sharma alias Narayani Sharma D/o Ram Prasad R/o 2, Army Public School, Dhaula Kuan, VTC: Delhi Cantt., South West Delhi, Delhi-110010 have changed my name to Narayani Sharma for all purposes.

0040866274-2

I, Rajwanti Devi M/o No 15174524X Rank Ex HAV (MACP NB SUB) Virender Singh Dalal R/o RZ- 119A, Gopal Nagar, Najafgarh, Delhi- 110043 have changed my name to Rajwanti vide affidavit date 15-7-26 before Delhi.

0071048062-1

I, Neeraj Shukla s/o Nagendra Prasad Shukla R/o Hno 90 chanethu janghai Allahabad up 212401 have changed my name Neeraj Kumar Shukla to Neeraj Shukla for all future purposes.

0040866281-1

I,AMIT SINGH ,s/o JAIBIR SINGH PANGHAL,HOUSE NO-1899/9, GALI NO-9,MATA ROAD,RAJIV NAGAR, GURGOAN,GURGOAN, HARYANA-122001,Changed my name to AMIT SINGH PANGHAL.

0040866383-6

I, KHUSHBOO DHALL D/o Late Shri Ashwani Dhall R/o A5C/13A JANAKPURI, ND- 58 have changed my name to KHUSHBOO ASIJA for all Future Purposes.

0050293251-1

I Kartik Raturi S/o Sunder mani Raturi R/O O-24/C-1,Dilshad Garden,Delhi-110095,have changed my name from Harish to Kartik Raturi for all future purposes.

0040866385-2

I,hitherto known as PARSHOTAM LAL,son of,Sh.Jai Ram Chawla,residing at,H.No.1, North-West Avenue,Club-Road,Punjabi-Bagh,West-Delhi-110026,have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as PURSHOTAM LAL CHAWLA.

0040866386-8

I,Chanda Devi,W/O Dinesh Dahiya,R/O-Flat No.404,Govindam Residency, Hariram Behar Marg, Polo Ground,Sikar,Rajasthan-332001,Have Changed My Name To Chanda Dahiya Permanently.

0040866412-8

We are Sh.Piyush Goel(Father) & Smt.Pooja Goyal(Mother),R/o 841,First-Floor,Niti Khand-1,Indirapuram, Ghaziabad, U.P.-201014,have changed the name of our minor daughter from ARADHYA GOEL to ARADHYA GOEL (Date-of-Birth:22.01.2013) for all future purposes.

0040866384-6

I,AMIT GOURD,S/O RAMU GOURD,S/O HNO.88 TEJ COLONY TEHSIL CAMP ASHOK NAGAR PANIPAT HARYANA-132103,HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO AMIT,FOR ALL PURPOSES.

0040866412-6

I,JASBIR S/o Bhraham Singh R/o House No-43, Nangal Thakran,Delhi-110039 have changed my name to JASBIR SINGH.

0040866412-1

I, Rasneet Kaur W/o Devender Pal Singh Gulati R/o House No-3/130, Upper Ground Floor, Nit-3, Faridabad, P.O: Faridabad Nit, Dist: Faridabad, Haryana-121001, have changed my name to Rasneet Kaur Gulati.

0071048095-1

I, Mohd Rashid S/o Anwar R/o-438, Village Radhna, Inayatpur, Meerut, UP have changed my name to Rashid.

0071048044-1

I, Narinder Kumar Sharma, S/o Mohd Raj Sharma, R/o First Floor, Left Side, 18/24-17-A, Old Govind Pura, Krishna Nagar, Delhi-110051, have changed my name to Narender Sharma, for all purposes.

0040866278-1

I,Service No.JC813246Y,Rank:-Nb Sub Name:- Sandeep Kesar,father of AMAN Presently residing at,Village & Tehsil Beri,Distt.Jhajjar, Haryana-124201,have changed my minor son's name from AMAN to AMMAN for all,future purposes.

0040866383-8

I, VINOD KUMAR SINGH S/o LATE SHRI MAM CHAND R/o HOUSE NO.13/2, GALI NO.1, AMBEDKAR VIHAR, SECTOR-37, NOIDA, GAUTAM BUDDH NAGAR, U.P.-201301 have changed my name VINOD KUMAR SINGH to VINOD KUMAR for all purposes

0071048020-1

I,Shahnawaz S/o Mohammed Dilshad R/o House no.B-69, B-block New Jafrabad Shahdra, Delhi-110032, have changed my name to Mohd Shahnawaz.

0040866386-1

I,ABDUL SAMAD S/o Mohammad Shahid Ansari,R/o-H.No.D-35,Room No.8,Near-Well No.2,Katwaria Sarai, New Delhi-16,declare that name of my wife has been wrongly written as Phoolzahan Bibi in my son's Aahil Ali,Aadil Ali School records.The actual name of my wife is Phuljhan Bibi which may be amended accordingly.

0040866386-10

I,NAMRATA,W/O PARVESH SINGLA,R/O-S D 69 THIRD-FLOOR SECTOR-45,NOIDA GAUTAM BUDDHA-NAGAR,UP-201303,HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO NAMRATA SINGLA,FOR ALL,FUTURE PURPOSES.

0040866383-1

I,SHETH AKASH VINODKUMAR,FATHER OF,AKSHAT AKASH KUMAR SHETH,R/O-18,MANGALAM-APARTMENT,NR-GOLD COIN APPARTMENT,MANIYASA,MANI NAGAR-EAST, AHMEDABAD-380008,GUJARAT,HAVE CHANGED MY MINOR SON NAME FROM AKSHAT AKASH KUMAR SHETH TO AKSHAT AKASH SHETH,VIDE AFFIDAVIT-16/07/2026.

0040866384-8

I, Mohammad Faizan S/o Farahim R/o-443, Masuri, Ghaziabad, UP have changed my name to Mohd Faizan.

0071048084-1

I,Hiren Singh,S/o Vivek Shart,R/o Flat No.-1602, Tower T-4,Imperial Estate,SPR Buildtech,Sector-82,Faridabad,Haryana,have changed my name to Hiren Pratap Singh,for all purposes.

0040866412-3

I, Mohd Intjar S/o Subhan Ali R/o H.NO-114, GOV Ghanghond Must, Saharanpur, UP have changed my name to Mohammad Intjar.

0071048042-1

I,SANTOSH KUMAR SHARMA,S/O K.H.RAM KUMAR SHARMA,R/O SH-17/13,GALI NO-8,GANGOTRI-VIHAR,WEST-GHONDA,DELHI-110053,HAVE CHANGED MY NAME,FOR ALL,FUTURE PURPOSES TO SANTOSH SHARMA.

0040866384-1

I, Neelam w/o Shamsher Gahlawat r/o Plot No.-663, Gali No.-2, Saini Vihar, Mundka Village Delhi-110041 have changed my name as NEELAM GAHLAWAT permanently.

0040866273-1

I,VINOD KUMAR GAUTAM,S/O-HARI RAM,R/O- HOUSE,NO.623,BHIM GALI,NEAR-ROBIN CINEMA,SUBZI MANDI,MALKA GANJ,DELHI-110007,HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO VINOD KUMAR SHARMA.

0040866386-3

I,Akhilendra Mani Tiwari S/o Indramani Tiwari R/o Iahari Tiwari Dih, Tiwari Dih, Bhojpur, Lahriwaidih, Bihar - 802207, have changed my name to Anand Raj

0071048078-1

I,DIVYA MISHRA,W/O PATEL BHAVESHKUMAR BHASMUKHBHAI, R/o-1868/9, Third-Floor, Gali-No.13,Govindpuri-Extension, Kalkaji,New Delhi-110019,have changed the name of my son from DEVANSH BHAVESH PATEL to DEVANSH MISHRA for all purposes.

0040866386-12

I,NASREEN W/o MOHAMMAD UMAR R/O HOUSE NO-994 GALI NO-12,NEW MUSTAFABAD,NORTH EAST,DELHI-110094,have changed my name to NASIRAN permanently.

0040866383-3

I,hitherto Known as Mohd Shariq, S/O- Mohd.Shafigquddin,6269,jharsai ya street,quresh-nagar, sadar-bazar,north-Delhi-110006,Have Changed My Name and Shall Hereafter Be Known as Mohammed Shariq.

0040866386-5

I, Saista W/o Farahim Ali R/o-443, Masuri, Ghaziabad, UP have changed my name to Shaista.

0071048091-1

I, Geetansh, S/o Dharmaend Kumar, R/O-H.No.234, Badnoli, Hapur, Near Syandicate Bank, Uttar Pradesh, 245101 have changed my name from Geetansh to Geetansh Tanwar, for all future purposes.

0040866338-1

I,Mohinder Singh,S/o Harbans Singh R/o H No-4, Block A, Himgiri Enclave, Niloti Extn,Delhi-110041,have changed my name to Mahinder Singh

0040866412-5

I,Anushka Grover,W/o-Satvir Singh,R/O-A-66,Upper Second-Floor,Gali no-13, Indra-Park,Chander-Nagar,Krishna-Nagar,Delhi-110051,have changed my name to Anushka Kaur for all purposes.

0040866384-3

I Anushka Kumar D/o Vikram Kumar W/o Mohit Wadera R/o D-1A/99, Janki Puri, West Delhi, Delhi-110058 have changed my name after marriage to Anushka Wadera for all purposes.

0040866274-1

I,Hawa Singh Dalal F/o No 15174524X Rank Ex HAV (MACP NB SUB) Virender Singh Dalal R/o RZ- 119A, Gopal Nagar, Najafgarh, Delhi- 110043 have changed my name to Hawa Singh vide affidavit date 15-7-26 before Delhi.

0071048051-1

I, Mukesh Popli S/o Mr. Krishan Lal, resident of H-642, First Avenue, Gaur City-1, Greater Noida West, Gautam Budh Nagar, Uttar Pradesh, 201009, have changed my Name from Mukesh Popli to Mukhesh Popli. Henceforth, I would be known by the name of Mukhesh Popli for all future purpose.

0040866299-1

I,GLENEYS NORMA,W/O-DARRYL DON ATTWELL,R/O-A-24 KAMAKHYA-VILLAS SATSANG ROAD SHABERI SECTOR-4 GREATER NOIDA WEST UTTAR PRADESH-201301,HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO GLYNNIS NORMA ATTWELL.

0040866383-5

I,hitherto known as Rajiv Kumar S/o Ram Diya residing at Near Stia Hospital, K.D. Nagar, Ganaur, Sonipat, have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as RAJEEV KUMAR.

0050293250-1

I, Kunwar Preet Singh Sachdeva S/O Mr. Gagan Preet Singh Sachdeva R/o House No.10, Road No.84, Punjabi Bagh West, New Delhi-110026, have changed my name from Agam Sachdeva to Kunwar Preet Singh Sachdeva.

0040866385-1

I,Gulam Mohammad S/o Abdul Ajjir, R/O-176, Khiharan-Madya, Khiharan, Milkpur, District-Ayodhya, Uttar Pradesh-224127, have changed my name to Gulam Mohammad Khan, for all purposes.

0040866386-7

I,MOHD LUQMAN S/o Gyas Mohammad, B-37, Gali No-7, Abul Fazal Enclave-2, Shaheen Bagh, Jamia Nagar, Delhi-25 have changed my name to MOHAMMED LUKMAN CHOUDHARY.

0071048093-1

I,Sunidhi Daiya,D/O-Dinesh Dahiya,R/O Flat No.404,Govindam Residency, Hariram Behar Marg,Polo Ground,Sikar,Rajasthan 332001,Have Changed My Name To Sunidhi Dahiya Permanently.

0040866412-7

I, NAJMUS SEHAR KHAN W/O- Mohammad Irfan Khan, R/o-D-249/2, (UGF), Jamia Nagar, Abul Fazal Enclave-1, New Delhi-25, have changed my name to NAJMUS SEHAR for all purposes.

0040866293-1

We are Sh.Piyush Goel (Father) & Smt. Pooja Goyal (Mother), R/o 841,First-Floor,Niti Khand-1,Indirapuram, Ghaziabad, U.P.-201014,have changed the name of our minor daughter from MANYATA GOEL to MANYATA GOYAL (Date-of-Birth: 30.12.2015) for all future purposes.

0040866384-5

I, Mukesh Kumar Chugh S/o Kishan Chand Chugh R/o Flat No.911, Tower-8, Purvanchal Heights Sector Zeta-1, Greater Noida G.B Nagar U.P have changed my name from Mukesh Kumar to Mukesh Kumar Chugh for all future purposes

0040866384-9

I, Janki Devi W/o Ranjit Rai R/o Shivkund Post, Munger Bihar-811201, have changed my name to Kajal Devi

0050293303-1

I,Amit Kochhar S/o Som Nath Kochhar R/o T-272, Parnapuri, Uttam Nagar, New Delhi-110059, have changed my name to Amit Kochar.

0040866383-7

I, LOVE BHARDWAJ S/O MANOJ SHARMA R/O HOUSE NO-RZ-7B 3, SHANKAR PARK, WEST SAGARPUR, NANGAL RAYA, SOUTH WEST DELHI, DELHI-110046 have changed my name to AYUSH SHARMA for all purposes.

0071048019-1

I, Suryapal S/o Harbhajan Singh R/o Plot no 981/21, Gali No.09, Rajiv Nagar, Sahibabad, Ghaziabad, U.P.-201005, have changed my name from Surypal Singh to Suryapal for all future purposes.

0040866386-9

I,Ex Sepoy No.13942972L Rajender Singh,S/o Sh.Mam Chand,R/O-326, Sunlight Colony-1,New Delhi-14 had mentioned my name as Rajender in my service records.My actual name is Rajender Singh.Hence,for all purposes my name may be treated as Rajender Singh.

I,Dinesh Daiya/Dinesh Kumar Daiya,S/O-Dayananand Daiya,R/O-Flat.No.404, Govindam-Residency,Hariram Behar Marg,Polo Ground,Sikar,Rajasthan 332001,Have Changed My Name To Dinesh Dahiya Permanently.

0040866412-9

I,Arun Agarwal S/o Ved Prakash Agarwal R/o Flat-No.1004, Tower-12, Lotus Panache, Sector-110, Noida(U.P) have changed my name to Arun Kumar Agarwal for all purposes.

0040866289-1

I Md Hamid Ashraf, R/o vill-Dilalpur, Ps- Balyia Belowwn, Po-Salmari, Katihar, Bihar-855113 declare my mother's correct name is "Baby khusanama Begam". In 10th marksheet, it is wrong "B B khusnuma Khatoon". Both are same person.

0130066879-1

I,KHUSHBU AKASHKUMAR SHETH,WIFE OF,SHETH AKASH VINODKUMAR,R/O- 18,MANGALAM-APPARTMENT,NR-GOLD COIN APPARTMENT,MANIYASA,MANI NAGAR-EAST, AHMEDABAD-380008 GUJARAT,HAVE CHANGED MY NAME,FROM KHUSHBU AKASHKUMAR SHETH TO KHUSHBU AKASH SHETH,VIDE AFFIDAVIT-16/07/2026.

0040866384-7

I Brindaban Ghosh Alias Binod Ghosh S/o Late Madhusudan Ghosh R/o Jalahati, Samudragarh, Purba Bardhaman, West Bengal - 713519, have changed my name to Binod Ghosh

0071048082-1

I, KM SHAMA AFROJ W/O AIJAZ AHMED ADDO-E-12/15,SECOND FLOOR,HAUZ RANI,MALVIYA NAGAR,NEW DELHI 110017,have changed my name to SHAMA AFROZ

0040866412-2

I, Shahzad Ahmad alias Shazada Mian S/o Jamil Ahmad R/o 197, A, T-Huts, Meera Bagh, Paschim Vihar, West Delhi, Delhi-110063, have changed my name to Shahzad Ahmad.

0071048105-1

I,Mukesh Kumar Agarwal,S/o- Raj Kumar Agarwal,R/o-C-1404,Tower-C, Civitech Stadia,Sector-79,Noida-201305,formerly known as Mukesh Agarwal,hereby declare that both names belong to one and the same person. Henceforth shall be known as Mukesh Kumar Agarwal.

0040866383-9

I,KM NIDHI JOSHI,W/O Abhishek Joshi R/o RZ-302,Gali No.3,Pratap Vihar Part-2,Kirari Suleman Nagar Sultanpur Delhi-110086,have changed my name to NIDHI JOSHI

0040866386-2

I,hitherto known as HEENA KHAN,D/O CHHAMMAN KHAN,R/O H.NO-B-19,South Ganesh-Nagar,Shakarpur-East,Delhi-110092,have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as AMAYRA KHAN.

0040866386-11

I, Mukesh Kumar, Son of Late Sh. Laxman Prasad Residence of B-1757, First Floor, Near Shiv Mandir, Shastri Nagar, Delhi-110052, have changed my name Mukesh Kumar Gupta to Mukesh Kumar for All Future Purposes.

0040866318-1

I,Pramod Kumar,S/o Shyam Vir Singh,R/o House No-210,Purbaliyan, Muzaffarnagar Uttar Pradesh -251203 have changed my name to Parmod Kumar.

0040866383-2

I,hitherto known as Purnima,D/O-Vinod Kumar,W/O-Sumit Kumar Verma,R/O-H.NO-1303,Gurgaon ESI Hospital,Sector-9A,Gurgaon, Haryana-122001,have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as Purnima verma.

0040866384-9

I, Ranjit Kaur W/o No 14309883L Rank Nk (Late) Balwinder Singh R/o H. No.-11/2 East Vinod Nagar, Delhi-110091 have changed my name to Ranjeet Kaur vide affidavit date 15-7-26 before Delhi.

0071048041-1

I, ZEENATH RIZVI,w/o karar ali r/o-c-9/5 yamuna vihar Delhi-110053,have changed my name to ZEENAT RIZVI,FOR ALL PURPOSE

0040866386-4

I,RENA KHATOON D/O SHAMIL AHMED AND W/O KHURSHED AHMED HEREBY CONFIRMS RENNA KHATOON AND RANA KHATOON BOTH NAMES BELONGS TO ME.

0130066851-1

I,Anita Gupta D/o Panna Lal Yadav,W/o Mr.Ankur Gupta,R/o H.No.34-A,First Floor,H-Block,Street No.3, Shakarpur,East Delhi-110092,have changed my name to Anita Yadav.

0040866412-4

I,KHALIL AHMED,S/O-HABIBULLAH,R/O E-604,GALI NO-22,OLD MUSTAFABAD,DELHI-110094,HAVE CHANGE MY NAME MUNNA ALIAS MUNNE SAIFI TO KHALIL AHMED,FOR ALL,FUTURE PURPOSES.

0040866383-4

I, Anubha Gupta Agarwal W/o Ankur Agarwal R/O-SG2/1703, Saya Gold Avenue, Vaibhav Khand, Indirapuram, Ghaziabad have changed my name to Anubha Gupta.

0071048047-1

I,BASAB MAITY,S/O-ANGSU MAN MAITY,R/O-1664-B,GALI.NO.15, GOVINDPUR,KALKAJI,SOUTH-DELHI,DELHI-110019,HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO "BASAB CHANDRA MAITY". HENCEFORTH,I WOULD BE KNOWN BY THE NAME OF"BASAB CHANDRA MAITY"FOR ALL,FUTURE PURPOSES.

0040866384-2

I, Prince s/o Shamsher Gahlawat r/o Plot No.-663, Gali No.-2, Saini Vihar, Mundka Village, Delhi-110041 have changed my name as PRINCE GAHLAWAT permanently.

0040866273-2

I, Bharti Prasad D/o-Late Mihilesh Kumar Prasad R/o-901, Osimo Tower, Mahagun Maestro, Sector-50, Noida, will be called by name of Bharti Prasad for all future purposes.

0040866280-1

LOST & FOUND

Lost my original Rohini Registration Receipt of (Application No.30648, Priority No.16560, on Date-06.04.1981, Rohini Scheme LIG, Rs.2,000/-) Finder may Contact-Ajeet Singh S/o-Late Rattan Singh at-A-16, Sarai Pipal Thala Extension, Opposite Metro Metro Pillar No.100, Adarsh Nagar, Delhi-110033

0040866314-1

I, Yasir Adeel Yusuf S/o Aftab Yusuf R/o D-1/203, FLAT No. B-3, 3RD FLOOR, Abul Fazal Enclave, Okhla, Delhi, have lost my Allotment Letter of my house No. 153, Block-B, Sector Sigma-1, Greater Noida, G. Nagar (U.P.), having allotment No. SIGMA60096 Any use of it will be considered illegal.

0071048132-1

I,SHOBHA KUMARI,D/O-LATE SH.CARLO NICOLAS,R/O- Flat.No.41, Ground-Floor,F-Block,Utsav-Apartment,Rohini Sector-18,North-West, Delhi-110089, I have lost my property documents:(1)Original allotment slip By DDA bearing.no.353(1147)-2011/DDA10/RO/7098/23/07/12(4)Housing loan Disbursement letter bearing no. RACPC/HL/2011-12 (5)Origin-Demand cum- Allotment letter by DDA bearing no. L/353(1147)2011/DDA10/RO (6) Original position-Letter by DDA. (7)Original Conveyance deed by DDA and entire documents related to my above said property/Flat.

0040866384-11

PUBLIC NOTICE

Notice is hereby given to the general public that My Client M/s SHREE RADHE KRISHNA ASSOCIATES having its



Government of Tamil Nadu
ELECTRONICS CORPORATION
TAMIL NADU LIMITED - ANGADI



9th Floor, Sigapi Aachi Building, 18/3, Rukmani Lakshmiipathi Road, Egmore, Chennai - 600 008
<https://elcot.tn.gov.in> | +91 44 2855 6120 | cloud@elcotangadi.in

NOTICE INVITING TENDER
Tender No. E-ANGADI-ST-SDC-2026-0034

ELCOT Angadi Division invites **"Tender for Empanelment of Managed Service Providers (MSP) to provide Cloud services from MeITy empaneled CSPs"**. For complete details, please visit www.intenders.gov.in. Pre-bid meeting: 23.07.2026, 11 AM. Last date for submission of e-bids: 19.08.2026, 3 PM. For queries: cloud@elcotangadi.in.

DIPR/2305/Tender/2026 **GENERAL MANAGER (PROCUREMENT)**



The Brihanmumbai Electric Supply & Transport Undertaking
(OF THE BRIHANMUMBAI MAHANAGARPALIKA)



TENDER NOTICE

E-tender is invited for the supply of following item.

(1) 81950 - M.S. Arm Brackets of various sizes, (2) 81418 - (Corrigendum),

Re – invited e-tenders

(3) 81537.

Note: For more details, log on to website <https://mahatenders.gov.in>

PRO/AAM(M)/45/2026 **GENERAL MANAGER**

Rajasthan Medical Services Corporation Ltd.
D-Block, Swasthya Bhawan, C-Scheme, Jaipur - 302005
Ph. No. 0141-2223887, Fax No. 0141-2228065, E-Mail-edepmmrsc-rj@nic.in
Ref. No.: F.80/RMSC/EPM/M-4/NIB-930/2025-26/533 Dated:- 14/07/2026

Corrigendum / Addendum

Bid for item WASTE BIN RED, BLACK & YELLOW (15 & 25 Ltr) are invited from interested bidders up to Date : 13/08/2026 : 06:00 PM. Other particulars of the bid may be visited on Procurement portal website <https://sppp.rajasthan.gov.in> or www.dipronline.org or <https://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in> or website <http://rmsc.health.rajasthan.gov.in>.
UBN No.: MSC2526GLOB00054

Director (P)
Rajasthan Medical Services Corporation

Raj.Samwad/C/26/7081

SALUTE THE SOLDIER

NK PAVANE NANASAHEB TUKARAM

On 17 Jul 2001, you made the supreme sacrifice while serving for the mother land while fighting with the terrorists in Kokrajhar (Assam). We remember your selfless service, courage and determination and you continue to be an inspiration to all of us.

BORDER SECURITY FORCE

Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Jawans on their Balidan Diwas.



SH SUDHIR KR BAMEITA,
ASSISTANT
COMMANDANT,
PPMG
28 BN BSF
15.12.1970
– 17.07.2002



CONSTABLE
ASHOK KUMAR
20 BN BSF
08.04.1967
– 17.07.2001

CENTRAL RESERVE POLICE FORCE



Veer Balidani
Assistant Sub
Inspector
Vinod Kumar
182 Bn
15-7-1970 To
17-7-2022



Veer Balidani
Constable
P Abdul Rafeek
19 Bn
19-3-1979 To
17-7-2009

DG and all Ranks of CRPF pay solemn tribute to Assistant Sub Inspector Vinod Kumar of 182 Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice while bravely combating terrorists during a joint naka duty in Pulwama, Jammu & Kashmir on 17 July 2022. CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.

DG and all Ranks of CRPF pay solemn tribute to Constable P Abdul Rafeek of 19 Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice after being grievously injured while bravely combating Maoists during an operation in Rourkela district, Odisha on 17 July 2009. CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.

Government of Jammu and Kashmir
Department of Fisheries
Ph.0194-2500092, 0191-2951670 email: jkfd-kmr@jk.gov.in, jkfd-jmu@jk.gov.in
Auction Notice No. 01 of 2026 Dated: 15 -07-2026

For and on behalf of the Lieutenant Governor, Union Territory of Jammu and Kashmir, e-Bid affixed with Revenue Stamp worth Rs. 5/- are invited from the Citizen of India,for the auction of Fishing Rights of Ranjit Sagar Reservoir (J&K portion) viz Satvain/Basohli, District Kathua for a period of one-year from the date of issuance of fishing rights contract. The society of Fishermen registered under the Cooperative Act of the J&K State (now Union Territory of Jammu and Kashmir) if any, can also participate in the auction proceeding. The Bid documents containing detailed terms & conditions can be seen/downloaded against e-Bid document fee of Rs.2000/- (Rupees Two Thousand only) in shape of DD pledged to Assistant Director Fisheries, District Kathua from the official Government website www.jktenders.gov.in. from:-

1	Download date start	16-07-2026
2	Bid Submission date start	17-07-2026
3	Bid submission date ends	07-08-2026
4	Submission of original Earnest Money Deposit along with Tender document Fee in shape of Demand Draft.	07-08-2026
5	Bid opening Date	09-08-2026

The original Demand Draft of EMDRs.5,00,000/- (Rupees Five Lakh only) along with Tender Document Fee of Rs. 2000/- (Rupees two thousand only) pledged to the Assistant Director Fisheries, District Kathua respectively in a sealed cover addressed to Accounts Officer (Member Secretary of the Auction Committee Ranjit Sagar Reservoir)/Department of Fisheries, Canal Road, Nowabad Jammu-180016 shall reach by or before 07.08.2026 upto 4.00PM without of which no bid shall be accepted. However, in case the interested genuine bidders fail to submit hard copies (original) of CDRs (tender document fee and earnest money deposit), the technical bid shall still be opened to verify/check the uploaded documents including the copies of CDRs. The bidders who shall have failed to submit hard copies of CDRs (tender document fee and earnest money deposit) but have uploaded them with bid document on JK tenders, in that case concerned bank/branch shall be approached for forfeiture of the CDRs and defaulters shall be blacklisted in J&K UT for future auction process. The other terms and conditions will remain same as are mentioned in detailed bid document.

The Bid shall be opened on 09.08.2026 at 11:30 AM or any other date convenient to bid opening authority in presence of bidders who may like to be present.

(Yog Raj)

Accounts Officer

Member Secretary Auction Committee,

Ranjit Sagar Reservoir,

Fisheries Department.

No.-DOF-ACTT/32/2026-05 Dated: 15 -07-2026.
DIPK-3394/26 – DATE 16 JULY 2026

कार्यालय अधीक्षण अभियन्ता
आगरा वृत्त, लोक निर्माण विभाग, आगरा

पत्रांक :- 3922 / 14एम-आ0वृ0 / दिनांक- 07.07.26

1. महामहिम राज्यपाल उत्तर प्रदेश की ओर से, अधीक्षण अभियन्ता, आगरा वृत्त, लो.नि.वि., आगरा, द्वारा निम्न तालिका में अंकित विवरण के अनुसार लोक निर्माण विभाग में भवन कार्य के पंजीकृत ठेकेदारों से प्रतिशत दर के आधार पर ऑन लाईन निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती है। निविदादाताओं को सलाह दी जाती है कि निविदा डालने से पूर्व निविदा के लिए न्यूनतम अर्हता हेतु निविदा निर्देशिका के क्लॉज 4 का ध्यानपूर्वक अध्ययन कर लें।

2.

क्र.सं.	जिला	कार्य का नाम	अनुमानित लागत (लाख रु० में)	संवेदक लागत (लाख रु० में)	निविदा प्रत्यक्ष मूल्य (रु०)	कार्य शुरू करने की अवधि	कार्य सम्पन्न करने वाले अधिकांसी अभियन्ता का पता	अधीक्षण अभियन्ता का पता	मुख्य अभियन्ता का पता	ठेकेदार की श्रेणी
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11
1	आगरा	जुलूस कमिश्नरेट, आगरा में प्रोपेटिटा फुलि क्लब अखलाय परिसर में कवरड्रीज, गार्ड रुम, डेकेटरी, सोरीली क्लब एवं गेट का निर्माण कार्य।	352.00	19.60	स्टेनरी चार्ज + टेंपली 0 + जोएस्टी = रु० 2354.00	18 माह	अधीक्षारी अभियन्ता, नि०छ०-नरर, लो.नि.वि., आगरा	अधीक्षण अभियन्ता, आगरा वृत्त, लो०नि० वि०, आगरा	मुख्य अभियन्ता, आगरा क्षेत्र, लो०नि० वि०, आगरा	ए बवन कार्य में पंजीकृत

3. कार्य पूर्ण करने की अवधि में वर्ष ऋतु भी सम्मिलित है।

4. वेबसाइट <http://etender.up.nic.in> एवं प्रहरी साफ्टवेयर पर निविदा से सम्बन्धित समस्त विवरण एवं विस्तृत शर्तें तथा बिडिंग डॉक्यूमेंट्स आन लाइन दि० 06.08.2026 से 12.08.2026 तक उपलब्ध होंगे। आन लाइन बिड दि० 12.08.2026 को दोपहर 12:30 बजे या इससे पूर्व ई-निविदा <http://etender.up.nic.in> एवं शासनदेश सं०-14 / 2020 / 879 / 23-7-2020-176(सा०) / 06 दिनांक 25.08.2020 के क्रम में प्रहरी साफ्टवेयर (<http://roc.uppwd.gov.in>/Prahari) पर अनिवार्य रूप से सभी वांछित अभिलेखों सहित ऑनलाइन जमा कर दी जाये एवं आन लाइन प्राप्त समस्त टेक्निकल बिड दिनांक 12.08.2026 को दोपहर 1:00 बजे खोली जायेगी।

(मनीष कुमार)

अधीक्षारी अभियन्ता

नि०छ०-भवन, लो०नि०वि०, आगरा

(सी०पी० सिंह)

अधीक्षण अभियन्ता

आगरा वृत्त, लो०नि०वि०, आगरा

UPID-253766 Dt. 15/07/2026
www.upidadv.gov.in

OFFICE OF THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER PWD (R&B) DIVISION VIJAYPUR
ABBREVIATED NOTICE INVITING TENDER

e-NIT No. 32 of 2026-27 Dated. 15-07-2026

For and on behalf of the Lieutenant Governor, Union Territory of Jammu and Kashmir e-tenders are invited on percentage basis from approved and eligible Contractors registered with Union Territory of J&K, CPWD, Railways, MES and other State/Central Governments for each of the following works.

S. No.	Name of Work	Estimated cost of Work (In Lacs)	Cost of Tender Doc. (In Rs.)	Earnest Money (In Rs.)	Time allowed for completion	Class of Contractor
1	2	3	4	5	6	7
1	Const. of road from Tubewell to National Highway at village Chanda and Jakh Pyl. Halqua Bagla Jakh stage- 1.	77.67	1500	2% of Adv. Cost	12 Months	“A”
2	Const. of road from National Highway to 17 Miles main road with allied links stage – 1.	77.67	1500	2% of Adv. Cost	12 Months	“A”

Position of AAA :- Accorded
Position of T.S :- Sanctioned
Project Authority :- Under UT Capex Road sector (New Works) 2025-26.

1	Date of Issue of Tender Notice	15-07-2026
2	Period of downloading of bidding documents	From 15-07-2026 to 22-07-2026
3	Date, Time and place of pre-bid meeting	16-07-2026 at 1300 Hrs. in the Office of Executive Engineer PWD (R&B) Division Vijaypur
4	Bid submission Start Date	15-07-2026 at 1800 Hrs
5	Bid Submission End Date	22-07-2026 upto 1700 Hrs
6	Date & time of opening of Technical Bids (Online)	23-07-2026 on or after 1300 Hrs in the Office of Executive Engineer PWD (R&B) Division Vijaypur
7	Date & time of opening of Financial Bids (Online)	To be notified after technical bid evaluation is completed

The tender is available at website <http://jktenders.gov.in> all other terms & conditions can be seen on the above website.

Sd/-

Executive Engineer,

PWD (R&B) Division, Vijaypur

DIP/J-5878/26 – DATE 16 JULY 2026

FORM NO. 14
[See Regulation 33(2)] By Regd. A/D, Dasti failing which by Publication.
OFFICE OF THE RECOVERY OFFICER - I/II
DEBTS RECOVERY TRIBUNAL DELHI(DRT 2)
4th Floor, Jeevan Tara Building, Parliament Street, New Delhi-110001
DEMAND NOTICE
NOTICE UNDER SECTIONS 25 TO 28 OF THE RECOVERY OF DEBTS & BANKRUPTCY ACT, 1993 AND RULE 2 OF SECOND SCHEDULE TO THE INCOME TAX ACT, 1961.
RC/61/2026 18-05-2026
THE HONGKONG AND SHANGHAI BANKING CORPORATION
Versus
MR. PARVINDER SINGH SAWHNEY

To
(CD 1) Mr. PARVINDER SINGH SAWHNEY, R/O A-6, Nizamuddin, West, New Delhi 110013 Also At: A-09, Housing Complex Opposite Sez, P-II, Noida
(CD 2) MS. JATINDER KAUR SAWHNEY, R/O A-6, Nizamuddin, West, New Delhi 110013, Also At: A-09, Housing Complex Opposite Sez, P-II, Noida
This is to notify that as per the Recovery Certificate issued in pursuance of orders passed by the Presiding Officer, DEBTS RECOVERY TRIBUNAL DELHI(DRT 2) in **TA/490/2022** an amount of **Rs 3698309 (Rupees Thirty Six Lakhs Ninety Eight Thousands Three Hundred Nine Only)** along with pendentellite and future interest @ 9% Simple Interest Yearly we.f. **20/07/2012** till realization and costs of **Rs 39000 (Rupees Thirty Nine Thousands Only)** has become due against you (Jointly and severally/Fully/Limited).
2. You are hereby directed to pay the above sum within 15 days of the receipts of the notice, failing which the recovery shall be made in accordance with the Recovery of Debts Due to Banks and Financial Institutions Act, 1993 and Rules there under.
3. You are hereby ordered to declare on an affidavit the particulars of yours assets on or before the next date of hearing.
4. You are hereby ordered to appear before the undersigned on **01/09/2026** at 10:30 a.m. for further proceedings.
5. In addition to the sum aforesaid, you will also be liable to pay:-
(a) Such interests as is payable for the period commencing immediately after this notice of the certificate / execution proceedings.
(b) All costs, charges and expenses incurred in respect of the service of this notice and warrants and other processes and all other proceedings taken for recovering the amount due. Given under my hand and the seal of the Tribunal, on this date: **18/05/2026**

Recovery Officer
Debts Recovery Tribunal Delhi(DRT 2)

COPY TO:- THE HONGKONG AND SHANGHAI BANKING CORPORATION, 25, Barakhamba Road New Delhi 110001
You are directed that the payment made, if any, by the Certificate Debtor(s) be credited to the consolidated account of all debts due in this case from the Certificate Debtor(s) and the Recovery Officer kept posted with the payment position regularly.
The consolidated account so maintained will be subject to the verification of the Recovery Officer. You are further directed to submit an up to date statement of the total claim in respect of the above matter and full details of property particulars wherefrom the recovery of the debt is to be made.
Note : Strike out whichever is not applicable..



GURU GHASIDAS VISHWAVIDYALAYA
(Central University established by the Central Universities Act, 2009, No.25 of 2009)
KONI, BILASPUR-495 009 (C.G.) INDIA . Tel.- +91-7752-260342

Ref. No. 574/MSDF/Academic/26 **ADMISSION NOTICE (2026-27)** Bilaspur, Date- 15.07.2026

Admission in M.Sc. Digital Forensic and Information Security under Self Finance Scheme (SFS)
Applications are invited in the prescribed form for the Admission in M.Sc. Digital Forensic and Information Security under Self Finance Scheme (SFS) in the Department of Forensic Science, School of Studies of Interdisciplinary Education & Research (IER).

Department	No. of Seats	Duration of Course	Fee Structure
Forensic Science	25	2 Years (4 Semesters)	Rs.60000 per Semester

Please check website for eligibility criteria and application form.

The candidates fulfilling the eligibility criteria may apply for admission as per the details available on the University website <https://ggu.ac.in>. The last date for submission of application is 10/08/2026. The candidates are advised to refer the detailed notification of M.Sc. admission available on university website before filling the application form.

Help line: 07752-260342, 9406430720

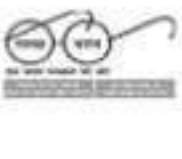
Sd/- Registrar

"IMPORTANT"

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बिहार सरकार



कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय,
भवन प्रमंडल, गया जी
E-mail :- ee.gaya.bcd1@gmail.com
शुद्धि पत्र

एतव द्वारा सर्वसाधारण को सूचित किया जाता है कि इस कार्यालय के पत्रांक-2002 दिनांक-30.06.2026 द्वारा आमंत्रित अति अल्पकालीन ई०-पुनर्निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना सं०-**06/2026-27** जिसका PR No.-**006884(BCD) 2026-27** है, जो विभिन्न समाचार पत्रों में प्रकाशित हुआ है, को अपरिहार्य कारणवश निम्नरूपेण विस्तारित किया जाता है :-

क्र० सं०	विवरण	पूर्व का निर्धारित तिथि एवं समय	संशोधित तिथि एवं समय
1	निविदा कागजात प्राप्त करने (डाउनलोड करने) की अंतिम तिथि एवं समय	अंतिम तिथि-31.07.2026 के 15:00 बजे तक	अंतिम तिथि-03.08.2026 के 15:00 बजे तक
2	निविदा प्राप्ति (अपलोड) करने की तिथि एवं समय	दिनांक-01.08.2026 के 15:00 बजे तक	दिनांक-04.08.2026 के 15:00 बजे तक
3	निविदा खोलने की तिथि एवं समय (तकनीकी बीड)	दिनांक-03.08.2026 को 15:30 बजे तक	दिनांक-05.08.2026 को 15:30 बजे तक

इसे हद तक संशोधित समझा जाय। शेष शर्तें यथावत रहेंगी। विस्तृत जानकारी www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar से प्राप्त की जा सकती है।

PR. No. 007944 (BCD) 2026-27

कार्यपालक अभियंता,
भवन प्रमंडल, गयाजी

बिहार में शराब का व्यापार, विक्री एवं सेवन अवैध है।
इससे संबंधित शिकायत इस नंबर पर दर्ज करायें, आपकी जानकारी गुप्त रखी जाएगी।
टॉल फ्री नं- 15545 या 1800 345 6268



बिहार सरकार



DEPARTMENT OF SPORTS
Address: Secretary Cell, Room No- 416, 4th Floor, Vikas Bhawan, New Secretariat Building, Patna-800015, Email: secy.sports-bih@gov.in
RFP No: 5/खेल 8-27/2026/02
(Request for Proposal- RFP)

खेल विभाग, बिहार सरकार द्वारा विभागीय योजनाओं एवं परियोजनाओं के प्रभावी संचालन, अनुश्रवण एवं प्रबंधन के लिए प्रोजेक्ट मैनेजमेंट यूनिट (PMU) हेतु योग्य एवं अनुभवी एजेंसी के चयन के लिए निविदा (RFP) आमंत्रित की गई है।
इच्छुक एवं पात्र एजेंसियों निर्धारित पात्रता मानदंडों के अनुरूप अपनी निविदाएँ आरएफपी (RFP) दस्तावेज में उल्लिखित शर्तों के अनुसार निर्धारित समय-सीमा के भीतर ई-प्रोक्योरमेंट पोर्टल (<https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in>) के माध्यम से प्रस्तुत कर सकती हैं।
RFP के अंतर्गत चयनित प्रक्रिया का विस्तृत विवरण तकनीकी दिशा-निर्देश, सेवा-क्षेत्र एवं अपेक्षित डिलिवरेबल्स अनुलग्नक संलग्न हैं।
इच्छुक एवं पात्र एजेंसियों दिनांक- 16.07.2026 से 06.08.2026 तक निर्धारित अवधि तक निविदा दस्तावेज प्रस्तुत कर सकते हैं।

(उमाकांत प्रसाद)
अवर सचिव,
खेल विभाग, बिहार, पटना

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उक्त सूचना www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar पर भी देखी जा सकती है।
सुरक्षित जीवन अपनाओ, अपनी नियमित एच.आई.वी. जाँच कराओ।

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